

KANTAR BRANDZ

2025 MOST VALUABLE
CHINESE BRANDS

最具价值中国品牌



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2025 MOST VALUABLE CHINESE BRANDS

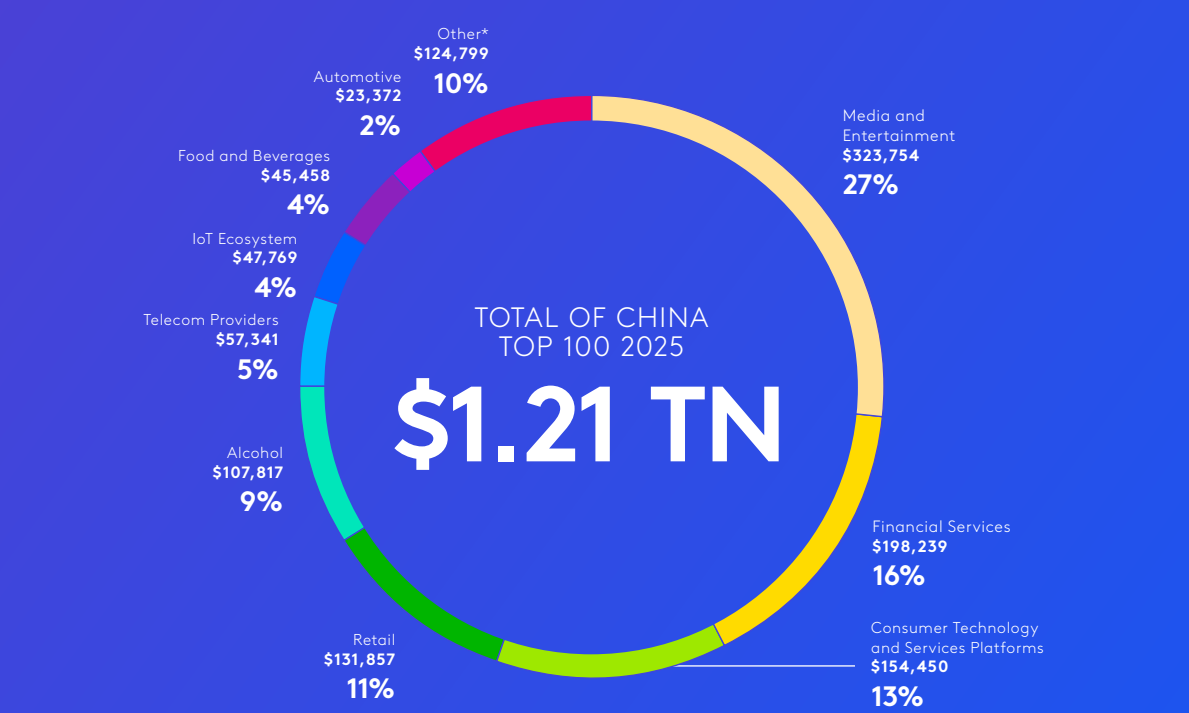
TOTAL VALUE OF THE CHINA TOP 100: \$1.21 TRILLION
YEAR-ON-YEAR CHANGE: 25%

THE TOP 100 MOST VALUABLE CHINESE BRANDS 2025

1	TENCENT ¹	51	MIXUE BINGCHENG
2	ALIBABA ²	52	HAIDILAO
3	MOUTAI	53	CHINA EVERBRIGHT BANK
4	DOUYIN	54	CHINA EASTERN AIRLINES
5	HUAWEI	55	ANTA
6	HAIER	56	PICC
7	CHINA MOBILE	57	KE
8	ICBC	58	ZTO EXPRESS
9	PING AN	59	XING HUA CUN
10	MEITUAN	60	LUCKIN COFFEE
11	XIAOMI	61	FRESHIPPO
12	AGRICULTURAL BANK OF CHINA	62	BILIBILI
13	CHINA CONSTRUCTION BANK	63	HEYTEA
14	CHINA LIFE	64	SHUANGHUI
15	JD ³	65	TAIKANG
16	PINDUODUO	66	VANKE
17	BANK OF CHINA	67	DJI
18	BYD	68	CHINA UNICOM
19	NONGFU SPRING	69	YUNNAN BAIYAO
20	CHINA MERCHANTS BANK	70	YOUKU
21	CHINA TELECOM	71	CHINA CITIC BANK
22	SHEIN	72	LIANJIA
23	SINOPEC	73	LI AUTO
24	YILI	74	LUZHOU LAOJIAO
25	NETEASE	75	POLY
26	CNPC	76	TCL
27	BAIDU	77	BOE
28	KUAISHOU	78	QUNAR.COM
29	WU LIANG YE	79	MANGO TV
30	SF EXPRESS	80	XPENG
31	XIAOHONGSHU	81	TSINGTAO
32	MIDEA	82	SNOW
33	TOUTIAO	83	BOSS ZHIPIN
34	VIVO	84	GUJING GONG JIU
35	HADAY	85	FLIGGY
36	CTRIP	86	TONG REN TANG
37	CPIC	87	CR LAND
38	AIR CHINA	88	CHAGEE
39	BANK OF COMMUNICATIONS	89	BANK OF NINGBO
40	NATIONAL CELLAR 1573	90	CHINA MINSHENG BANK
41	MENGNIU	91	GENKI FOREST
42	IFLYTEK	92	WEDOCTOR
43	LENOVO	93	NCI
44	EASTROC BEVERAGE	94	NIO
45	CHINA SOUTHERN AIRLINES	95	KUGOU
46	ELE.ME	96	GUO YUAN
47	CHOW TAI FOOK	97	YANGHE
48	DIANPING	98	DONG E E JIAO
49	DIDI CHUXING	99	YTO EXPRESS
50	GREE	100	CR SANJIU

¹Tencent brand value includes QQ, QQ Music, WeChat, Tencent Music, WeSing, WeChat Pay, WeBank, v.qq.com, and Tencent Cloud
²Alibaba brand value derives from both Media & Entertainment and Business Technology & Services Platforms
³JD brand value includes JD Financial

CATEGORY COMPOSITION



*Energy, Travel Services, Apparel, Logistics, Fast Food, Home Appliances, Business Technology and Services Platforms, Health Care, Real Estate, Real Estate Agents, and Casual Dining.

TOP 10 RISERS

		BRAND VALUE CHANGE (%) 2025 VS. 2024
#1	mi	\$28,150 M CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES PLATFORMS +154%
#2	BYD	\$17,164 M AUTOMOTIVE +78%
#3	东鹏饮料	\$4,218 M FOOD & BEVERAGES +73%
#4	HUAWEI	\$64,152 M CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES PLATFORMS +56%
#5	美团	\$29,328 M CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES PLATFORMS +54%
#6	大众点评	\$4,077 M CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES PLATFORMS +54%
#7	Tencent 腾讯	\$197,991 M BUSINESS TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES PLATFORMS / MEDIA & ENTERTAINMENT +53%
#8	携程旅行	\$5,586 M CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY & SERVICES PLATFORMS +49%
#9	bilibili	\$3,005 M MEDIA & ENTERTAINMENT +49%
#10	Haier	\$47,769 M IOT ECOSYSTEM +47%

NEWCOMERS & RE-ENTRANTS

	BRAND VALUE (US\$M)
蜜雪冰城 始于1997 冰淇淋专家	\$3,955 NEW
盒马 FRESHIPPO	\$3,008 NEW
去哪儿旅行	\$2,204 RE-ENTRY
XPENG	\$2,175 RE-ENTRY
CHAGEE	\$1,817 NEW
NCI 新华保险	\$1,684 RE-ENTRY
东阿阿胶	\$1,500 RE-ENTRY

15 YEARS OF EXCELLENCE AND THE JOURNEY AHEAD FOR TOP CHINESE BRANDS

The total value of the Kantar BrandZ Top 100 Most Valuable Chinese Brands rose by 25% this year as China's top brands pursued AI innovation and overseas expansion.

In all, 68 brands in the 2025 China Top 100 have grown since 2024 – almost twice as many as the year before. The country's largest brands performed especially well this year, including Tencent, Huawei, Haier, Meituan, and Xiaomi.

2025 is a big anniversary year for Kantar BrandZ in China, as well as for the Kantar BrandZ practice globally. Kantar BrandZ released its first ranking of the world's most valuable brands 20 years ago; five years after that, its first China ranking.

From the start, Kantar has approached China's top businesses as *brands*. This was not always the popular stance: back in 2010, some people misperceived Chinese firms as having merely lucked into their perches atop the world's largest internal market. What we saw, by contrast, was companies well on their way to securing the kind of 'brand premium' that generates superior returns from Meaningfully Different offerings around the world.

And that's exactly what is now occurring. China, it turns out, has been formidable proving ground for building top brands. If you can succeed across the country's varied regions, cities, and townships, you'll have a strong base from which to expand globally. (Allowing for some considered adjustments for export markets, given that the best brands localise when expanding overseas).

This year especially, Chinese brands have succeeded impressively, returning the China Top 100 to strong growth after three challenging years. From micro-dramas to intelligent driving technology to AI-powered home appliances, Chinese innovations now drive global business and cultural trends –

with Chinese brands showing a particular gift for bridging virtual-physical divides. It's about constantly finding new ways to reach consumers at and beyond the point of sale, while always pushing for richer insights and stronger execution.

It is notable, too, that 2025's ranked brands have succeeded while remaining proudly Chinese. These days, being known as a 'brand from China' evokes dual strengths: on one hand, 5,000 years of cultural heritage; on the other, up-to-the-minute digital innovation. (Indeed, many of China's hottest cultural exports, like *Ne Zha* and *Black Myth: Wukong*, exist precisely at the intersection of these two dynamics).

This report, then, should be read as a celebration of China's many success stories. But it's also a guide for the road ahead. Chinese brands have come into their own just as the world economy has begun to fragment – or at the very least, grow more volatile. This has taught Chinese brands the importance of agility. But in the future, they'll have to be even more agile.

Brands are already facing new challenges and opportunities in this new age of advanced AI. For Chinese brands, these include trade tensions, the maturation of the Chinese domestic economy, the imperative to expand abroad, and the need to turn AI innovations into tangible business results. Add in the tasks of building a 'healthier China' and a more sustainable world, plus major evolutions in content commerce and brand marketing...and you'd still have only a partial list. In sum: top Chinese brands have a lot to be proud of, but they cannot afford to rest on their laurels.





Moving forward

At Kantar, building strong brands is, quite literally, our mission. We shape the brands of the future by better understanding people everywhere. We use the power of our teams, tools, and data to become the partners clients need to implement transformational change.

And for 20 years, the Kantar BrandZ database has been one of the most important tools in Kantar’s brand-building arsenal. At the core of the Kantar BrandZ approach is a model for stable growth that has been tested and re-tested, challenged and re-confirmed, across all the work that we do.

That now includes the Blueprint for Brand Growth, Kantar’s breakthrough strategic framework for understanding how businesses can build profitable, strong, and sustainable brands. Drawing on Kantar BrandZ and marketplace data from around the world, the Blueprint for Brand Growth presents a trove of best practices that truly cross borders. It should prove an essential companion for Chinese brands navigating through this challenging economic environment.

As mentioned, we began our Kantar BrandZ Global rankings back in 2006. Over the years, Kantar’s data and modelling has indicated how brand value – and branded business growth – derives from three core building blocks: Meaningfulness, Difference, and Salience. Brand attributes like Creativity, Innovation, Sustainability, and Trust (all of which are measured in the Kantar BrandZ database) ultimately contribute to a brand’s Meaningful Difference.

Today, our proprietary Kantar BrandZ database has expanded to include information from over 4.5 million consumers regarding their attitudes toward (and relationships with) 22,000 brands across 538 categories in 54 markets. All of that has produced more than 5.5 billion data points.

Just two years into our project, in 2008, the global economy ground to a halt, and brands were tested in unprecedented ways. So, too, was Kantar’s theory of brand value growth. But the data didn’t lie: when the dust settled, it was clear that Meaningfully Different brands had retained more of their value during the initial period of the market crash, and captured more of the gains from the ensuing recovery once the economy got back on track. Year after year, this data has told a consistent story: in good times and bad, it pays to bet on strong, distinctive brands.

Reaffirming the fundamentals



To compile this year’s China Top 100 report, we began with the fundamentals. Kantar BrandZ relies on a unique model of brand value.

We start by examining relevant corporate financial data and stripping away everything that doesn’t pertain to the branded business. Then we take the unique step of conducting ongoing, in-depth quantitative consumer research with more than 170,000 consumers annually, across more than 50 countries.

The category-spanning, insight-laden report you have before you is the fruit of these considerable labours. How you read the report, front to back or skipping around, depends on your needs and time available. Whatever way you choose, I guarantee that your time will be well spent. To help you navigate through it, here is a guide to the major components:

SECTION 1
Introduction and Analysis

Here we connect the dots, summarising the key developments and findings in this year’s report, suggesting brand-building actions, and identifying cross-category trends.

SECTION 2
Thought Leadership

We amplify our Kantar BrandZ data findings with articles and insights from Kantar China’s brand-building experts.

SECTION 3
The Kantar BrandZ China Top 100

Here you’ll find the year-on-year brand changes and the analysis that explains which brands did well and why.

SECTION 4
Category Analysis

Join us in examining the dynamics and brand performance of the industries represented in this year’s China ranking, with a spotlight on eight major categories and sectors.

SECTION 5
Brand Perspectives

Hear from the senior leaders of world-renowned Chinese brands that are innovating, inspiring, and carving their own paths.

SECTION 6
Resources

The report concludes with all the contact details and other relevant information needed to go from reading the report to taking the next constructive steps.

We can help

This report is a starting point. I urge you to follow up with the experts who contributed to it. We also have an extensive library of Kantar BrandZ country reports that sit alongside our annual China Top 100 and Global Top 100 reports. In them, you will find intelligence about brand building in key markets such as India, the UK, South Africa, and France. I invite you to access the reports with our compliments at kantar.com/campaigns/brandz.

As the world’s leading marketing, data, insights, and analytics consultancy, Kantar’s research and technology resources are substantial with over 18,000 people working with Kantar worldwide. Our holistic brand guidance approach combines innovation, experience, creative content, and media insights to optimise investment and accelerate profitable growth.

Using the vast Kantar and Kantar BrandZ reservoirs of intelligence, we can help you successfully navigate emerging challenges and fully seize new opportunities.

I am available to personally discuss how we can help you and your brand succeed – building valuable brands that add value to people’s lives.

Please feel free to contact me directly, or reach out to any of our Kantar leaders listed in the Resources section at the end of this report.

Sincerely,

Doreen Wang
Kantar Greater
China CEO &
Global Chair
of Kantar BrandZ

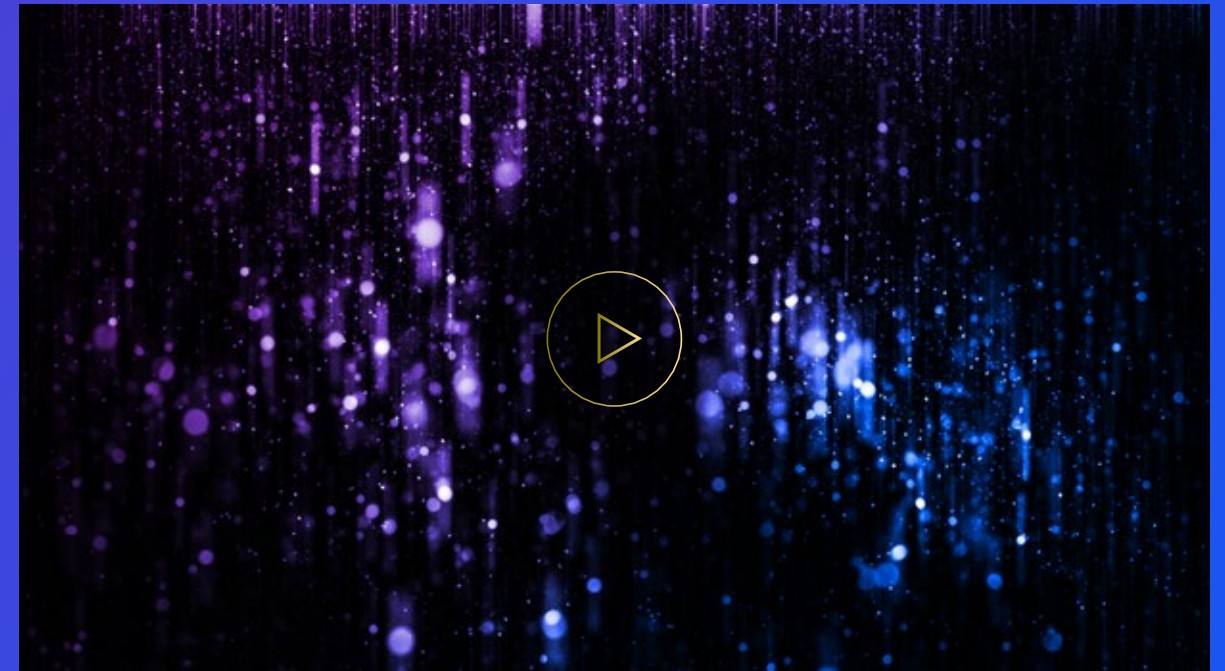
doreen.wang@kantar.com



WHAT IS KANTAR BRANDZ?

THE DEFINITIVE GUIDE TO BRAND BUILDING

5.5 BILLION DATA POINTS
4.5 MILLION CONSUMER INTERVIEWS
22,000 BRANDS
538 CATEGORIES
54 MARKETS



Kantar BrandZ ranks the most valuable brands in the world... and shows you how to become one of them.

It is the world's largest, consumer-focused source of brand equity insight, which also powers our proprietary brand valuation methodology.

Kantar BrandZ brings you industry-leading brand valuations, along with research from the world's most extensive brand equity study: over 4.5 million consumer interviews covering 22,000 brands across 538 categories in 54 markets.

This brand valuation series began in 2006 to help researchers, planners and strategists better understand the brands they worked on. Our reports rank, analyse and honour the world's top brands.

Kantar BrandZ has become a global standard brand value ecosystem, featuring our flagship Most Valuable Global Brands ranking and report. It also features country and regional rankings across six continents, and world-class thought leadership on building strong brands.

HOW DOES KANTAR BRANDZ WORK?

STEP

01

FINANCIAL
VALUE
(\$)

The proportion of the total \$ value of the parent company that can be attributed to the brand in question, considering both current and future performance.

STEP

02

BRAND
CONTRIBUTION
(%)

The proportion of Financial Value generated by the brand's ability to increase purchase volume and charge a premium.

STEP

03

BRAND
VALUE
(\$)

The \$ amount that the brand contributes to the overall business value of the parent company. Kantar BrandZ valuations isolate the value generated by the strength of the brand alone in the minds of consumers i.e. with all other elements removed.



Kantar BrandZ uniquely arrives at brand value by combining the perceptions of those affecting the stock market with the perceptions of consumers. To understand how much brand contributes to the overall business value, we examine relevant corporate financial data and strip away everything that doesn't pertain to the branded business.

We also conduct ongoing, in-depth quantitative research with more than 170,000 consumers and business decision-makers annually and globally to assess attitudes about, and relationships with, thousands of brands.

Then, a team of our analysts combine those inputs with a financial model of the business to determine the brand's ability to generate value.

The result is a holistic portrait of brand equity: one that incorporates how the market values a company's brand assets – and how ordinary people do, too.

WHAT CAN KANTAR BRANDZ DO FOR YOU?

Kantar BrandZ research data is uniquely linked to financial outcomes. Our analysis has repeatedly proven that businesses that invest in their brands outperform the market... and that investing in your brand remains the most powerful way to grow. What's more, we can show you how. Our data and frameworks work to create a forensic portrait of a brand's strengths, weaknesses and opportunities within one – or many – categories and markets.

Get essential insight on category trends and macroeconomic shifts – and how brands compare across crucial building blocks of brand value in Kantar's proprietary **Meaningful Different and Salient framework**.



435% **STRONG BRANDS**
PORTFOLIO

353% **S&P 500**

171% **MSCI WORLD INDEX**

STRONG BRANDS:

DELIVER SUPERIOR
SHAREHOLDER RETURNS

ARE MORE RESILIENT
IN TIMES OF CRISIS

RECOVER MORE QUICKLY

THE BUILDING BLOCKS OF BRAND EQUITY

The most valuable brands in the world have built powerful connections allowing them to create shareholder value faster, resist market downturns and recover sooner from recessions. Brands with powerful connections have three essential qualities: Meaningful, Different, and Salient.

Behavioural science has taught us that our brains store memories using three types of mental connection: knowledge, feelings and experience. Brands with a balance of each come to mind most easily – quickly activating the brain’s memory-retrieval processes.

Effective marketing delivers all three: informing us of what a brand is or does; providing an emotional context and tapping into our emotional needs; and ensuring a positive experience of the brand when used.

The strongest brands – ones that have built up deeper and broader connections over time – end up with three essential qualities: they are Meaningful, Different, and Salient to consumers.

Brands with powerful connections are...

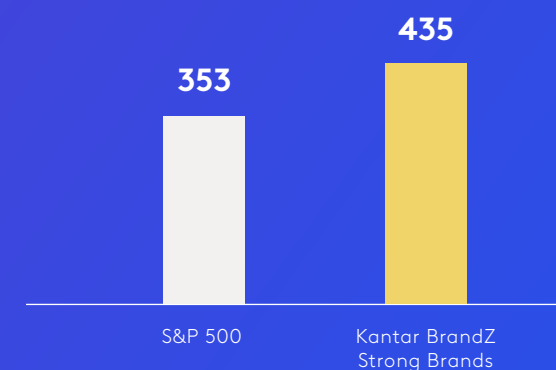
Meaningful: The extent to which brands create clear and consistent functional and emotional connections with consumers. Meaningful brands meet people’s needs in a way that demonstrates warmth.

Different: The extent to which a brand is seen to offer something that others don’t and lead the way. Different brands are hard to substitute and often offer something new.

Salient: The mental availability of the brand – how quickly and easily it comes to mind when choosing between options. A brand’s most fundamental role is as a shortcut for decision making.

KANTAR BRANDZ ANALYSIS PROVES THAT STRONG BRAND EQUITY IS GROWING SHARE PRICES FASTER AND HIGHER OVER THE LONG TERM

% Growth vs. 2006



The Kantar BrandZ Strong Brands Portfolio has grown share prices +83% more than the S&P 500 index.

It has outperformed the S&P 500 every year for the past 19 years.

Don't just take our word for it

The University of Oxford's Saïd Business School has studied Kantar BrandZ brand valuations and compared them against the real-world ups and downs of business.

They found that Kantar BrandZ equity metrics are an excellent predictor of 'abnormal' business returns – those not explained by historical share price performance and company results alone – and that adding Kantar BrandZ measures to their models allowed them to predict business performance with 99.5% accuracy.

What they also found was that Difference contributed most to the best business results.





KANTAR

BRANDSNAPSHOT

Explore Kantar BrandZ data for free

Want to know how your brand stacks up? BrandSnapshot gives you instant access to brand intelligence across thousands of categories in global markets – all powered by Kantar BrandZ, the world's most extensive brand equity study.

Use BrandSnapshot to:

- Get a quick read on your brand equity vs. competitors in a specific category
- Understand what's driving demand, pricing power, and future growth
- Spot opportunities to build your brand's Meaningful Difference

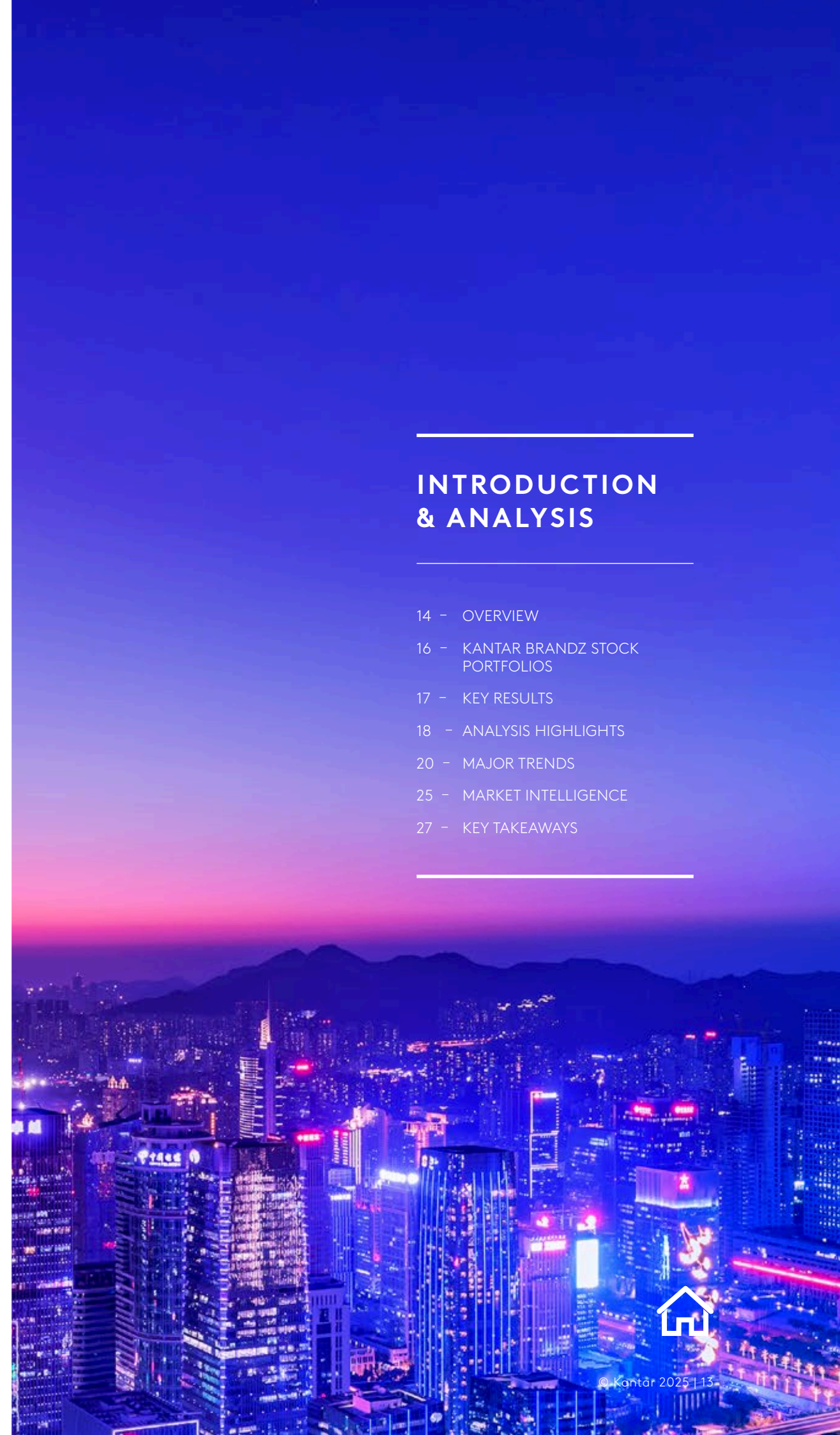
Free. Fast. Insightful. Supercharge your brand's next move.
Discover BrandSnapshot at: kantar.com/marketplace





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INTELLIGENT, POWERFUL BRANDS

CHINESE BRANDS IN THE AGE OF AI

The Kantar BrandZ Top 100 Most Valuable Chinese Brands rose 25% in total value this year. This represents a welcome reversal after three challenging years. It also outpaces the Chinese economy's overall projected growth rate of 5% for 2024.

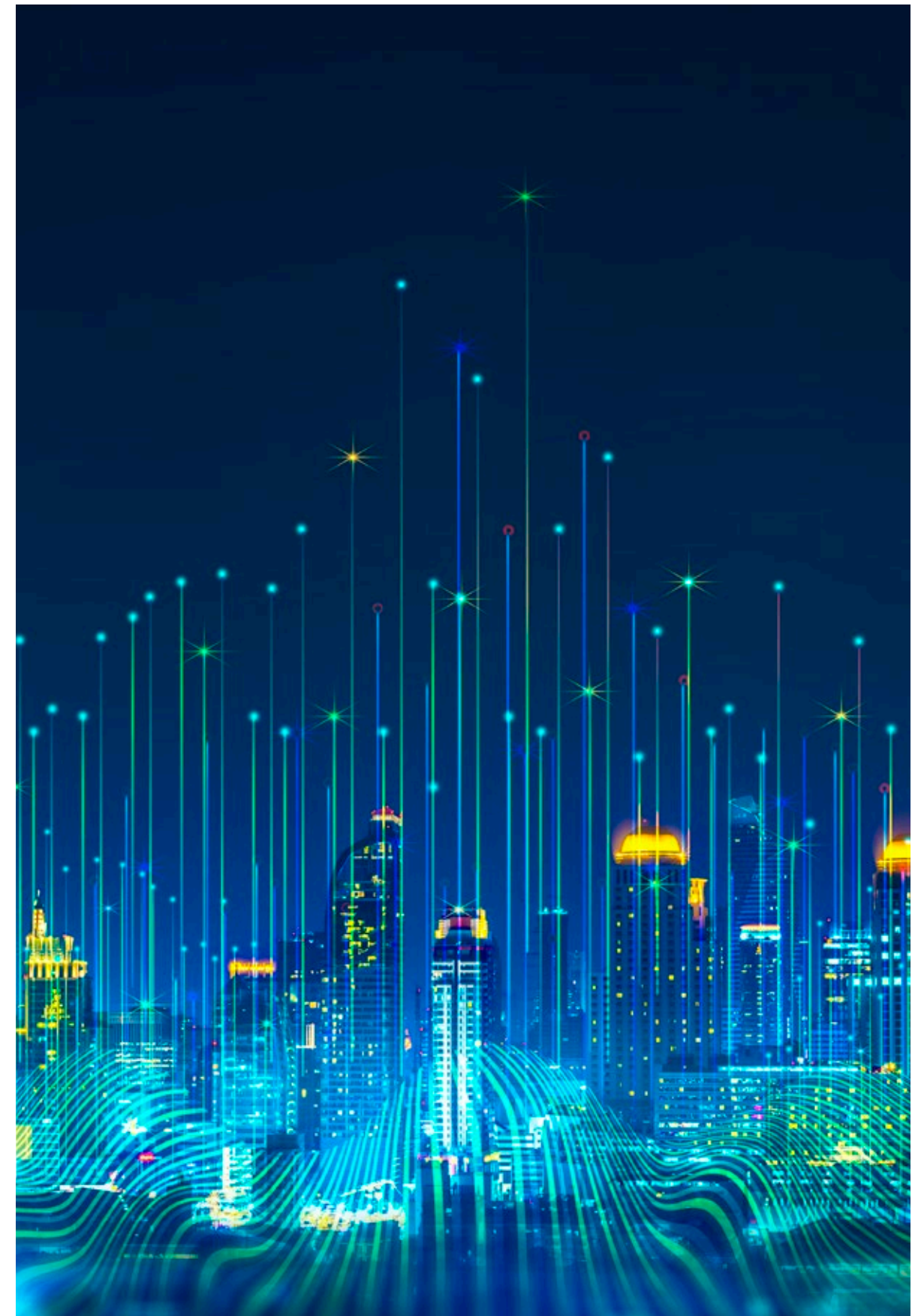
The Chinese economy is maturing, and so is the country's population. Those are two big reasons why China's growth trajectory looks different than it did 15 years ago (while still forerunning even more mature markets like the eurozone).

But there are other macroeconomic headwinds affecting GDP growth. The real estate market remains an ongoing challenge: despite regulatory easing and looser financing, home prices continued to fall in Q2 of 2025.

In other areas, the economic picture is more mixed. China's urban unemployment rate dipped to 5.0% in May, and youth unemployment fell to 14.9% (down from last year's peak of over 21%). Consumer spending also rallied somewhat in the first half of 2025, helping to counteract a softening in manufacturing output.

How does this spending data square with constant headlines proclaiming Chinese shoppers' intention to 'pull back' and 'trade down'? Again, it's nuanced: Kantar research shows that while consumers' perceptions of their *overall (maximum) capacity for spending* have declined, their *willingness to spend in line with previous years* has not collapsed – even if they are seeking more value for their money in various ways, and even if they are shifting to different categories. Among middle-class and high-tier shoppers in particular, spending has trended toward wellness, lifestyle pursuits, and experiences outlays (think gym memberships, outdoor gear, and travel). Lower-income consumers, meanwhile, are saving money while retaining quality by switching to more local brands.

Indeed, in 2025 retail sales have grown year-on-year for every month through June. Most notably, government-backed 'trade-in' policies and subsidies drove a 6.4% year-on-year sales spike in May – the strongest growth since late 2023. These expanded rebate programmes now cover appliances, digital devices, and vehicles, typically with discounts of 15–20%.



Taken together, the rebates have helped unlock pent-up demand – particularly around major sales events like the China 618 Shopping Festival. That’s no small feat in a country with a famously high savings rate (which climbed even higher after the pandemic). However, some localities’ ‘trade-in’ programmes are starting to max out on their funding; long-term momentum will ultimately require further innovation and economic transformation.

China’s tech titans, meanwhile, have rebounded strongly after years of regulatory uncertainty. AI breakthroughs like DeepSeek-R1 and Qwen3 (Alibaba) have fuelled excitement in China’s wider tech ecosystem, with listed public companies enjoying strong stock rallies. On the hardware side, domestic chipmakers have come into their own in the face of import controls.

In order to meet ambitious growth targets, China’s manufacturers have accelerated their expansions abroad – especially into friendlier markets across ASEAN, the Middle East, and Latin America. Overall, a weaker yuan has helped offset some of the volume declines caused by worldwide economic malaise. And so, too, has the emergence of Chinese brands as trusted names worth paying more for – which, of course, is precisely what makes branding so valuable both at home and abroad.

While top brands can never be fully immune to market swoons or economic shocks, strong brands are better positioned to grow beyond any limitations set by category, geography, or macroeconomic context.



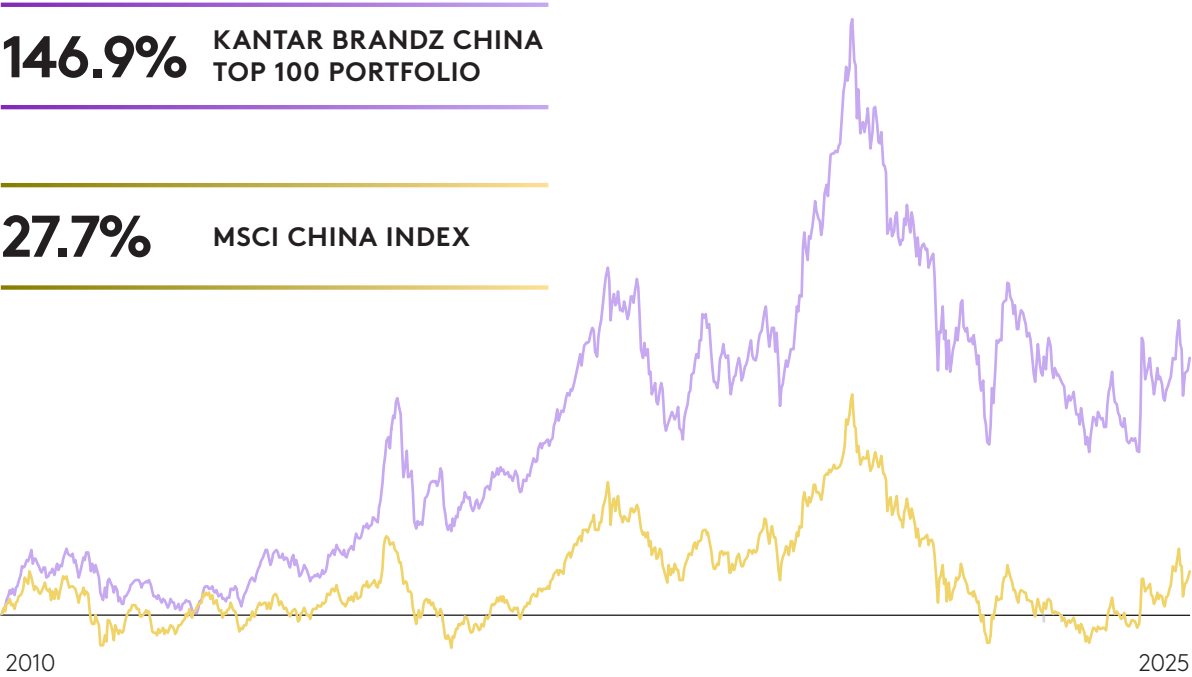
ALL-WEATHER VALUE

STRONG BRANDS FARE BETTER

Strong brands do far more than win press accolades and consumer recognition. The value of a brand has a clear, measurable link with the share price of the company behind it.

Over the 15 years in which we have been tracking China’s strongest brands, the companies behind the top-ranking brands have outperformed stock market benchmarks. The value of the Kantar BrandZ China Top 100 stock portfolio, which includes companies owning the brands in the China Top 100 ranking, increased 146.9% between July 2010 and June 2025. By contrast, the value of the MSCI China Index in June 2025 was up just 27.7% from its 2010 level.

Stock market performance since 2010:
The strong brand advantage



KEY RESULTS

China Top 100 bounces back

The total brand value of the China Top 100 increases by 25% for 2025, in a return to strong growth following three consecutive down years. Strong outings from China's leading Tech and Financial Services brands are a big reason for the rankings' rebound. But brands from all corners of China's brand landscape have found ways to win this year: of the 93 brands that also appeared in last year's ranking, 68 see their brand value grow since.

Tencent retains the number-one spot

With a total value of \$198 billion, Tencent remains number one in this year's Kantar BrandZ China Top 100. This is Tencent's fifth straight year on top as the company continues to unlock growth in both its consumer offerings and its B2B services business. Tencent's 53% brand value increase for 2025 was fuelled by its video, music, gaming, advertising, and AI innovation service offerings.

A diverse top five

Alibaba has edged ahead of Moutai to take back second place in the China rankings this year, while Douyin and Huawei retain their rankings as China's fourth and fifth most valuable brands, respectively. In all, five different brand categories are represented across the China top five.

Seven brands join the Top 100

Three of the seven brands joining the ranking are new, whilst four re-enter having appeared in the China Top 100 at any time pre-2024. Fast Food brand Mixue Bingcheng leads this year's newcomers in the 51st spot. Next, at 61st, is Alibaba Group's high-tech supermarket brand FRESHIPPO (which is being valued as a standalone brand for the first time). Travel Services platform Qunar.com leads the re-entrants at the 78th spot.

Xiaomi leads Top Risers

Xiaomi's remarkable 154% year-on-year brand value growth catapults the brand from 20th to 11th in the China Top 100. Other Top Risers include well-known names such as BYD, Eastroc Beverage, and Huawei.

Strong brands fare well

It has been a good year for large, export-minded Chinese brands – and for strong brands in general. Big Chinese brands grew faster than their smaller ranked counterparts this year, while brands with more overseas exposure grew more than domestically focused brands. Another strong differentiator this year is brand equity: in an uncertain economic environment, growing brands tend to be more Meaningful, Different, and Salient than flat or declining brands.

BRAND VALUE ANALYSIS HIGHLIGHTS

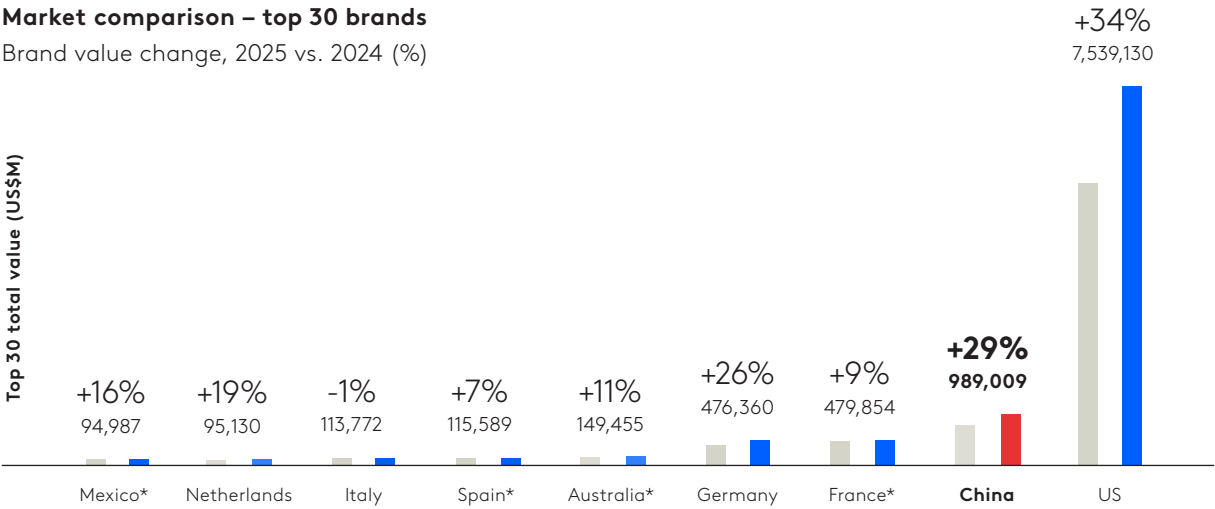
INSIGHTS FROM THE KANTAR BRANDZ CHINA DATA

A standout market

China has been an especially bright star in the Kantar BrandZ universe over the past year. Compared to other recently ranked national markets, the brand value growth rate of the top 30 most valuable Chinese brands is second only to that of the US, surpassing several major European markets like France, Germany, and Italy. These top 30 Chinese brands also had the highest average Meaningful Difference scores out of all recently ranked markets.



Market comparison – top 30 brands
Brand value change, 2025 vs. 2024 (%)



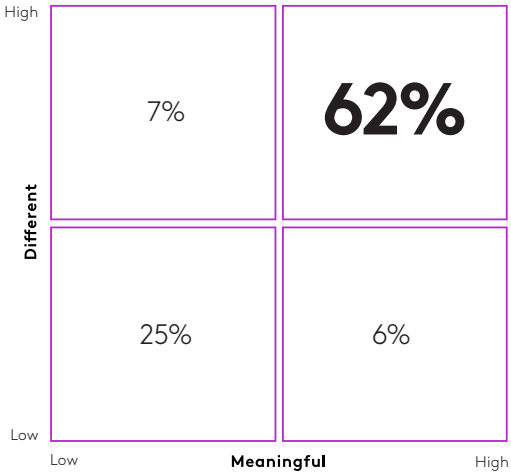
*2024 brand value is calculated by the mean of 2023 and 2025 brand value, due to lack of an actual 2024 brand value



A Meaningfully Different group

Over 60% of the Kantar BrandZ China Top 100 Most Valuable Brands are highly Meaningful and Different – a much higher proportion than what’s found among the wider set of Chinese brands valued by Kantar BrandZ. Very few top 100 brands are highly Meaningful without also being highly Different, or vice versa. And these building blocks of brand equity are as important as ever for business success.

Proportion of most valuable Chinese brands

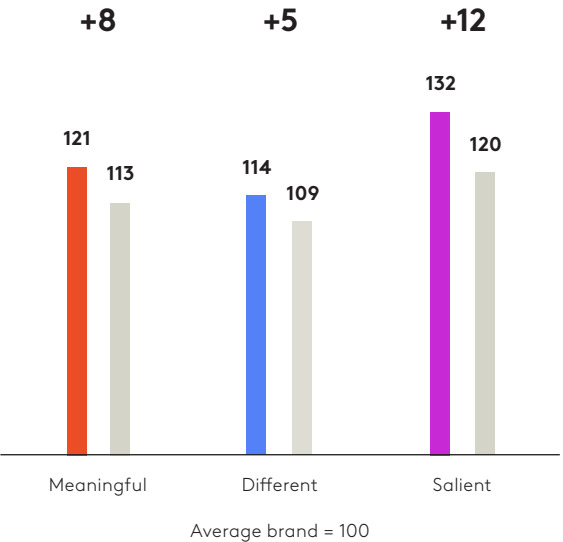


Unlocking powerful growth

Demand Power is the Kantar BrandZ measure of a brand’s ability to predispose more consumers to choose them, thus driving volume share. It is closely related to Meaningful Difference. This year, amongst all China Top 100 brands, those that improved their Demand Power saw 6.7x greater brand value growth.

Brand equity building blocks: MDS

■ Growing ■ Declining



A premiumising cohort

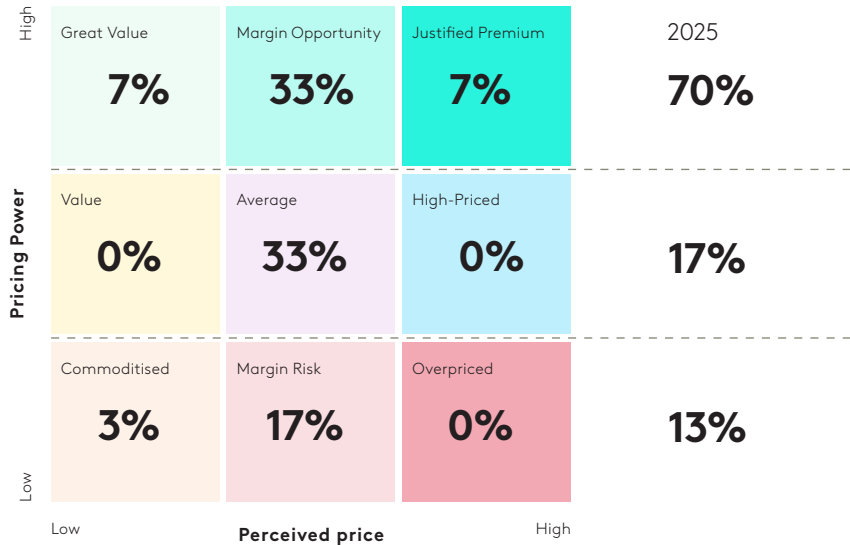
Chinese brands have enhanced their Pricing Power. Pricing Power can be understood as a brand’s ability to set its own prices – prices that consumers are willing to pay, even when they’re otherwise trying to economise, because of that brand’s Meaningfully Different value proposition.

One way that Pricing Power can help brands win is by allowing them to sell a lot of their lower-priced options. These ‘Great Value’ brands are seen as being worth much more than they cost (consumers would have willingly paid even more for them!).

Or, more commonly, Pricing Power can help brands win by allowing them to charge more of a premium. These are the ‘Margin Opportunity’ and ‘Justified Premium’ brands: brands seen as being worth the average or high prices they command relative to competitors. Seventy percent of the China Top 100 now belong to one of these three ‘high Pricing Power’ typologies in Kantar’s Strategic Pricing matrix– up from 65% in 2024. These high Pricing Power brands also grew their brand value faster this year than those with low or average Pricing Power.

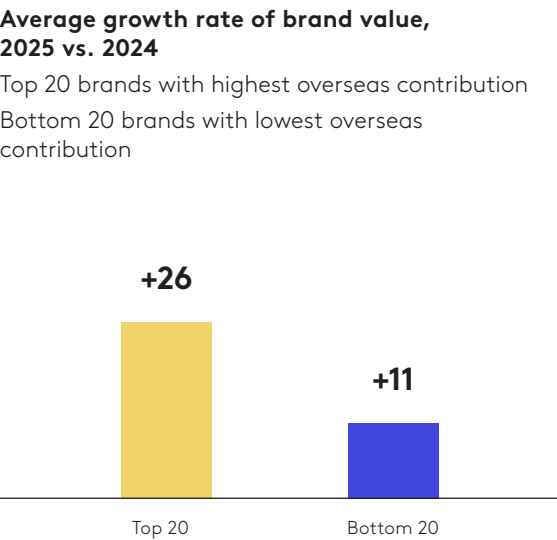


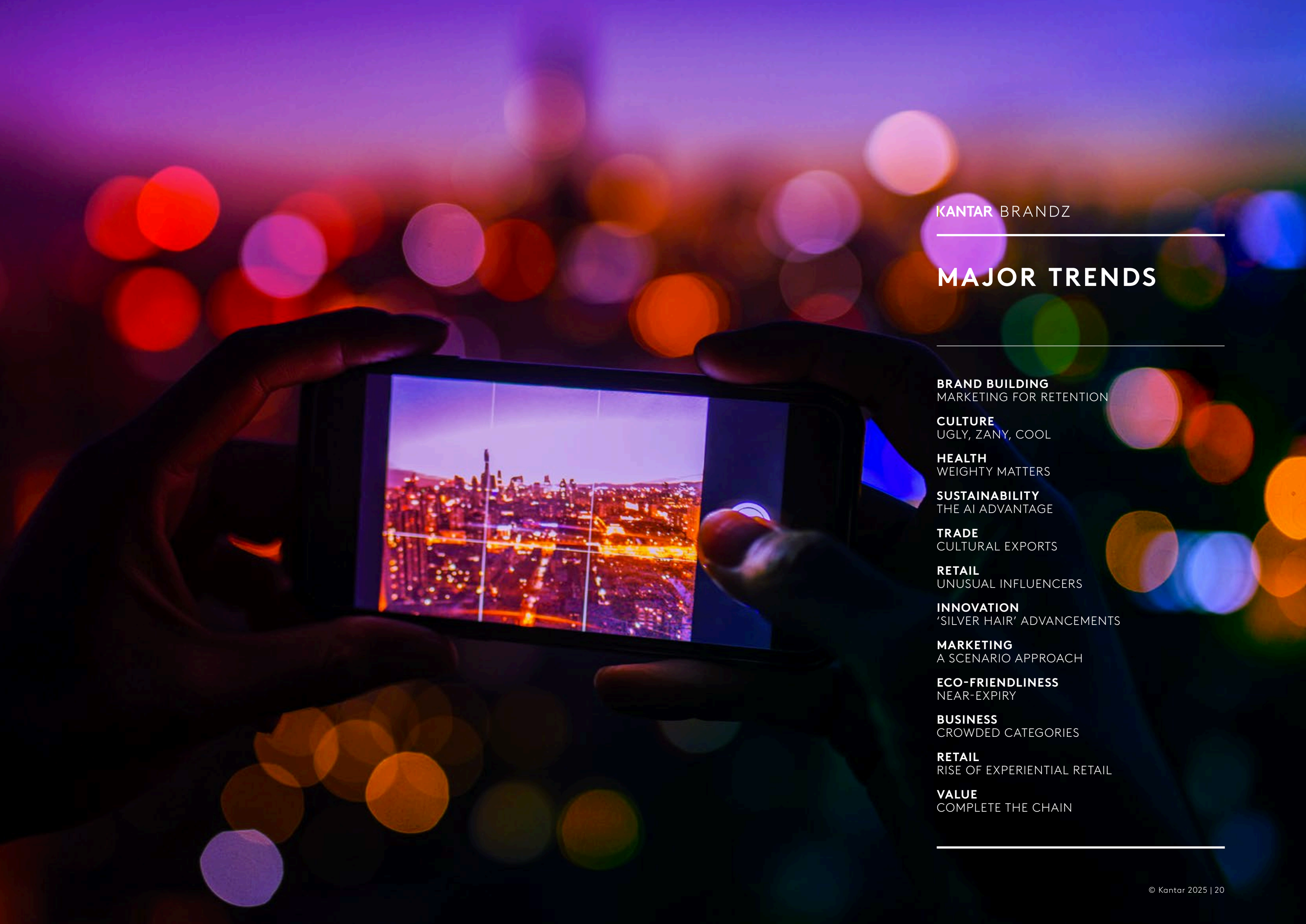
China Top 100 charted against Kantar’s strategic pricing matrix



Going global pays

The overseas contribution of the China Top 100 (a measurement of how much of brands’ value comes from international operations) has grown every year since 2020. It’s the categories with continually improved technology that tend to have higher overseas contribution, including IoT Ecosystem, Energy, Consumer Technology and Services Platforms, Home Appliances, Automotive, and Business Technology and Services Platforms. And in general, brands with more overseas business tend to have higher brand value increases this year.





KANTAR BRANDZ

MAJOR TRENDS

BRAND BUILDING
MARKETING FOR RETENTION

CULTURE
UGLY, ZANY, COOL

HEALTH
WEIGHTY MATTERS

SUSTAINABILITY
THE AI ADVANTAGE

TRADE
CULTURAL EXPORTS

RETAIL
UNUSUAL INFLUENCERS

INNOVATION
'SILVER HAIR' ADVANCEMENTS

MARKETING
A SCENARIO APPROACH

ECO-FRIENDLINESS
NEAR-EXPIRY

BUSINESS
CROWDED CATEGORIES

RETAIL
RISE OF EXPERIENTIAL RETAIL

VALUE
COMPLETE THE CHAIN

BRAND BUILDING

MARKETING FOR RETENTION

Many brands have mastered the art of driving sales of new products on social media. Now they'll have to learn the art of retention. As the domestic Chinese market continues to mature, brand building in the country will need to switch its emphasis. What lies beyond new customer acquisition? What does it take to get people to not just try a product, but continue buying it in perpetuity? That's where the notion of brands as purveyors of experience comes in. To build loyalty, brands need

to offer value propositions that last beyond the first purchase: that means Meaningfully Different experiences and ongoing exposures beyond the point of purchase.

The goal is no longer just visibility or buzz. It's about creating sustained value through brand touchpoints that feel personal, useful, and engaging. Retention depends on how well a brand can show up repeatedly in people's lives – and still feel fresh each time.



CULTURE

UGLY, ZANY, COOL

What to make of Labubu? These furry, mischievous monster dolls have propelled parent brand Pop Mart to approximately \$1.8 billion in annual sales and the title of the world's biggest toy company by market capitalisation. This was not an overnight success. Since 2019, the brand has built up Labubu's creative universe in parallel with Pop Mart's direct sales infrastructure – which by the end of 2024 included 130 Pop Mart stores and 192 vending machines outside of China. Pop Mart also hit on a 'blind box' merchandising concept for Labubu that's perfect for social media content creation. And it carefully seeded Labubu dolls among major global celebrities and KOLs – creating new associations between Labubu and luxury handbags.

But there's something else at play: Labubu first caught on in China as part of a larger 'emotive economy' wave. This term describes offerings that affirm a wider range of human emotions – even those that people hesitate to express. Labubu dolls are cute, but they're also a little bit ugly, scary, mischievous, and zany – which demonstrates to people that they don't have to be perfect to be lovable. That's a big comfort to many young people out there. And it's also proof Chinese brands can afford to go beyond the safe archetypes. And if they're reluctant to do so permanently, they can always just partner with a brand like Labubu for a more limited-time range – as Coca-Cola and Luckin Coffee have both done.



HEALTH

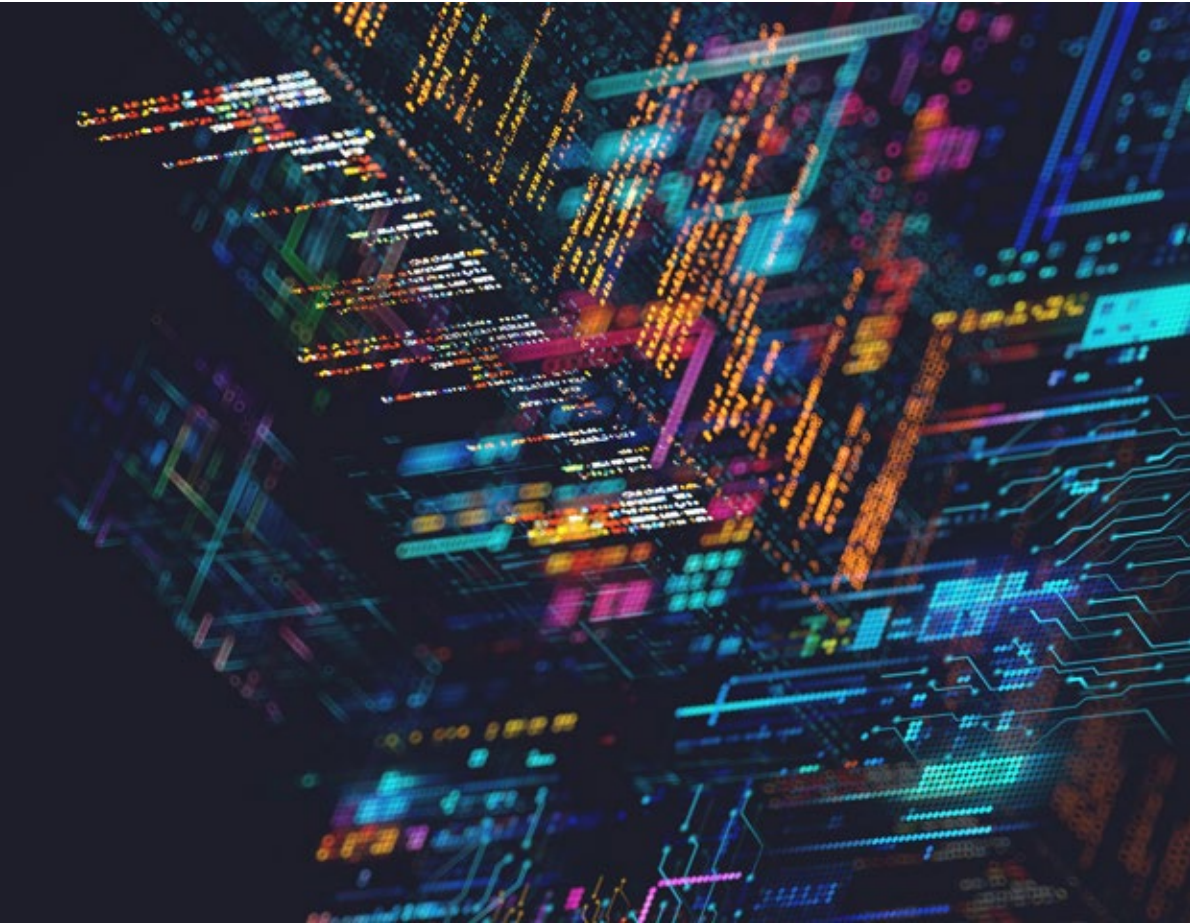
WEIGHTY MATTERS

China's anti-obesity drive is picking up speed. The government has declared 2024–2026 the 'Years of Weight Management' and is promoting better diets, sleep, and exercise every way it can. The goal: reduce obesity rates, which now affect over half of adults and 19% of minors. By April 2025, these goals were formally integrated into the Healthy China 2030 strategy. From now on, every aspect of society is expected to pitch in: that includes healthier canteens, more workplace fitness breaks, community gyms, school diet challenges, and traditional Chinese medicine. It's about shifting overall lifestyle norms, which is why brands and brand advertising are also expected to play a big role. From wearable tech manufacturers to food and beverages players, brands of all stripes are now expected to make a tangible impact. And if they can't? Well, the pharmaceutical industry will be more than happy to step into the gap, now that GLP-1 treatments like Wegovy and Ozempic have received government approval.

SUSTAINABILITY

THE AI ADVANTAGE

Brands are using advanced AI to create more efficient, sustainable industrial practices. If 10 years ago the vision of a ‘sustainable factory’ conjured up solar roofs and wastewater recycling, today it looks more like Xiaomi’s fully autonomous ‘dark factory’. This facility uses AI and the Internet of Things to assemble product components with high energy efficiency and almost no human intervention. A smaller-scale analogue is the sustainable smart home: ecosystems that use AI to coordinate appliances, solar panels, and EV charging to maximise families’ energy self-consumption and minimise grid usage. Haier’s latest refrigerators can even use AI image recognition to flag when food is about to go bad – thus nudging users to reduce food waste.



TRADE

CULTURAL EXPORTS

China’s top exports aren’t all physical goods. Cultural products like *Ne Zha 2*, *Black Wukong*, and bite-sized micro-dramas are spreading fast across Asia and beyond. These soft-power assets signal a shift in how China presents itself. Instead of pandas and palaces, today’s exports feature more emotional, fantastical, and even irreverent imagery. This has benefitted Chinese creators and businesses alike. When consumers associate ‘Brand China’ with a wider range of imagery and emotions, Chinese brands of all types can more easily equip themselves for overseas expansions. China’s cultural rise has created more room for export brands to ‘be themselves’.



RETAIL

UNUSUAL INFLUENCERS

Livestream fatigue is real. Consumers are looking for fresh formats and influencers – and brands are responding. Netizens now readily suggest brands’ future celebrity ambassadors. They are even co-creating new campaigns based on ‘punny’ name associations – as seen in a recent ‘Red vs. Blue vs. Yellow’ celebrity ambassador showdown between Meituan, Ele.me, and JD. Virtual avatars offer another route: always-on, perfectly branded, and never tired. Meanwhile, CEO-influencers provide the thrill of interacting with trusted brand ambassadors who actually have the power to act on consumers’ feedback. And sometimes, these categories overlap – as in the case of JD’s virtual avatar clone of CEO Richard Liu, whose debut last year attracted tens of millions of views and drove ¥50 million (\$336,300 million) in sales.

INNOVATION

‘SILVER HAIR’ ADVANCEMENTS

Dynamism, innovation, and openness to change are typically associated with young people. But these days, China’s aging consumers have become an equally important engine of innovation. For example, a recent study found that people aged 45 to 65 are the biggest group of paying users for China’s new wave of micro-dramas content. Ageing consumers are also the prime customers for a new wave of humanoid home-help robots. And they’re behind the rise of ‘100 yuan a day’ clubhouses – a new service/lifestyle concept where people can eat, exercise, and socialise across multiple mealtimes (in contrast to how other dining establishments have begun hustling customers out the door). Food and beverages brands are innovating with ‘silver-hair’ consumers in mind, too. Players like Danone and Yili are shifting from child-focused product development to more ‘senior nutrition’ offerings. Old age, then, is no longer the domain of the familiar and safe; in China, it’s a new beginning.



MARKETING

A SCENARIO APPROACH

What will Chinese brand advertising look and sound like in the back half of the 2020s? Recent shifts in the automotive category offer an indication. One shift is in the *process* of content creation: AI-generated content now allows brands to test hundreds of messages tailored to different target audiences all aligned to core brand values.

The other shift lies in the *messaging*: previously, Western brands like Mercedes and BMW emphasised abstract ideas like 'luxury' or 'high performance' (as expressed through headline statistics like horsepower

and acceleration). Chinese brands, meanwhile, focussed more on specific innovations and features, but in a very technical way. Now, most have converged on an approach that's specific but human: scenario-based storytelling that shows how car features can solve real-life problems. In terms of ad creative, this means less cinematic drone shots and more relatable imagery. (Think ads showing families going on trips, or showing storage space packed with everyday items.) In short, it's no longer enough to boast about what a brand offering does. Brands need to show how it actually enhances people's lives.



ECO-FRIENDLINESS

NEAR-EXPIRY

As value and sustainability converge, retailers that offer both are finding real momentum. Near-expiry retail has gone mainstream as chains like HotMaxx have built stylish stores around the concept of surplus inventory. In doing so, they have shown that 'discount' doesn't have to mean disorganised chaos: these stores feel clean, curated, and exploration-friendly. At the same time, these formats support national goals around food waste reduction. The success of near-expiry chains also reflects a broader truth: consumers would rather find new ways to save on brands they like than 'trade down' to ones they don't.



BUSINESS

CROWDED CATEGORIES

Many categories became overcrowded with competitors in the first half of the 2020s. From New Energy Vehicles (NEVs) to skincare to soft drinks, startup brands flooded in with trendy features and rapid content-commerce rollouts. But hype is not enough. Many products were built to check boxes – 'sugar free', 'with hyaluronic acid' – without clear positioning. Now comes the shakeout. NEV makers will have to consolidate; many personal brands have shuttered (as indeed they were always designed to do, if they weren't immediate hits). Going forward, the brands that last will be the ones that move beyond feature lists to build more emotional relevance. Functional credentials matter. But feelings matter too.



RETAIL

RISE OF EXPERIENTIAL RETAIL

Chinese malls are changing. First, pandemic vacancies opened the door for new types of tenants. Now, anchor spaces that once went to luxury beauty brands are being reimagined with a diverse array of experiential formats. You'll find Pop Mart toy stores, NEV showrooms, upscale tea bars like CHAGEE, and outdoor gear hubs like Arc'teryx. The logic is simple: young shoppers want what they can't get online. That means experiences, expertise, and physical interaction. For brands, the mall is no longer just a billboard or a sales clearinghouse – it's a lab for new kinds of hands-on storytelling.

VALUE

COMPLETE THE CHAIN

Value deals have moved from 'the bundle' to 'the chain'. Instead of buying a bunch of discounted items in one bundled transaction, consumers can now unlock 'chain deals' that link across categories with each subsequent purchase. Buy a concert ticket and get a dining discount. Visit a museum and unlock shopping rewards. These extended chains blend experience-seeking with product consumption. They're reshaping consumer flow across sectors, to the benefit of wider regional economies (already, Shanghai has been testing the 'chain' model as a formal growth initiative). To scale 'chain commerce' further, there needs to be stronger public-private coordination, more tax incentives, and better tech. But the payoff is clear: more value, more often, in more places – and new alliances between different types of brands.



MARKET INTELLIGENCE

ECONOMY/DEMOGRAPHICS/CONNECTIVITY

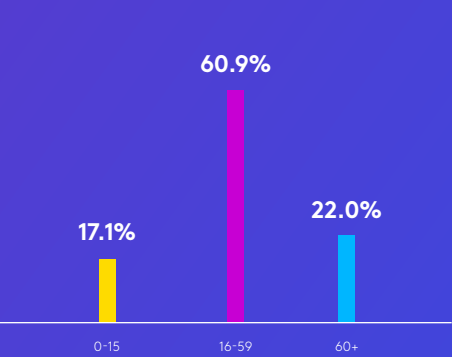
LAND AREA: **9.6 MILLION KM² / 3.7 MILLION MI²**

TOTAL POPULATION: **1.4 BILLION**

URBAN/RURAL POPULATION



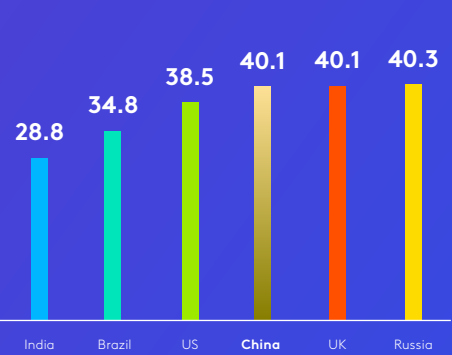
POPULATION BY AGE (YEARS)



POPULATION BY SEX



MEDIAN AGE (YEARS)

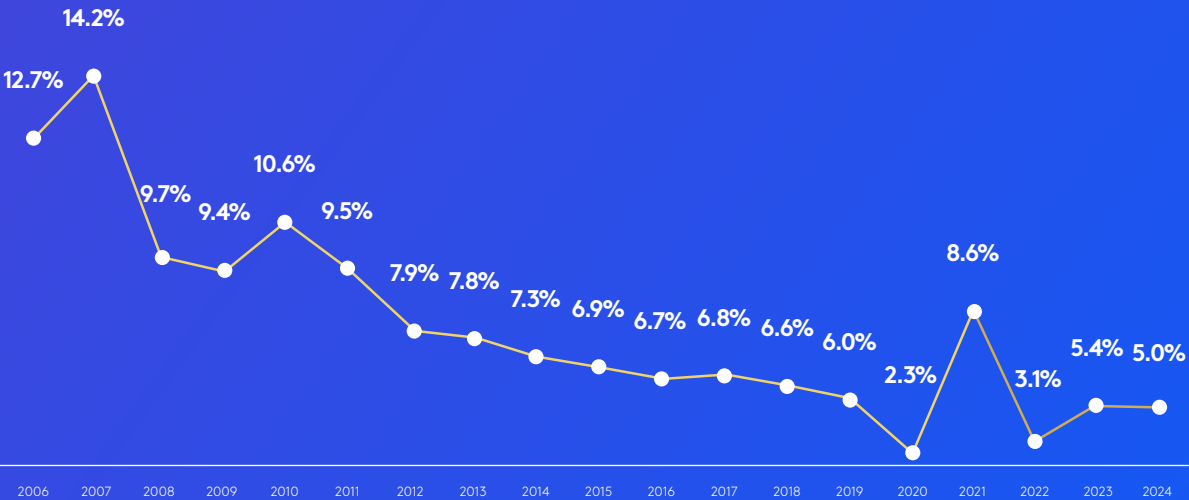


Sources: World Bank, International Monetary Fund, Chinese Government Network, National Bureau of Statistics of China

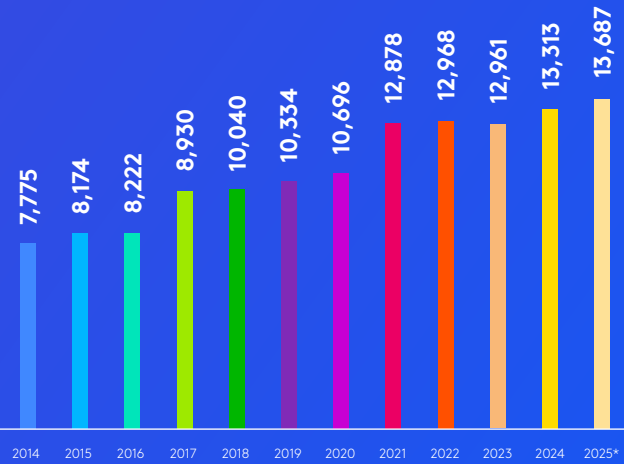
2025 GDP*: **\$19.2 TRILLION**

BELOW THE US AT **\$30.5 TN**
ABOVE JAPAN AT **\$4.2 TN**

2024 GDP RATE OF GROWTH: **5.0%**



GDP PER CAPITA (CURRENT US\$)



*2025 estimated value

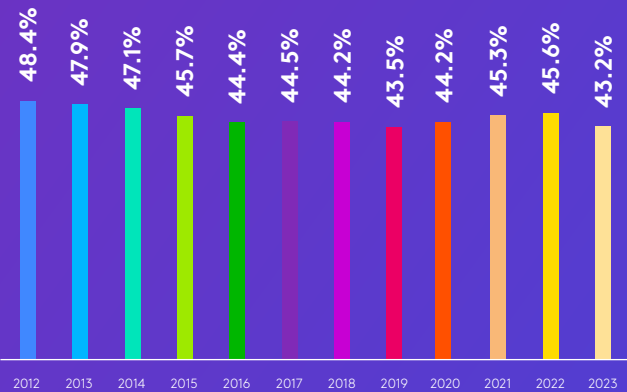
COUNTRY COMPARISON 2025*



MARKET INTELLIGENCE

ECONOMY/DEMOGRAPHICS/CONNECTIVITY

GROSS DOMESTIC SAVING (% OF GDP)



COUNTRY COMPARISON 2023



TOTAL IMPORTS: **\$2.6 TRILLION**

TOTAL EXPORTS: **\$3.5 TRILLION**

TRADE SURPLUS: **\$984 BILLION**

INTERNET

TOTAL INTERNET USERS: **1,108 MILLION**

AS OF DECEMBER 2024



ONLINE VIDEO VIEWERS

1,070 M



ONLINE SHOPPERS

974 M



LIVE STREAMING USERS

878 M



ONLINE MEAL ORDERING USERS

592 M



ONLINE TRAVEL BOOKING USERS

548 M



ONLINE HEALTHCARE USERS

418 M

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- 1

LOOK DEEPER

Macroeconomics is not destiny – not for brands. So don’t let gloomy headlines obscure the more nuanced story that lies beneath, or else you’ll miss out on many paths to growth. For instance: You could accept the headline that Chinese consumers are ‘pulling back’ and ‘trading down’ in 2025. Or you could look closer and see there are actually several consumption stories unfolding: high-income consumers are shifting from investing to spending, showing strong willingness to splurge on certain categories; middle-income consumers prioritise quality; and budget-conscious shoppers seek affordable alternatives.

Which framework offers you more control of your own destiny? The sweeping summary, or the nuanced exploration? The latter – so look past the generalities.
- 2

VALUE HAS CHANGED

That said, the rules of branded business are different now. Mere presence alone (in stores or online) is rarely enough. And while strong product features matter, they can’t guarantee breakthrough growth, especially abroad. Instead, brands must prove their worth more holistically, through functional performance *and* cultural resonance. In short, this means brand building: pairing great products with equally great experiences and communications. It means going to market with propositions that not only work well, but that also make people feel good about choosing them. That’s what value means nowadays.
- 3

THERE’S A RIGHT WAY TO GO ABROAD

When going abroad, localisation isn’t optional. It’s essential. Why? Because overseas consumers won’t buy a product unless they can see how it makes their lives better – and ‘better’ means different things in different places. At the same time, brands still need to anchor back to a consistent, resonant overarching brand identity. If consumers understand the mission and values behind a brand’s products, they’ll be more likely to follow that brand into ‘new spaces’ that *also* relate to this broader identity.
- 4

PURSUE CONSUMER-CENTRIC AI INNOVATION

Even the most behind-the-scenes AI brand tools ultimately have an impact on the end-user. But what are those effects, and how well are they communicated? Does your brand use AI to save people time or money? To bridge language gaps? To match users with more relevant products and content? To support people’s creativity? Their ability to age more gracefully? The answer to these questions will depend on a brand’s category, market, and target demographics. But the point is that all brands need *some* answer for how they’re making AI work for more than just their bottom lines.
- 5

STAY AHEAD OF MEDIA CHANGES

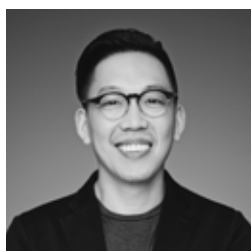
Chinese brands invented content-commerce formats like livestreams and gamified mini-programmes. They have benefitted handsomely from these innovations and will continue to do so, as these formats expand abroad. But in China, the media and ecommerce landscapes are evolving. Performance marketing costs are up; traditional KOLs must work harder for each and every sales conversion. Meanwhile, CEO-influencers, virtual avatars, and niche micro influencers are forging new kinds of connections with viewers. The common thread here is interactivity: brands must shift away from simply *selling* to consumers online and toward *relating* to consumers in multifaceted ways. Livestreams should do more than promote discounts. Instead, they should promote co-creation: solving problems, soliciting feedback, and sharing brand philosophies. Media buys should incorporate more brand-building communications: creative that speaks to brands’ ongoing presence in consumers’ lives beyond the moment of transaction.



THOUGHT LEADERSHIP

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HOW FMCG BRANDS
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COMMUNICATE THEIR
BRAND VALUE
-





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MARKETING THE AI REVOLUTION CHINESE BRANDS LEAD THE WAY

- Discover how **Kantar Live** helps you see the full picture faster. Explore how hybrid qual-quant research technology can accelerate your decision-making and **drive better outcomes**.

An exciting race to the top is now under way among China's emerging – but already powerful – AI platform brands. Internationally, DeepSeek has made the biggest splash with its low-cost large language models. But at home in China, DeepSeek faces strong competition from established players like Tencent, ByteDance, and Baidu – not to mention other disruptive startups.

It's a thrilling business story, with major shifts in competitive momentum arriving nearly every week. But as marketers, it is also important to step back and holistically assess how the industry has changed: how China's AI boom has changed brand building *regardless* of which AI engine is on top in a given week. For indeed, AI has already had a huge impact on nearly every corner of our industry, from strategic planning and content creation to 'finding new space' abroad.

A strategic revamp

In category after category, AI-driven insights are improving brand strategies by providing faster and more accurate consumer feedback. At Kantar, for example, our Kantar Live (ART. AI) platform lets brands quickly test how people react to PR campaigns – as proven out by our successful collaborations with brands from a variety of sectors, including Big Tech and automotive. What we found was that AI feedback allows brands to swiftly adjust their PR messaging to reach maximum effectiveness – all while providing a big improvement over traditional concept testing timelines.

And that's just one example of AI's impact on strategic insights and planning. There are plenty more. Take the realm of consumer research, where qualitative studies are now frequently paired with AI-powered quantitative tracking through the likes of Kantar Live. This combination allows brands to leave no stone unturned. Teams can not only capture 'big-picture headlines' about a brand's overall reputation, but also surface those 'small but mighty' insights that often prove so useful – e.g., about particular features or tools that resonate well with consumers.

These smaller, subtler signals are often the key to unlocking breakthrough innovation. They allow teams to uncover specific, unmet consumer needs and then develop unique product features around them. To name one example: a globally renowned brand conducted a user validation study through Kantar Live for a new air purifier geared at pet owners. After its launch, the product achieved impressive sales results.





More impactful social media

Meanwhile, AI has also driven big changes in how brands approach creative content, especially for social media. Consider how automotive brands now use AI to illustrate a wide array of specific product innovations on their Xiaohongshu and Douyin accounts. That’s a big change from their previous social media playbook, which saw them recycling a smaller collection of more ‘general’ brand imagery to little positive effect.

Indeed, in category after category, we’ve seen a strong uptick in the use of official brand accounts on social media. AI has played a big role in this shift. After all, AI has not only made it easier to generate official social media account content; it has *also* made it easier for brands to build that content around fresh, targetted consumer insights.

User-generated content (UGC) is another area that has benefitted from the rise of generative AI – in a way that ultimately benefits brands just as much as it does ordinary social media users. Whether sponsored or ‘earned’, UGC that expresses a positive view of a brand’s offerings can be a huge boon for business. This is especially the case when that content is effective and engaging. The problem was that until recently, creating strong content was hard and relentless work for young netizens – leading to a lot of creator burnout, and a weaker influencer ecosystem overall.

Now, however, users can take advantage of new, personalised tools from platforms like Hunyuan-T1, Tencent’s latest AI reasoning model. These tools are explicitly built with social media UGC in mind. As a result, it has become faster and easier than ever for people to create memorable social media posts, all while retaining their own distinctive voices. AI’s rise, then, has been a big relief for creators – and for brands, too, thanks to how it’s shored up the talent pool of potential UGC collaborators.

Going abroad

As it becomes easier to tailor AI tools to specific user groups, AI should also become a big help to Chinese brands expanding abroad. Already, platforms like ChatGPT and DeepSeek have helped Chinese brands translate market research and creative copy into local languages overseas. At the same time, these platforms can also surface key cultural insights to inform strategic planning: insights, for instance, about how overseas consumers (and coworkers) might differ from their domestic Chinese counterparts. These capabilities should only improve once AI agents gain the ability to discern – and then ‘train on’ – the most accurate information sources for each specific market (thus alleviating earlier accuracy concerns).

There is understandably a lot of excitement in the marketplace around this new crop of homegrown Chinese AI tools. Trained on some of the world’s richest datasets, they have the potential to meet global consumers’ needs in exciting, unprecedented ways. And they can do just as much to meet brand marketers’ needs as well – indeed, they already are.



KANTAR

AI.NET

Including AI Hub, Kantar Live,
Ecosystem.AI

Kantar, as a global leader in data insights and strategic consulting, embraces AI for brand innovation and growth. Our AI Hub in China advances automation and intelligence, enhancing service capabilities. KMP.AI, powered by 40 years of Kantar insights, streamlines report summarisation to boost efficiency and cut costs. Kantar Live (ART.AI) offers real-time, detailed feedback to accelerate innovation. Ecosystem.AI uses social media data to improve the precision of insights.

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KNOW YOUR MARKET

THE IMPORTANCE OF BEING LOCALLY RELEVANT

► Our strategic consultants around the world partner with our clients to inspire actionable solutions that drive brand growth. Learn more about **optimising your brand and retail strategy using digital and social data to your advantage**, with help from Kantar.

I remember when international companies first tried to expand into China in the early 2000s. Despite ample advertising spends, many struggled thanks to their unfamiliarity with China’s market dynamics. As marketing professionals, we kept telling international brands that ‘China’s market dynamics were complex and layered, and that China’s consumer base was more diverse and sophisticated than they realised. Not everyone listened – but the most successful brands did.



Now, in a full-circle sign of just how far China’s economic development has come, we are having similar conversations with *Chinese* brands about their plans to expand into overseas markets. If, in the past, we were saying, ‘Be careful – what sold well in Europe may not sell much in China’, nowadays the script is flipped to, ‘What sells in China might not perform as well in other countries – at least not without some modifications’.

In both cases, our aim in giving this advice is not to be discouraging, but rather to inspire new ways of thinking. When brands take the time to understand consumer preferences and trends in a new target market, they can uncover fresh insights that apply well beyond the marketing sphere – leading to exciting new innovations and range extensions, sometimes with global relevance.

Here, then, are three big lessons from when international brands tried to expand into China. They still apply to Chinese brands moving abroad today:



01

Adapt to cultural differences

Cultural missteps can be costly. I remember working with a prominent global deodorant brand hoping to enter China. Early on, we had to explain to the Europeans that their product name could not include a direct translation of the term ‘de-odour’, but instead needed to anchor on ‘fragrance enhancement’. Why? Because body odour is not a prevailing biological issue among Chinese consumers – and moreover, even in the rare case where someone did have a body odour issue, it would be taboo to speak about it. This was more than just a language issue; it was a core cultural discrepancy that the deodorant brand could not afford to ignore.

In this spirit, Chinese brands should invest in understanding cultural nuances up front. That means ensuring accurate translations and culturally appropriate marketing strategies when entering other markets. From there, brands should reflect on any wider learnings or insights that arise from these marketing efforts – with an eye toward future innovations.

02

Be prepared for a different pace of change

The Chinese market is known for its rapid pace of change. Back in the 2000s, international companies took a while to adapt to this fact.

Chinese companies, by contrast, have long needed to function with a high degree of urgency: the better to deal with constantly new domestic competitors and ever-shifting consumer habits.

Mostly, this ability to go *fast* has been a benefit overseas, as it has helped Chinese companies to respond quickly to evolving market conditions abroad.

But on the other hand, Chinese brands sometimes miss those instances when it pays to *slow down* when operating abroad. For instance, there are markets in which market changes and consumer trends move more deliberately than they do in China. In these markets, patience often comes with its own rewards.

This principle even extends to issues like work culture. In some markets, pushing workers too hard too fast may backfire on a brand’s larger image. For example, when Chinese technology companies tried to export their ‘996’ working culture to their Singapore offices years ago, it touched off waves of anti-overtime sentiment that these brands then had to work to contain – a real distraction.

03

Balance autonomy and control

Striking the right balance between local autonomy and central headquarters control is a constant challenge for brands abroad, then as now.

These days, Chinese companies increasingly see the benefits of localisation in overseas markets. As a result, this question of autonomy versus control has moved from being a strategy management-level concern to encompassing many different facets of business execution, including:

- What is the most suitable brand management system?
- How should brands manage marketing budget between HQ and local teams?
- What is the best product innovation and launch planning system?
- Who is responsible for which parts of the product planning stages?

International brands working in China can provide a good starting point for thinking these issues through. They tend to grant substantial autonomy to local units while maintaining centralised governance – all in a way that allows them to manage rapid changes effectively.

Ultimately, any division of responsibility must allow for quick decision making while maintaining consistency with a brand’s values and goals. Beyond this, there is no one-size-fits-all answer. Instead, brands must take multiple factors into consideration, including company management style, local dynamics, industry, and category.

Chinese brands have an exciting journey ahead of them. And while they should hold fast to their core values, they also shouldn’t be afraid to change and adapt around what they discover in their ventures abroad.

KANTAR

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Our new evidence-based framework
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BLUEPRINT
FOR BRAND
GROWTH

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BRAND VALUATION FROM KANTAR

There is more to Brand Valuation than rankings

By connecting brand equity to dollars, we can help you address multiple strategic questions via ad hoc Brand Valuation, depending on your needs:

- What is the value of my brand and how can I increase it, creating long-term value for my business?
- What is the impact of brand-related investments on delivering incremental brand value (return on marketing investment)?
- How can I optimise the value of my brand portfolio via clear brand architecture?
- What is the value of sponsorship, how much is it increasing my brand value?
- What is my brand's endorsement worth, what should I charge for licensing?

Brand Valuation helps bring insights and marketing into the boardroom using a financially sound, brand-specific, and customer-centric approach.

Our methodology is unique in leveraging quantitative insights from real customers based on Kantar's Meaningful Different and Salient framework, which has a proven link to revenue growth.

The Kantar BrandZ methodology conforms to the US GAAP and International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS) and has withstood scrutiny from European tax authorities. It is certified by the Marketing Accountability Standards Board (MASB) and compliant with ISO 10668 for Brand Valuation.



To find out more: kantar.com/expertise/brand-growth/brand-valuation
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STRONG GLOBAL CONNECTIONS

LEARNING FROM CHINESE CONSUMER TECH BRANDS

► We empower Chinese brands to pinpoint high-value targets and unlock growth potential. Helping them to utilise our **Technology Panel** insights is one aspect to achieving this.

Chinese consumer technology brands have succeeded abroad *as brands* in ways that many other Chinese business sectors have not yet accomplished. They have done so not only by offering affordable products, but also by creating deeper consumer value.

What actionable lessons can other Chinese businesses learn from these brands? Four case studies suggest some...



Transsion – the Africa advantage

Transsion is one of the world’s leading smartphone brands, originating from the African market and gradually expanding into other emerging markets such as India and Southeast Asia. Transsion is committed to providing competitive products in these high-growth developing markets to meet user needs.

Its flagship brand, TECNO, has grown stunningly over the past decade, becoming the top-selling smartphone brand in Africa.

Transsion achieved this by smartly tailoring its products to local needs. For example, it has developed unique camera software tuned for darker skin tones. And it has rolled out keyboard and voice recognition features designed with Africa’s many languages in mind.

Some of Transsion’s phones allow for up to four SIM cards, in recognition of how African users often switch networks to access better deals. The long battery life of its handsets is another selling point in a region with unreliable electricity.

But hardware alone is not enough to explain Transsion’s success. Transsion has also built a digital ecosystem tailored to African culture. Its music service, Boomplay, attracts 94 million users each month and offers mostly local music. And PalmPay, its payment app, is pre-installed on millions of Transsion phones every year.

Marketing has also played a key role in Transsion’s localised rise. Its three main brands – itel, TECNO, and Infinix – carefully target different customer segments. They also advertise heavily in public spaces and sponsor major events like the African Cup of Nations – all while partnering with local influencers that other competitors overlook. Just as crucially, their communications are all carefully adapted for each country, as opposed to being broadly applied in a ‘one size fits all’ way.

Additionally, Transsion’s strong local retail partnerships and localised after-sales support network help it retain consumers long after their first purchase. And all of these innovations have been supported by a strong consumer insights engine. Looking ahead, Transsion hopes to replicate this success in South Asia and the Middle East.



Huawei – emotive premiumisation

Huawei, long known in China for its premium products, has most recently won attention for its boundary-pushing form factors. For instance, its Mate XT model is the world’s first mass-produced tri-fold phone. With a starting price of ¥19,999, it appeals to business users looking for cutting-edge technology and a prestigious image.

Indeed, ‘premium’ and ‘prestige’ are now important brand platforms for Huawei more broadly – with a new emphasis on premium *in-house*. These technologies include HarmonyOS, Kirin chips, and its XMAGE imaging system. Huawei’s Harmony software also connects phones, cars, and other smart devices via a single intuitive system, thus encouraging customer loyalty.

After emerging from years of regulatory challenges abroad, Huawei has now shifted its global marketing toward emphasising emotional connection, rather than focusing more single-mindedly on technical features.

For example, Huawei’s former partnership with Leica used to dominate the brand’s messaging around camera features and picture taking. Today, Huawei has moved on to promoting XMAGE, its fully in-house imaging platform. And it’s doing so with a different, more holistic view of ‘superiority’. Yes, XMAGE relies on advanced, proprietary AI and sensors to deliver pictures with richer, more natural colours. But crucially, Huawei markets this functionality not merely as a technical achievement, but as a way to create photographs with ‘emotional realism’: images that feel rich and human, rather than sterile and overly processed.

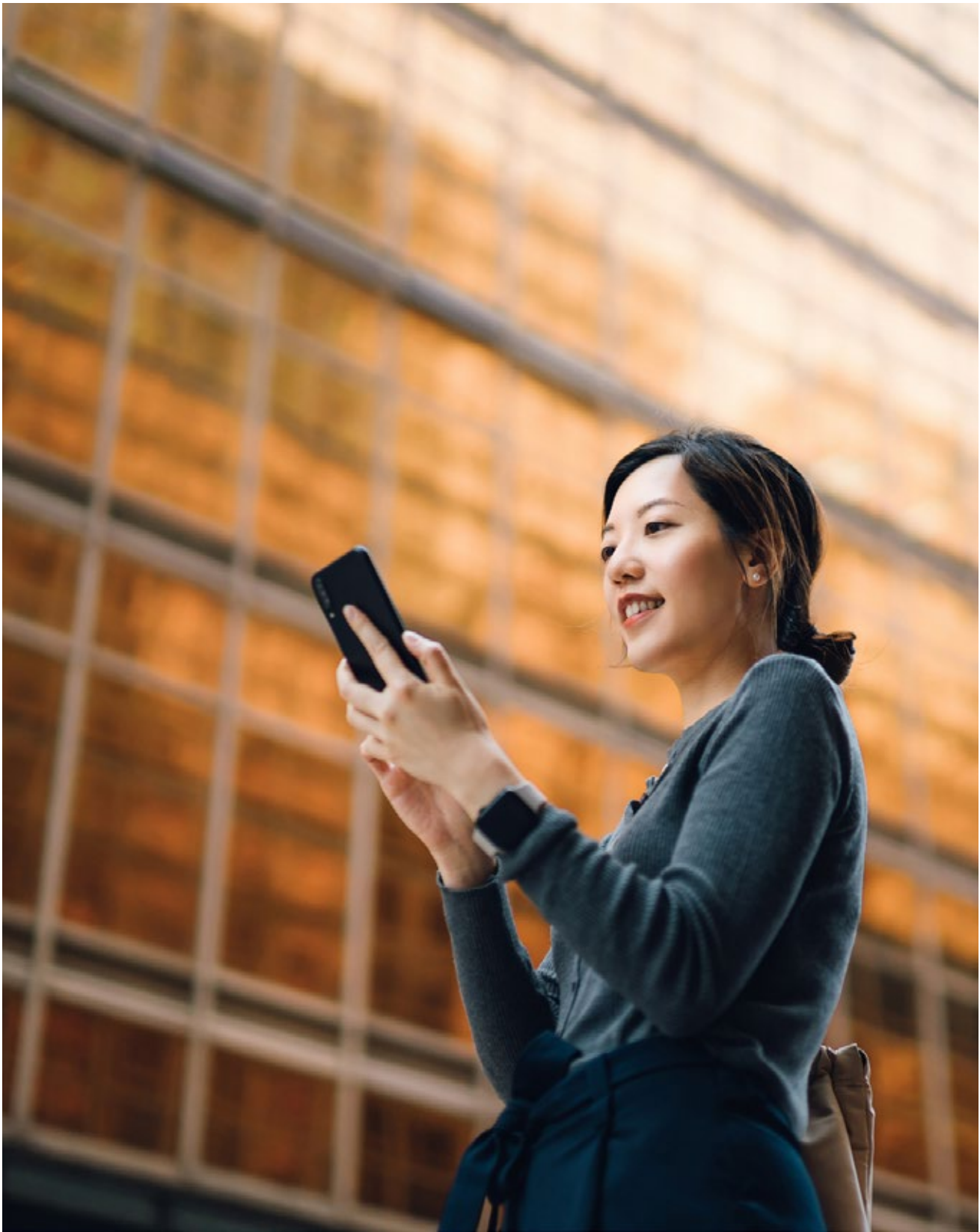


Xiaomi – the ecosystem effect

Xiaomi, meanwhile, has built one of the world’s largest consumer IoT systems around its smartphones. This ecosystem now includes smart home devices, wearables, and – perhaps most unusually – electric vehicles. One constant? Xiaomi’s self-developed software, HyperOS, which uses AI features to create seamless connections between devices.

These brand extensions (especially in the auto space) have had a positive halo effect on Xiaomi’s brand reputation as a smartphone manufacturer. As a result, Xiaomi can now leverage this innovative image to sell more premium handsets.

Models like the Xiaomi 15 Ultra, developed with Leica, have helped the brand move beyond its budget roots. At the same time, Xiaomi’s Redmi series continues to offer the affordable options that have proven so popular in markets like India and Southeast Asia. It’s a true range play – which makes sense for such a savvy ‘ecosystem player’.



OPPO – thinking ‘glocal’

OPPO, vivo, and Realme have captured a large share of India’s massive national market, while also expanding successfully elsewhere. OPPO has carefully structured its operations to remain in compliance with India’s regulations and local consumer sentiment – including opening a ‘superfactory’ in Uttar Pradesh.

This is just one way that OPPO carefully adapts its phones for local markets. It has also developed better mobile signals for Indonesia, rolled out beauty filters tuned for Malaysia, unveiled features designed for group photography in Africa, and enhanced waterproofing specs for Pakistan.



The common thread among these brands is their willingness to venture abroad and adapt carefully to consumer needs. With every year that passes, low prices matter less to their global success. Instead, these brands can now call upon more emotional connections to win the day – connections that have been forged via human-centric innovations and locally attuned marketing alike.

DIGITAL ANALYTICS (DX)

Discover what others cannot.
At speed, with scale.

Dx Analytics helps clients discover what others cannot through the use of search, social, and digital analytics data at scale (in any market, in any language) and speed (as soon as one week). We are helping brands futureproof innovation, refine their brand blueprint, and master digital marketing. Dx Analytics can provide insight on:

1. **Future Proofing:** Identifying trends and growth opportunities for innovation
2. **Brand Blueprint:** Understanding people better and connecting to their moments of truth
3. **Digital Mastery:** Boosting digital presence and performance with best-practice digital marketing and analytics support



Dx Analytics



KANTAR

LINK

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- Industry leading know-how, expert support, technology, and brand measurement to drive genuine impact

Connect your creativity to commercial outcomes.

Unlock your ads potential at: kantar.com/marketplace



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CHANGING LANES

CHINESE AUTO BRANDS

- Leverage Kantar’s auto solutions to drive your brand growth in the dynamic market through **automotive & mobility research, data, insights, and consulting**. Understand customers, explore market opportunities, and market precisely.

Chinese brands are at the forefront of a revolution in automotive brand building. In the past, car brands emphasised driving performance and exterior styling in their quests for Meaningful Difference. Now the focus has shifted toward high-tech cabin features and everyday experiences.



In other words, what matters most in 2025 is not a car’s horsepower or acceleration, but rather how well it can provide a comfortable and feature-rich driving *experience*. It’s a shift that’s inseparable from the rise of electrification: by doing away with combustion engines, EVs have freed up more cabin space for passenger amenities.

Today, Chinese brands like BYD, Chery, Li Auto, AITO, and Xiaomi are defining a new kind of ‘premium’ driving *experience* at home and abroad. In the Chinese market especially, cars are now seen as more than just transportation: they have become adaptive mobile living spaces built to support daily life.



Some of the best recent Chinese auto ads have illustrated this concept. Li Auto, for example, regularly promotes its vehicles as family-friendly spaces. Its commercials position the brand as a tool for simplifying families’ lives – both on-road and off. One recent spot highlighted how a Li Auto model’s reclining seats can transform into beds for overnight trips, thus making family travel easier and more comfortable while reducing the need for hotel bookings.

You can expect to see more messaging in this vein going forward. Whereas car ads once placed vehicles in extreme situations – speeding through the desert, say, or down a remote mountain road – now the focus is on the everyday. It’s about showing how technology can help people get the most out of common, relatable situations: family trips, urban commuting, and (less extreme) outdoor adventures.

Notably, software innovations have proven just as important to highlight in these narratives as hardware specs. That’s because software innovations are at the heart of popular features such as driver-assistance systems, adaptive suspensions, and infotainment displays.



Focus on the human

The best of these marketing scenarios are aspirational and human-centric. They build emotional connections while clearly demonstrating practical benefits. For instance, one campaign shows drivers instructing their vehicles to ‘go home’ after work – letting the drivers unwind while their vehicles’ Level 2 autonomous driving systems handle the evening commute. It’s an appealing, empathetic pitch: after all, what driver wouldn’t want to be taken care of like that after a long day at the office?

The shift toward ‘experiences’ has changed auto marketing in other ways, too. At multiple points along the path to purchase, Chinese brands have now set up immersive opportunities for buyers to interact with their vehicles.

‘Immersion’ could mean setting up showrooms or booths in busy shopping malls, thus giving consumers a more convenient way to experience the cars directly. It could also mean lending vehicles to potential customers for several days at a time, so that they can undertake a more thorough exploration of a car’s new features. Virtual and augmented reality technology offer another useful route for demonstrating value – helping buyers not just understand high-tech car functionalities but *visualise* and *experience* them.

Auto brands have also revamped their use of social media. The goal is for to become a more constant presence in consumers’ lives – rather than only rolling out campaigns alongside the launch of a new car model, as was once standard practice.

To accomplish this ‘social shift’, most brands now collaborate with Key Opinion Leaders and Key Opinion Consumers on social media year-round. These influencers produce test-drive videos, explain car features, and share lifestyle experiences – all in a friendly, informal way.

At the same time, Chinese brands have begun to use their corporate executives as official ambassadors on sites like Douyin and Xiaohongshu. In these contexts, executives can serve as a source of authority and transparency, but also as a human link between a brand and the public.

In sum, even as Chinese car factories roll out increasingly advanced machines at unbeatable prices, automotive brand building has become anything *but* mechanical. Instead, Chinese brands are marrying human-centric functional innovations with empathetic communications – the better to inspire a new, more experience-focussed generation of car buyers.





KANTAR

MDX

Power your growth

We live in an 'experience economy' that offers unique economic opportunities. Experiences are the single most important driver of business growth as evidenced by Kantar data:

- 75% of brand growth is driven by product and service experiences
- Brands that improve their experience are 2.5x more likely to grow

MDX is set to disrupt and revolutionise customer experience by focusing on creating meaningful and unique interactions. **MDX** builds loyalty among existing customers generating value today *and* grows your brand by attracting new customers through building predisposition.



Download our free booklet to discover how to power growth through Meaningfully Different Experiences

KANTAR

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TRUE CONNECTION

HOW FMCG BRANDS LEVERAGE SOCIAL MEDIA TO COMMUNICATE THEIR BRAND VALUE

► Explore in full **Kantar Media Reactions 2024: Moving at the speed of culture** for the latest consumer marketing trends. **The Blueprint for Brand Growth** will then help you to leverage these in practice.

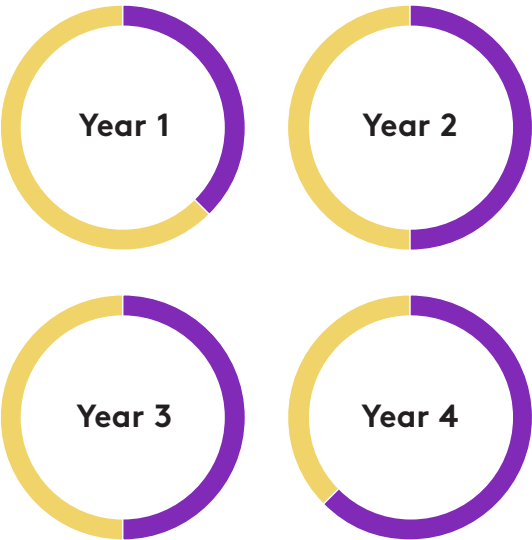
Performance marketing is becoming less cost-effective in the Chinese market. Customer acquisition costs are rising, but sales growth isn't keeping pace – to the point where today, Kantar's brand database reveals that as brands spend more on performance advertising, their base sales actually *decline*.

In reaction to this trend, businesses have increasingly returned to traditional brand building methods: that is, using high-quality content to communicate value. But they're doing so through a new medium – social media.

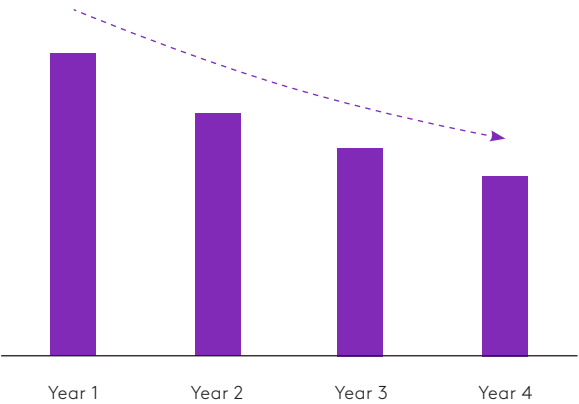


Market spend

■ Brand building ■ Performance



Decline in base sales



Even relative to five years ago, social media has become especially appealing as a marketing channel. That’s because China’s social media landscape now includes more varied and innovative formats than ever before. FMCG brands, in particular, prefer social media for the way it can ‘activate’ marketing concepts in exciting and experiential ways – with each social platform offering its own unique qualities and capabilities in this regard.

No matter the platform, the ultimate goal for brands in 2025 is to create social media content that resonates deeply with consumers. The aim is no longer merely driving traffic, but clearly communicating a brand’s holistic value proposition in an exciting way, while also providing a convenient ‘click to buy’ path for immediate sales conversions that may come a brand’s way (for even though pure performance marketing is no longer the best route, brands should still aim to be more present at any potential purchase moments).

How can this all be accomplished in practice? Here are three brands that have found success:

Mengniu – unlocking smart IP synergies

In early 2025, Mengniu provided a masterclass in how to leverage the success of a popular IP property – in this case, the film *Ne Zha 2*. As the movie began its climb toward \$2 billion at the global box office, Mengniu promptly launched related creative short videos, social media exclusive ‘red envelopes’, and branded emoticons, creating substantial social media buzz. These novel and interesting activations stimulated consumers’ desire to share *Ne Zha* content with friends – which meant that people were actively spreading Mengniu’s brand message on social media too. Ultimately, these activations not only achieved significant sales growth, but also reinforced Mengniu’s brand message of ‘Born to Excel’.



Genki Forest – user-generated content done right

Genki Forest launched the ‘zero sugar inspiration recipes’ topic on Xiaohongshu by inviting small and medium-sized Key Opinion Consumers to create innovative new drink combinations using the brand’s ‘better for you’ soft drinks. To accomplish this, Genki Forest provided content templates to a wide variety of creators. Then it selected some of the highest-quality user-generated content to use as official brand advertisements. The result? Reduced creative production costs and enhanced authenticity. Most importantly, Genki Forest’s messaging around its ‘zero sugar’ selling point became more engaging and convincing, thereby increasing consumers’ purchase intentions.



Master Kong – engaging the middle class

In its bid to grow its share of the competitive instant noodle market, Master Kong chose a strategy focused on appealing to China’s growing white-collar middle class. Recognising that these consumers sought premium quality, Master Kong introduced a high-end Royal Feast range of instant noodles. These noodles featured real ingredients, thick-cut meat, and a refined dining experience. To market this innovation, the brand then selected Key Opinion Leaders (KOLs) closely aligned with its ‘serious and uncompromising’ image. Through these KOLs’ associated video ads, live streaming, and social media discussions, Master Kong quickly attracted consumers who appreciated Royal Feast’s more gourmet appeal.

In the past, reputational concerns sometimes scared brands away from social media: Would they lose control of the message? Would these platforms really be brand-safe? And would consumers really want to hear from official brand accounts? Or was KOL-led performance marketing still the only social media format that could work?

Today, the path forward is clear: consumer attitudes have shifted to the point where it now makes sense or brands to embrace a wide variety of social media marketing formats. For instance, the Kantar Media Reactions 2024 report shows that consumers increasingly trust – and are thus open to being influenced by – content from official brand accounts.

Ultimately, and as our three examples show, brands have much to look forward to now that the performance marketing bubble has deflated. They can use their social media accounts in impactful new ways, launching new products and promotional videos via direct interaction with consumers. In the process, brands can more clearly communicate the value they create for consumers and build stronger relationships with their audience – while still boosting sales in the marketplace.





MOST VALUABLE CHINESE BRANDS

- 50 - TOP 100 MOST VALUABLE
CHINESE BRANDS
 - 52 - NEWCOMERS
 - 54 - TOP RISERS
-



2025 MOST VALUABLE CHINESE BRANDS

Rank	Brand	Brand value (US\$M)	% Brand value change vs 2024	Category	Rank change vs 2024
1	TENCENT ¹	197,991	53%	Business Technology and Services Platforms / Media and Entertainment	0
2	ALIBABA ²	84,352	23%	Retail	1
3	MOUTAI	80,023	-8%	Alcohol	-1
4	DOUYIN	76,200	34%	Media and Entertainment	0
5	HUAWEI	64,152	56%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	0
6	HAIER	47,769	47%	IoT Ecosystem	1
7	CHINA MOBILE	41,078	16%	Telecom Providers	-1
8	ICBC	38,302	34%	Financial Services	0
9	PING AN	29,640	44%	Financial Services	0
10	MEITUAN	29,328	54%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	2
11	XIAOMI	28,150	154%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	9
12	AGRICULTURAL BANK OF CHINA	27,307	39%	Financial Services	-1
13	CHINA CONSTRUCTION BANK	21,114	38%	Financial Services	3
14	CHINA LIFE	20,721	40%	Financial Services	3
15	JD ³	20,224	16%	Retail	-1
16	PINDUODUO	20,142	-1%	Retail	-6
17	BANK OF CHINA	18,618	31%	Financial Services	1
18	BYD	17,164	78%	Automotive	6
19	NONGFU SPRING	15,075	-20%	Food and Beverages	-6
20	CHINA MERCHANTS BANK	13,892	35%	Financial Services	3
21	CHINA TELECOM	13,605	21%	Telecom Providers	-2
22	SHEIN	12,193	-24%	Apparel	-7
23	SINOPEC	11,373	9%	Energy	-1
24	YILI	11,081	6%	Food and Beverages	-3
25	NETEASE	8,783	0%	Media and Entertainment	0

Rank	Brand	Brand value (US\$M)	% Brand value change vs 2024	Category	Rank change vs 2024
26	CNPC	8,684	3%	Energy	2
27	BAIDU	8,350	4%	Media and Entertainment	2
28	KUAISHOU	8,072	-6%	Media and Entertainment	-1
29	WU LIANG YE	7,921	-9%	Alcohol	-3
30	SF EXPRESS	7,705	3%	Logistics	0
31	XIAOHONGSHU	7,604	4%	Media and Entertainment	0
32	MIDEA	7,598	45%	Home Appliances	3
33	TOUTIAO	7,277	16%	Media and Entertainment	0
34	VIVO	5,989	11%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	0
35	HADAY	5,595	19%	Food and Beverages	3
36	CTRIP	5,586	49%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	10
37	CPIC	5,371	38%	Financial Services	7
38	AIR CHINA	5,288	5%	Travel Services	-1
39	BANK OF COMMUNICATIONS	5,120	28%	Financial Services	2
40	NATIONAL CELLAR 1573	5,087	-22%	Alcohol	-8
41	MENGNIU	4,767	-7%	Food and Beverages	-5
42	IFLYTEK	4,762	2%	Business Technology and Services Platforms	-3
43	LENOVO	4,262	11%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	2
44	EASTROC BEVERAGE	4,218	73%	Food and Beverages	25
45	CHINA SOUTHERN AIRLINES	4,208	7%	Travel Services	-3
46	ELE.ME	4,178	29%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	5
47	CHOW TAI FOOK	4,129	-8%	Retail	-7
48	DIANPING	4,077	54%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	14
49	DIDI CHUXING	4,048	9%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	-2
50	GREE	3,973	33%	Home Appliances	7

¹Tencent brand value includes QQ, QQ Music, WeChat, Tencent Music, WeSing, WeChat Pay, WeBank, v.qq.com, and Tencent Cloud

Tencent brand value derives from both Media & Entertainment and Business Technology & Services Platforms

²Alibaba brand value includes Alibaba Cloud, Ant Financial, Aliexpress, 1688.com, AliHealth, Taobao, and Tmall

³JD brand value includes JD Financial

2025 MOST VALUABLE CHINESE BRANDS

Rank	Brand	Brand value (US\$M)	% Brand value change vs 2024	Category	Rank change vs 2024
51	MIXUE BINGCHENG	3,955	N/A	Fast Food	N/A
52	HAIDILAO	3,882	17%	Casual Dining	-2
53	CHINA EVERBRIGHT BANK	3,806	27%	Financial Services	3
54	CHINA EASTERN AIRLINES	3,798	-2%	Travel Services	-11
55	ANTA	3,753	24%	Apparel	0
56	PICC	3,577	40%	Financial Services	9
57	KE	3,563	45%	Real Estate Agents	11
58	ZTO EXPRESS	3,481	-1%	Logistics	-10
59	XING HUA CUN	3,218	-7%	Alcohol	-10
60	LUCKIN COFFEE	3,042	21%	Fast Food	7
61	FRESHIPPO	3,008	N/A	Retail	N/A
62	BILIBILI	3,005	49%	Media and Entertainment	18
63	HEYTEA	2,991	-7%	Fast Food	-11
64	SHUANGHUI	2,976	0%	Food and Beverages	-6
65	TAIKANG	2,949	39%	Financial Services	8
66	VANKE	2,822	0%	Real Estate	-6
67	DJI	2,683	5%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	-1
68	CHINA UNICOM	2,658	47%	Telecom Providers	17
69	YUNNAN BAIYAO	2,648	13%	Health Care	2
70	YOUKU	2,635	34%	Media and Entertainment	12
71	CHINA CITIC BANK	2,594	43%	Financial Services	13
72	LIANJIA	2,468	2%	Real Estate Agents	-2
73	LI AUTO	2,379	-22%	Automotive	-19
74	LUZHOU LAOJIAO	2,361	-24%	Alcohol	-21
75	POLY	2,339	-9%	Real Estate	-11

Rank	Brand	Brand value (US\$M)	% Brand value change vs 2024	Category	Rank change vs 2024
76	TCL	2,300	11%	Business Technology and Services Platforms	1
77	BOE	2,260	11%	Business Technology and Services Platforms	1
78	QUNAR.COM	2,204	N/A	Travel Services	N/A
79	MANGO TV	2,203	5%	Media and Entertainment	-4
80	XPENG	2,175	N/A	Automotive	N/A
81	TSINGTAO	2,093	5%	Alcohol	0
82	SNOW	2,075	-20%	Alcohol	-19
83	BOSS ZHIPIN	1,997	-11%	Consumer Technology and Services Platforms	-11
84	GUJING GONG JIU	1,920	-29%	Alcohol	-23
85	FLIGGY	1,874	42%	Travel Services	11
86	TONG REN TANG	1,828	-10%	Health Care	-7
87	CR LAND	1,821	-12%	Real Estate	-11
88	CHAGEE	1,817	N/A	Fast Food	N/A
89	BANK OF NINGBO	1,777	19%	Financial Services	2
90	CHINA MINSHENG BANK	1,767	12%	Financial Services	0
91	GENKI FOREST	1,747	-8%	Food and Beverages	-8
92	WEDOCTOR	1,691	0%	Health Care	-5
93	NCI	1,684	N/A	Financial Services	N/A
94	NIO	1,654	3%	Automotive	-5
95	KUGOU	1,634	27%	Media and Entertainment	4
96	GUO YUAN	1,616	-8%	Alcohol	-10
97	YANGHE	1,504	-29%	Alcohol	-23
98	DONG E E JIAO	1,500	N/A	Health Care	N/A
99	YTO EXPRESS	1,496	9%	Logistics	-7
100	CR SANJIU	1,481	15%	Health Care	0

KANTAR BRANDZ RANK 2025
BRAND VALUE (US\$M)



NEWCOMERS AND RE-ENTRANTS

MEET THE CLASS OF 2025

Seven brands join the China Top 100 this year as either debuts or re-entrants.

As a group, this ‘Class of 2025’ hails from six different categories, with Fast Food twice represented. That includes this year’s top-ranked new brand Mixue Bingcheng.

Mixue Bingcheng, grocery brand FRESHIPPO, and tea chain CHAGEE are Newcomers, meaning that they are making their first ever China Top 100 debut. In the case of Fast Food brands Mixue Bingcheng and CHAGEE, that’s because of recent public listings. In FRESHIPPO’s case, it’s because the brand is now being valued separately from parent brand Alibaba.

Four brands are re-entrants, meaning that they had previously been ranked among the Top 100 and are now making their return to this elite list. Leading this contingent is travel search and booking platform Qunar.com at 78th, followed by XPENG, NCI, and Dong E E Jiao.

A common theme among many of these brands is experiences. Chinese consumers are gravitating toward sociality and exploration over material possessions. And they’re rewarding brands that understand this.

For example, Mixue Bingcheng’s affordable price point makes ‘tea occasions’ accessible to everyone, even Gen Alpha schoolchildren. CHAGEE promotes culturally refined tea rituals through brand assets ranging from its tea parlours to its elevated packaging. And FRESHIPPO has experimented with ‘premier’, ‘membership’ and, ‘outlet’ store formats that reward browsing and exploration – all while maintaining its commitment to low prices and omnichannel fulfilment.

XPENG’s vehicles are also designed with exploration in mind, with family-friendly features like smart fridges, extra storage space, and racks for outdoor gear. And, of course, Qunar.com explicitly facilitates new experiences through its travel booking services and AI concierge assistants.

This shift toward the experiential has extended to brand marketing, as well. When the Health Care brand Dong E E Jiao promotes its collagen products, it now balances functional claims with emotive scenarios showing moments of care, confidence, and mutual support – a parent preparing a surprise for their child, for example, or friends dressing up in costume together.

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



XPENG defends its ‘Justified Premium’ by embracing AI

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$2,175 M

Re-entry
Automotive

XPENG has successfully captured China’s mass market with its affordable MONA series, driving annual sales to a record high. Meanwhile, the brand’s pioneering embrace of AI – which according to CEO He Xiaopeng represents the ‘core engine’ of all XPENG vehicles – has positioned the brand as a tech-driven automotive innovator.

Innovation at an excellent price

XPENG has broken the automotive category’s traditional correlation between smart features and high price. By developing a fully in-house intelligent driving system, the company achieved China’s first comprehensive autonomous driving coverage. At the same time, XPENG has optimised cost efficiencies through strategic partnerships with big names like Volkswagen.

As all of this has been so well communicated, XPENG currently stands as the only Chinese ‘Justified Premium’ auto brand in Kantar’s strategic pricing model. That’s a big improvement from only two years ago, when XPENG was seen as providing ‘Average’ value for its price point.

	Brand strengths	Strength percentile
SPECIALIST	+10	86
DISTINCT	+11	84
PURPOSE	+3	86

Strength Percentile (100 = best)

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



FRESHIPPO refines its retail model

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$3,008 M

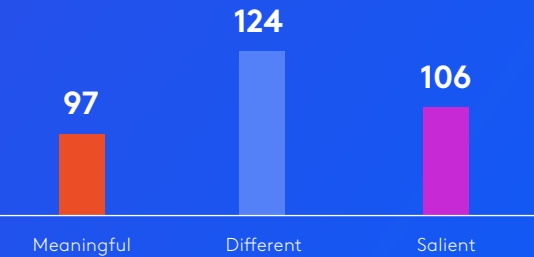
New
Retail

FRESHIPPO uses big data to offer price-sensitive customer groups an affordable, value-laden O2O shopping experience – thus achieving user growth of over 50% last year. At the same time, the brand supported brick-and-mortar expansion by hiring 200 new store managers and overhauling its compensation systems.

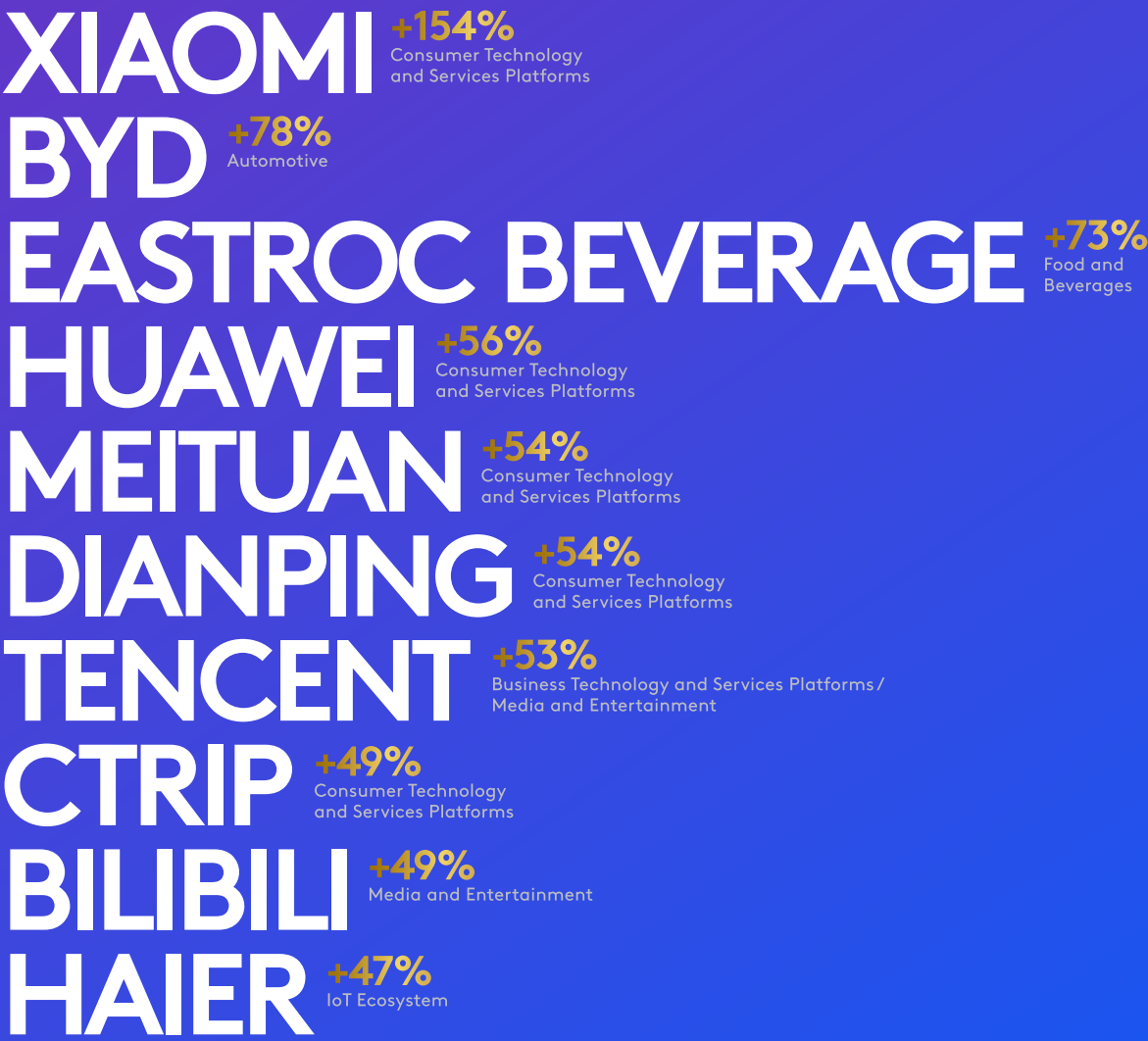
Making tangible improvements

In 2024, FRESHIPPO came into its own following a long developmental period where parent company Alibaba Group experimented with multiple formats. These days the brand focuses on two core businesses: its ‘premium markets’ which focus on healthy innovations (such as low-sugar baking and HPP juice); and its more discount-focused, O2O-focused Hema NB series which optimises for greater penetration into local communities. The result? Nine consecutive months of profitability and an annual gross merchandise value of ¥59 billion – plus strong Meaningful Difference gains since 2019.

China brand equity



BRAND VALUE GROWTH % VS. 2024
CATEGORY



*Tencent brand value includes QQ, QQMusic, WeChat, Tencent Music, WeSing, WeChat Pay, WeBank, v.qq.com, and Tencent Cloud

TOP RISERS

XIAOMI, BYD LEAD THIS YEAR'S GAINERS

The 2025 Top 10 Risers list recognises the 10 brands that achieved the fastest growth since 2024 across the China Top 100.

In a year when the overall value of the rankings increased by 25%, the Top Risers all rose by 67% on average. Many did so by finding new space – that is, by expanding into new markets, demographics, or new categories.

Perhaps no brand exemplifies this better than Xiaomi, this year's fastest-growing Chinese brand, which has successfully broadened its connected tech ecosystem to include high-tech, semi-autonomous New Electric Vehicles (NEVs). Led by CEO Lei Jun, Xiaomi's live-streamed car launches have injected new excitement into auto marketing. Its brand value grew 154% this year, catapulting Xiaomi to a new ranking high of 11th place.

There are two other Top Risers with close ties to the car industry. BYD grew 78%. In just a few short years it has become the best-known Chinese car marque abroad, with ambitious plans for the future. It's aiming for 50% of its total sales to come from overseas markets by 2030.

Huawei (which like Xiaomi is primarily valued as a Consumer Tech brand) also has a booming auto business – though as a tech provider and leader of the Harmony Intelligent Mobility Alliance rather than a car marque in its own right. Across all its divisions, Huawei is known for its strong investments in research and development – which in the auto realm includes promised solid-state battery models that could be a gamechanger for Chinese NEVs.

Another big story this year is Chinese tech giants' AI-assisted comeback. Digital brands had been on the backfoot in recent years thanks to regulatory scrutiny and an uneven transition out of the COVID-19 pandemic (some delivery and ecommerce brands overexpanded, for instance, while some travel brands struggled to regain momentum after lockdowns). Now, brands like Meituan, Dianping, and Ctrip have right-sized just in time to take advantage of Chinese consumers' shift toward spending on experiences – while also setting their sights on new overseas markets from East Asia to the Gulf. And they are doing so with more efficiency and better service than ever before, thanks to their embrace of advanced AI.

As discussed elsewhere in this report, Haier and bilibili have also used AI to better meet customers' needs. And then there's Eastroc Beverage, one of many 'national champions' this year that have met consumers' demand for better value – with great performance at a price that's right for many Gen Z and blue-collar consumers.

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Xiaomi builds a unique ‘Human x Car x Home’ brand ecosystem

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$28,150 M

+154% vs. 2024

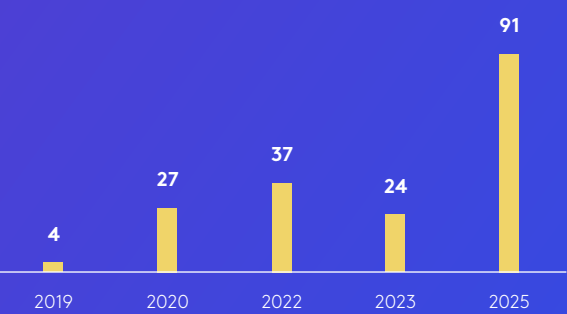
Consumer Technology and Services Platforms

Xiaomi continues to strengthen its Meaningful Difference. Domestically, its high-end smartphones dominate China’s ¥4,000 price tier, and its SU7 electric sedan has been an instant best-seller. Globally, the brand now ranks as a top-three smartphone player in over half of the 100+ countries it has expanded into.

Predisposing more people through human connection

Xiaomi captures market share through human-centred accessibility. It builds trust via transparent pricing and capped profit margins. And it connects well with consumers across multiple channels, supported by nearly 15,000 retail stores showcasing its ‘Human x Car x Home’ ecosystem. Last year, Xiaomi’s smart home surpassed ¥100 billion in revenue. Xiaomi also uses social media to aid in product development – for example, by soliciting public votes on SU7 features. Overall, Xiaomi’s brand ecosystem excels at guiding cross-category purchases while creating passionate brand advocates along the way.

Association with ‘Shaking things up’ Strength Percentile (100 = best)



BRAND SPOTLIGHT



bilibili marries innovative technology with ‘fandom-forward’ content

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$3,005 M

+49% vs. 2024

Media and Entertainment

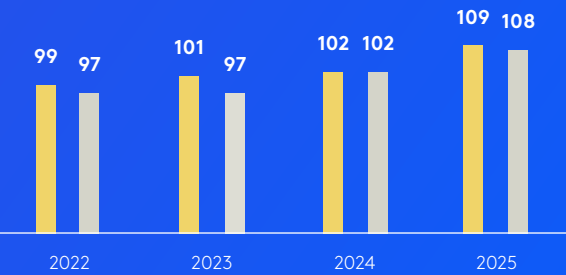
bilibili has always had a young, passionate user base. Now it’s getting serious about marketing innovation with its Huahuo commercial order platform, annual nodal marketing events, ecommerce integrations, and partnerships with key users. The result? Deeper engagement and more sales conversions.

Winning users’ trust with wonderful content

From the start, bilibili’s algorithm has prioritised subcultural specificity over mass virality. Over the past year, bilibili has consolidated its longtime leadership in Anime, Comics, and Gaming (ACG) content. At the same time, it has expanded further into domains like ‘learning’, technology, tourism, and sports. This has yielded a potent content matrix combining ‘broad coverage + deep penetration’ with a unique emphasis on tutorials, reviews, and ‘fan edits’. Meanwhile, more advanced AI has led to better marketing tools and more personalised content recommendations, while also making it easier for users to create great content.

Online sharing and networking, China

Overall Consumer Trust Index
Inspiring Trust





MDS

Discover the power of Kantar's Meaningful Different and Salient framework

Validated against short-term and long-term sales, our Meaningful Different and Salient framework (MDS) measures your brand equity and helps you grow. Our proprietary framework, accredited by the Marketing Accountability Standards Board (MASB), asserts that difference – not just distinctiveness – is crucial in forging strong mental connections between consumers and brands. Easily incorporated into any research study, it helps you maximise volume and value share growth for your brands.

Build strong emotional engagement, support margins, and increase market share. Drive your brand to success in today's uncertain marketing landscape.

Different

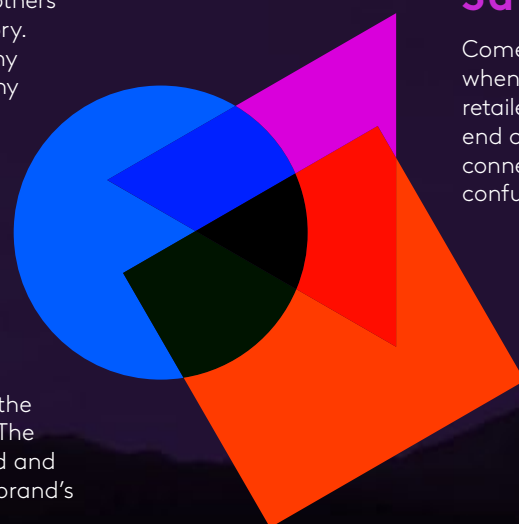
The brand feels different from others or is a trendsetter in the category. It expands outside the box in any direction, not constrained by any one dimension. **The circle.**

Salient

Comes to mind quickly and readily when activated by ideas around retailer or category choice. The sharp end of the brand, the memorable connection that pierces through the confusion of choices. **The triangle.**

Meaningful

Consumers feel an affinity for the brand or it meets their needs. The foundation of the brand is solid and tangible. The four walls of the brand's home territory. **The square.**



Find out more: **Kantar's MDS framework**





CATEGORY FOCUS

- 58 – CATEGORIES OVERVIEW
 - 59 – AUTOMOTIVE
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 - 73 – IOT ECOSYSTEM
 - 76 – MEDIA AND ENTERTAINMENT
 - 79 – RETAIL
-



CATEGORY OVERVIEW

A DIVERSE BRAND LANDSCAPE

Twenty categories are represented in this year’s Kantar BrandZ China Top 100 ranking.

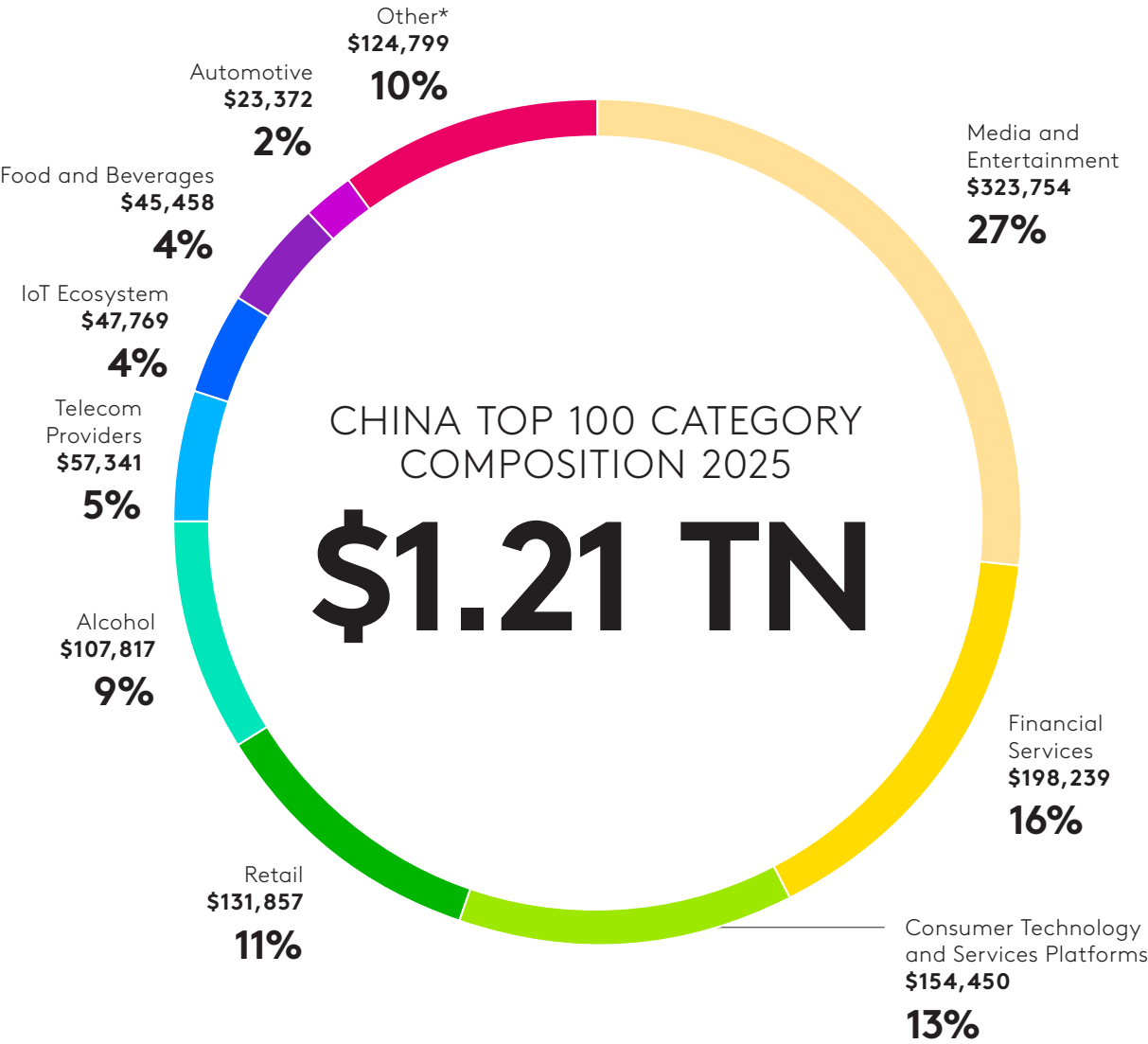
Among them, the Media and Entertainment category is once again the largest by total brand value. Taken together, the 11 brands in this category account for 27% of the China Top 100’s total value; that’s up from 24% the year before.

Financial Services claims the second largest value share for 2025, at 16%. It also placed the highest number of brands in the Top 100, at 16.

Consumer Technology and Services Platforms is this year’s third largest category by value, up from fifth in 2024. It grew its share of the rankings from 10% to 13% in this time and has placed 11 brands in the 2025 China Top 100.

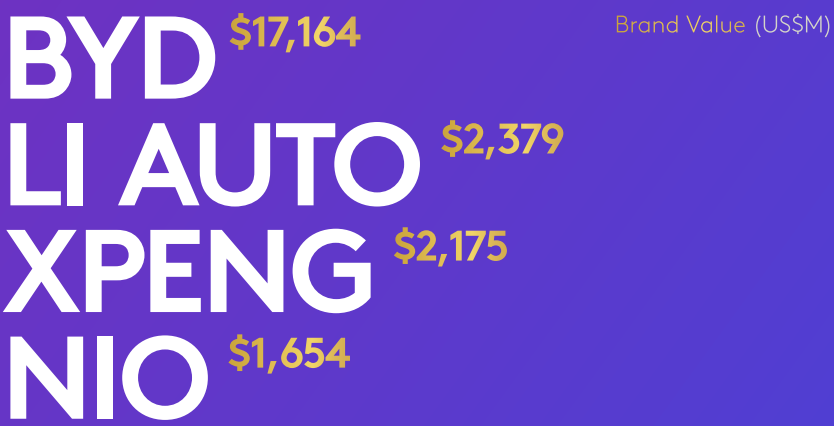


Kantar BrandZ categories by % of the China Top 100 total value



*Energy, Travel Services, Apparel, Logistics, Fast Food, Home Appliances, Business Technology and Services Platforms, Health Care, Real Estate, Real Estate Agents, and Casual Dining.

AUTOMOTIVE



DEFINITION:
The Automotive category includes mass-market and luxury cars, trucks, motorcycles, scooters, and tyres. Each brand includes all models marketed under the brand name.

THE ROAD AHEAD/
AUTOMATIVE BRANDS
PROCEED WITH AGILITY

Automotive
Total Brand Value

\$23,372 M

AUTOMOTIVE

Four Automotive brands appear in this year’s China Top 100 ranking, the same as last year. They are led by BYD, which rose 78% year-on-year as one of 2025’s Top Risers.

China’s top Automotive brands are more global than ever. Already, their success has made China the world’s top car exporter – a title the country seems unlikely to relinquish in the coming years. These brands have succeeded abroad not merely by costing less, but by providing *more*: more distinctive cabin amenities, more advanced AI assistance, and more daring exterior design.

In doing so, they have won over discerning car buyers around the world. In Europe, around one in every five electric vehicles sold is now made in China – double the share of a year ago. BYD also outsold Tesla in Europe for the first time earlier this year. (And next year looks even better for BYD’s European sales, when the brand’s factories in Hungary and Turkey will start rolling out tariff-exempt vehicles for the EU market.)

Over the past year, trade barriers and economic uncertainty have made agility a top priority for Chinese car brands abroad. This agility might take the form of rolling out more plug-in hybrid or combustion models (in markets where Chinese EVs now face heavy tariffs); or it could mean partnering with local dealerships in markets where direct-sales models have stagnated. In any event, pulling back on global expansion is not an option for Chinese brands – not when China’s domestic landscape continues to see price wars and softening demand.

At the same time, there remains no better incubator for breakthrough innovation than the domestic Chinese market. China, after all, is where BYD first developed and unveiled its new ultra-fast charging system, as well as its God’s Eye driver-assistance system (which it recently made a standard feature for most models). China is where NIO continues to refine its battery swapping system and develop an in-house smart driving microchip. And it’s where Xiaomi (discussed elsewhere in this report as a ‘3C’ Consumer Tech brand) first reached new heights of ‘ecosystem’ integration between its SU7 vehicles and its personal tech devices.

Similarly, the Chinese government’s openness to AI innovation has been crucial to XPENG’s emergence as a true ‘AI mobility company’. XPENG’s proprietary AI chip allows its models to process data in-vehicle to deliver a variety of innovative services. This includes a self-learning driving system, fatigue-monitoring safety features, an adaptive chassis system, AI-curated media, and cabin configurations.

‘The idea isn’t just that your car knows your schedule or your climate settings. It’s about creating a relationship between driver and machine – where the vehicle evolves with you’, XPENG’s CEO recently explained. As the brand put it in a recent press release: ‘AI is the core engine of our vehicles’.

It’s hard to imagine any legacy Western automotive brands speaking in those terms – which is exactly why Chinese brands have become so disruptive: they are willing to challenge the category’s deepest-rooted conventional wisdom.

And this innovation mindset extends to automotive brand marketing, as explained by our experts in the Thought Leadership section.



AUTOMOTIVE

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



BYD builds a dominant global NEV brand

2025 BRAND VALUE

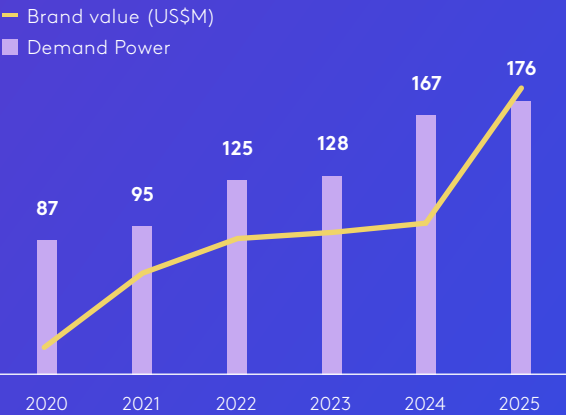
\$17,164 M
+78% vs. 2024

BYD has consolidated its position as the global leader in new energy vehicles (NEVs), achieving dual breakthroughs in scale and profit. At the same time, it has continued to increase its Demand Power and volume share in key markets around the world.

An expert at expanding overseas

BYD’s overseas market growth exceeded 115% over the past year. It achieved this by becoming more deeply relevant to consumers in ways specific to region – and by exporting its high technical standards to overseas factories. From there, BYD has worked to support its premium pricing abroad by foregrounding its technological superiority. In the process, BYD has changed the world’s perceptions of what it means to be ‘Made in China’.

Global brand equity



BRAND SPOTLIGHT



NIO courts loyalty through excellent user experience

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$1,654 M
+3% vs. 2024

NIO is transforming from a pure automaker to an intelligent mobility pioneer powered by ‘technology + ecosystem’ synergies, with a focus on great service.

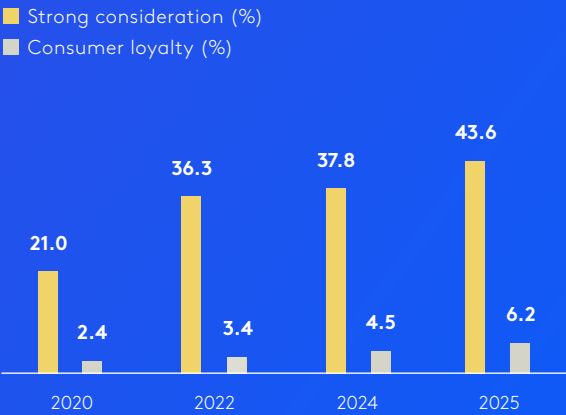
A focus on service, loyalty, and contentment

NIO is building on its existing differentiators – including its three-minute battery swap service – to set new experience standards. With AI assistants enabling 24/7 issue resolution, for instance, the NIO Worry-Free Service offers replacement vehicles and five-second accident response. This is one of many new AI integrations that aims to support drivers across social situations.

	Brand strengths	Strength percentile
DISRUPTIVE	+6	78
DISTINCT	+12	86
PROUD TO BE A USER	+2	75

Strength Percentile (100 = best)

Cars, China



CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY AND SERVICES PLATFORMS



*3C brands

DEFINITION:
The Consumer Technology and Services Platforms category includes 3C (Computer, Communication, and Consumer Electronics), TV, audio, gaming, phones, and wearables. It also includes online platforms which provide services to consumers.

EXCITING NEW MODELS/
DEVICE BRANDS DIVERSIFY

Consumer Technology and Services Platforms Total Brand Value

\$154,450 M

CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY AND SERVICES PLATFORMS

There are five 3C (Computer, Communication, and Consumer Electronics) brands in the Kantar BrandZ China Top 100. A subset of the broader Consumer Technology and Services Platforms category, these brands are best known for their smartphones, drones, and other smaller-format hardware – though several are now expanding into new sectors.

Xiaomi grew its brand value by 154% year-on-year on the back of a strong push into mobility. Though the brand faced some setbacks in early 2025, it regained momentum in June with the launch of a new family-sized SUV model, which generated close to 290,000 orders an hour after its debut.

Huawei, meanwhile, has pushed into the car market as a full-stack automotive tech provider – a business track that has developed as a steady complement to the brand's high-end smartphone business, which has weathered a volatile (but ultimately triumphant) first half of the 2020s. In 2021, Huawei launched the HarmonyOS Cockpit and a co-developed vehicle line with Seres. In 2023, it added advanced driver assistance features and formed the Harmony Intelligent Mobility Alliance (HIMA) in collaboration with major names like Changan, Chery, BAIC, JAC, and SAIC.

One positive recent shift across both smartphone and automotive segments is the use of more domestically sourced tech components. Initially a response to trade restrictions, local semiconductor manufacturing has become a point of national pride. Similarly, Chinese-developed AI engines like DeepSeek and Doubao (ByteDance) are now the LLMs of choice for most Chinese consumer tech brands.

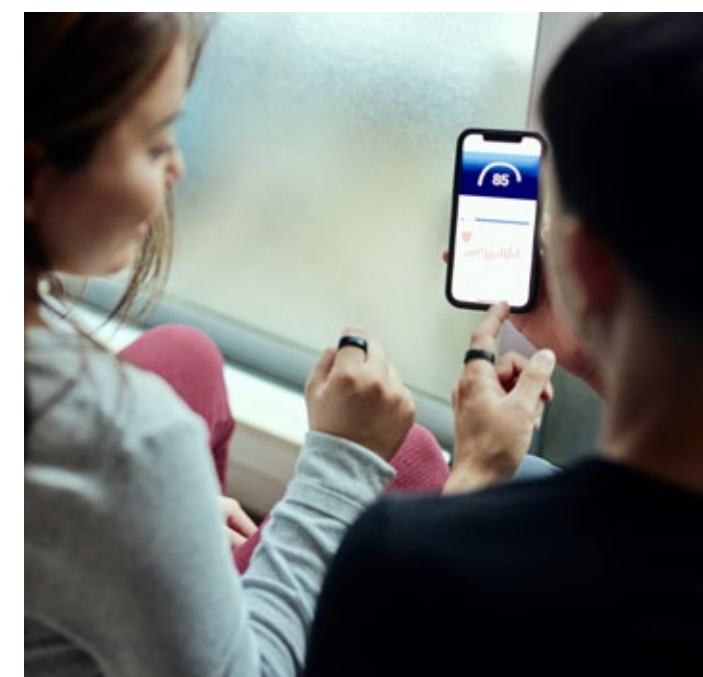
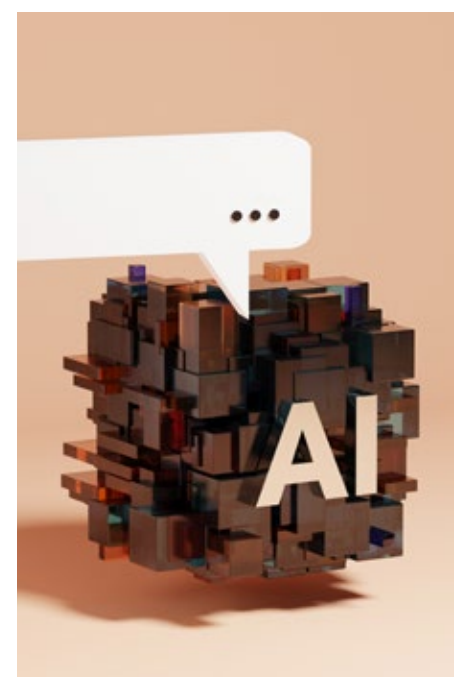
Unlike in Europe or North America, Chinese consumers tend to have a more positive view of AI's potential impact on their lives. This has given Chinese brands more leeway to promote advanced AI features as a fresh marketing angle. That's useful at a time when more and more smartphones have come to look the same physically, and as consumers' phone upgrade cycles continue to lengthen.

Still, even with AI, differentiation remains a challenge. Most Chinese tech brands are relying on the same small set of third-party AI engines (e.g. DeepSeek) to power their new 'AI-enabled' smartphones – so how can they make those phones stand out from the pack? Going forward, handset makers must find ways to apply these engines *distinctively* – to design brand-specific apps, features, and OS that deliver Meaningfully Different AI experiences. This is still a work in progress.

Hardware innovation may offer another way forward. In 2024, foldables such as the Honor Magic V4 and Huawei Mate X5 accounted for 10% of Chinese smartphone sales. At the same time, the 'Healthy China 2030' initiative has sparked renewed interest in health-focused wearables like smart rings, glucose-monitoring earbuds, and fitness trackers. Ecosystem integration across smartphones, smart homes, and now EVs is another rising differentiator.

Above all else, user insight will be key. Already, Chinese brands' success in overseas markets largely depends on consumer intelligence. vivo's success in Southeast Asia, for instance, has been achieved by diligently localising its offerings and operations. Transsion's smartphone brands may be absent from the Chinese market but they remain household names in African markets like Nigeria, Kenya, and Ghana.

In short, China's leading 3C brands have achieved success across virtually all segments and markets. But as AI reshapes the category, complacency is not an option: they must continue to innovate and localise.



CONSUMER TECHNOLOGY AND SERVICES PLATFORMS

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Huawei achieves global, premium growth

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$64,152 M

+56% vs. 2024

Huawei made strong gains over the past year, combining brand resilience with technological breakthroughs. That’s thanks to rising consumer interest in high-end products like its foldable smartphones, as well as the success of Huawei’s HarmonyOS system at home and overseas.

Predisposing more people to pay a premium

Many Chinese consumers see buying a Huawei device as an expression of national pride. But the brand refuses to rest on these laurels as it looks to expand globally. Huawei continues to invest heavily in innovation, directing more than 10% of its revenue into R&D. Commercially, consumers continue to pay more for flagship models in Huawei’s Pura and Mate series – and even for Huawei’s premium-priced AITO M7 SUV. For this reason, Huawei is one of only two global consumer electronics brands to rate as ‘Justified Premium’ in Kantar’s strategic pricing model.

Consumer electronics, China



BRAND SPOTLIGHT



vivo achieves a strong-value leap

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$5,989 M

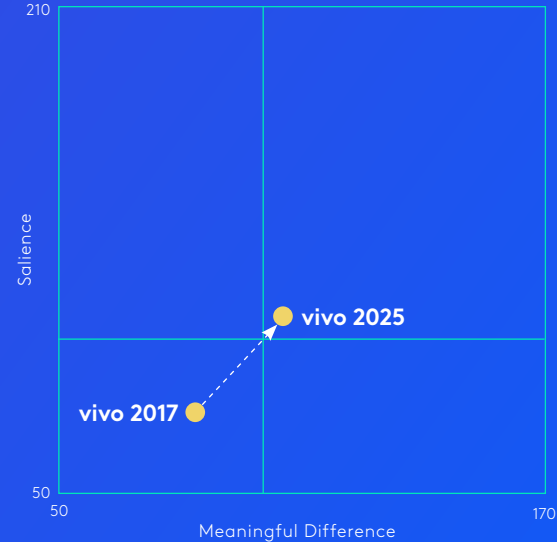
+11% vs. 2024

vivo led China’s smartphone market in 2024 with a 17% share. It has now topped China’s domestic smartphone rankings for four straight years. Global shipments also passed 100 million last year, thanks to vivo’s focus on turning lab innovations into real consumer value.

Predisposing more people through unique expertise

vivo builds loyalty by being reliable. It develops features people want: better cameras, stronger-yet-lighter foldables, and stable gaming performance. In 2024, vivo supported TEAM CHINA at the Paris Olympic Games by donating smart devices to meet the communication and data security needs of the team. It was also the official FIFA sponsor from 2017 to 2023. Along with these sponsorships, service has become another brand strength – vivo now operates service centres in select countries worldwide, offering one-hour repairs to create a seamless chain of user-centric care from R&D to after-sales support. This has led to marked improvements in vivo’s Meaningful Difference perceptions.

Global brand equity



FAST FOOD

Brand Value
(US\$M)

MIXUE BINGCHENG \$3,955
LUCKIN COFFEE \$3,042
HEYTEA \$2,991
CHAGEE \$1,817

DEFINITION:
The Fast Food category includes quick service restaurants (QSR) and casual dining brands which vary in customer and menu focus, but mostly compete for the same dayparts.

FAST, FRESH, FUN/
FAST FOOD BRANDS
WIN ON VALUE

Fast Food
Total Brand Value

\$11,805 M

FAST FOOD

The four Fast Food brands in the China Top 100 reflect the diversity and momentum of modern Chinese brand building. Some scaled rapidly from the start, like Luckin Coffee and CHAGEE. Others, like Mixue Bingcheng and HEYTEA, started out as smaller neighbourhood shops. All four feature clear points of differentiation, backed by consistent execution.

CHAGEE enters the ranking at No. 88. Founded in Yunnan, CHAGEE draws inspiration from Starbucks, which it sees as a global model for standardised premium beverages. CHAGEE hopes to do for Chinese tea culture what Starbucks did for ‘second-wave coffee’. To that end, CHAGEE’s menu is more streamlined, with a focus on fresh Yunnan tea leaves and East-meets-West drinks like tea lattes, teapuccinos, and teaspressos. It targets urban white-collar workers with elevated packaging and teahouse interiors that blend Chinese opera motifs and Western luxury cues. CHAGEE now operates more than 6,400 stores worldwide. In 2024, it expanded its footprint in eastern China and Southeast Asia. In 2025, it went public on the NASDAQ.

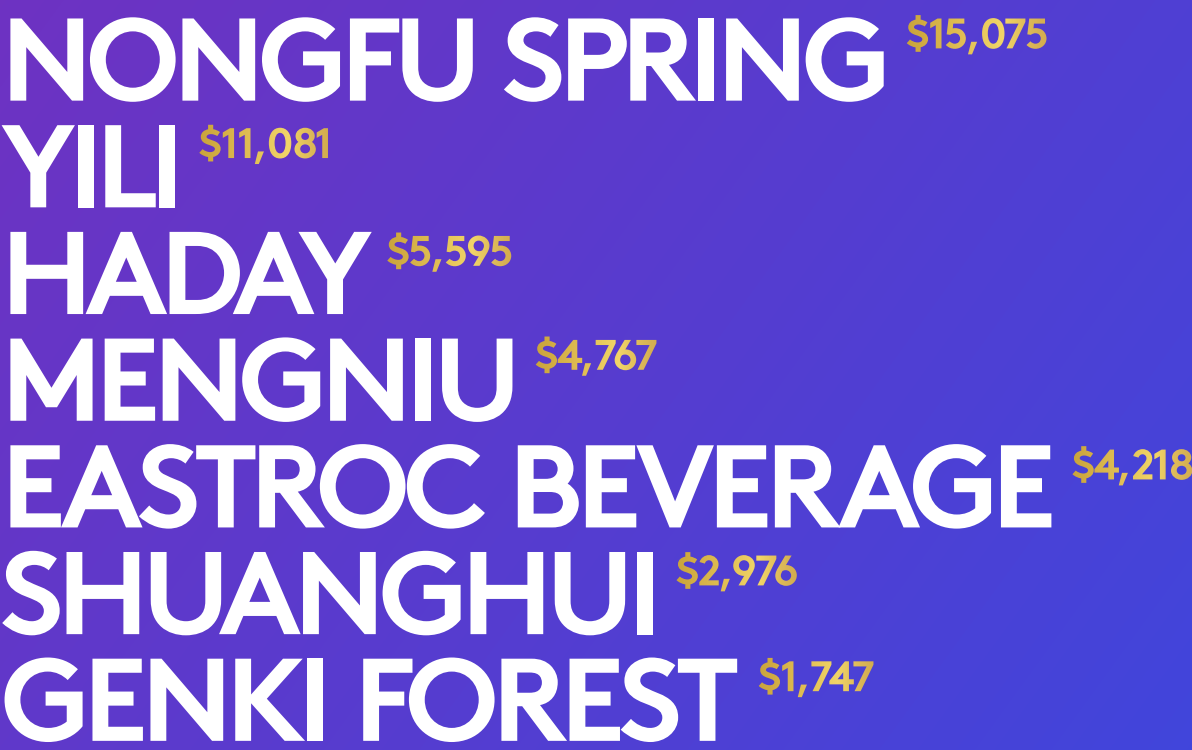
Mixue Bingcheng, this year’s highest-ranked newcomer at No. 51, takes a different approach. Instead of luxury malls, it focusses on student districts and busy streets and alleys. A core advantage is price. By streamlining its supply chain and limiting its fruit options to mostly lemons, Mixue Bingcheng keeps prices between ¥2 to ¥8 (between \$0.30 and \$1.11) – a fraction of HEYTEA or CHAGEE’s costs. Affordability has made it especially popular with Gen Z and Gen Alpha, helped by its widely recognised ‘Snow King’ mascot.

By 2024, Mixue Bingcheng had entered over 4,900 townships, 1,700 county towns, and 300 prefecture-level cities across China. While other brands expand outward to towns from major cities, Mixue Bingcheng has done the reverse. Similarly, it has used an ‘outside-in’ playbook to enter overseas markets such as Thailand and Indonesia. It has also localised for price and taste – which, in Southeast Asia, means offering sweeter formulations at even lower costs. As of late 2024, Mixue Bingcheng has over 45,000 outlets worldwide, now larger than McDonald’s and Starbucks by store count.

The two returning Fast Foods brands, Luckin Coffee and HEYTEA, are balancing international growth with domestic strategy shifts. In China, Luckin Coffee has courted value-seeking consumers by launching a ¥9.9 pricing tier; this has forced competitors like Starbucks and Western burger chains to offer discounts of their own. HEYTEA, meanwhile, has introduced more drinks in the ¥10–20 range to fight perceptions of selling only high-priced drinks. At the same time, HEYTEA has leaned into its upscale brand image in its efforts to offer superior experience: opening more premium store formats and offering better service *without* raising prices.



FOOD AND BEVERAGES



Brand Value (US\$M)

DEFINITION:
The Food and Beverages category includes non-alcoholic ready-to-drink beverages (carbonated soft drinks, juice, bottled water, functional drinks, coffee and tea); packaged foods including snacks, meal and culinary brands, meat and dairy products, and confectionery.

APPETITE FOR GROWTH/
BRANDS FIND NEW WAYS TO SATISFY

Food and Beverages
Total Brand Value

\$45,458 M

FOOD AND BEVERAGES

There are seven brands from the Food and Beverages category in the 2025 China Top 100. Three rose in brand value, three declined, and one remained essentially flat.

As in other categories, overseas expansion is a major focus for these brands. And indeed, many have fairly long histories of selling overseas. This comes despite higher barriers to global export due to health and safety regulations – such as the year-long process Yili underwent with the U.S. Food and Drug Administration before gaining access to the American market last year.

Success abroad also requires a strong local presence. HADAY, for instance, works closely with Chinese restaurants overseas to get its condiments on dining tables. But once established, Food and Beverages brands can be some of China's best cultural ambassadors, earning a valued place in families' daily lives.

Meanwhile, in the domestic market, health-conscious products continue to perform well, driven in no small part by government wellness campaigns. Low-sugar and low-calorie offerings remain in high demand.

At the same time, consumers are also seeking greater value, especially as the rising costs of basic ingredient (such as pork and vegetables) have pushed up prices.

What this means for 'healthy' products is that value-driven shoppers are now looking for more than 'free from' claims – they want added benefits. Recently, this has fuelled demand for protein-enriched snacks, probiotics supporting gut health, and adaptogenic mushrooms.

There's also some demographic nuance here: older consumers, for instance, are choosing low-sodium, easy-to-digest options. Meanwhile, time-pressed Gen Z shoppers have powered interest in nutrient-rich meal replacement products, which have seen strong sales growth on platforms like Tmall.

In general, domestic brands are well positioned to deliver these 'premium enhancements' at a better price point than their foreign competitors. (They also benefit from the latest *Guochao*, or 'national wave', that's proven especially potent for brands in culturally resonant sectors like fashion, beauty, and dining).

Digital innovation has also played a major role in spurring brand value growth. Buying food and drinks online is now a routine activity in China. Looking forward, it is hoped that AI-driven recommendation tools will match SKUs (stock keeping units) with their most receptive potential consumers.

Still, ecommerce has introduced new challenges too. These include price wars and discounting pressures in the 'livestream economy', as well as new competition from 'farmer influencers' and other non-traditional sellers.

Some brands are finding especially creative ways to bridge the physical-digital divide. Eastroc Beverage, for example, has covered its distinctive large caps with scannable QR codes that offer consumers exclusive discounts and cash rewards, while providing the brand with rich data on consumer preferences and behaviour.



FOOD AND BEVERAGES

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



HADAY builds brand value through
Meaningfully Different innovation

2025 BRAND VALUE

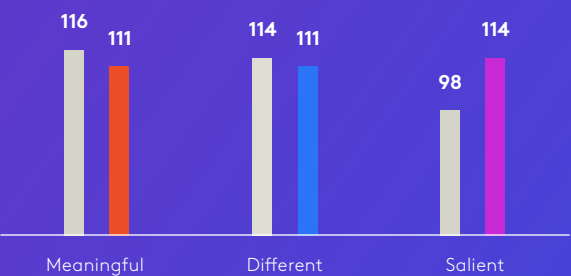
\$5,595 M

+19% vs. 2024

Also known as Haitian, HADAY’s rise has been propelled by its seven ‘hero’ products, each of which has annual sales exceeding ¥1 billion. Equally important are the 1,200+ new products that HADAY has rolled out to fill market gaps around the world.

China brand equity

2020 2025



Optimised products, optimised marketing

Some of HADAY’s R&D spend supports behind-the-scenes innovations like its AI-integrated intelligent brewing technology (which ensures strong worldwide consistency for products like its Golden Label Light Soy Sauce). Other innovations address changing consumer preferences: think low-sodium and gluten-free condiments – plus experiential innovations like ‘squeeze-type’ oyster sauce and ‘spray-on’ soy sauce. Meanwhile, high-frequency marketing exposures and partnerships with overseas Chinese restaurants have strengthened HADAY’s worldwide Salience. The result? Some of the category’s strongest brand equity, volume share, and Demand Power.

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Eastroc Beverage thrives as a youth-focused
national champion

2025 BRAND VALUE

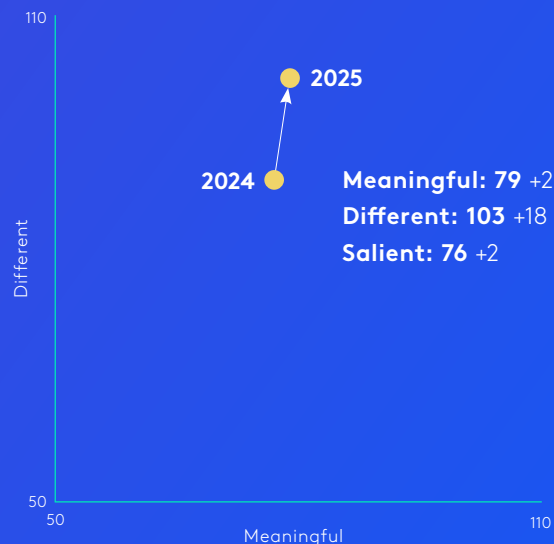
\$4,218 M

+73% vs. 2024

Eastroc Beverage has consolidated its position as China’s ‘National Energy’ brand. It has done so by mastering scenario-based consumption mindsets and building a youth-oriented ecosystem. The brand is currently found in 25 overseas markets and counting, with plans for further global expansion.

China brand equity

Eastroc Beverage has increased its Difference Brand value: +73%



Enhancing user loyalty with a unique brand image

Eastroc Beverage has emerged as a major rival to international ‘energy’ brands like Red Bull. It is winning over young people with a strong combination of value, presence, and attitude. At home, the brand ties itself to Chinese youth events like esports matches and street dance competitions. Globally, it popularises the concept of ‘Chinese energy’ by sponsoring international events like the Asian Games and the World Cup.

While its slogan ‘Tired or sleepy? Drink Eastroc Beverage’ has universal appeal, the brand also works to more precisely target core demographics such as truck drivers, blue-collar workers, and e-sports gamers. The result has been improved Meaningful Difference over the past three years.

HOME APPLIANCES



DEFINITION:
The Home Appliances category includes manufacturers of electric household appliances, smart home solutions, and related products.

ELEVATED COOL/
HOME APPLIANCES
PREMIUMISE

Home Appliances
Total Brand Value

\$11,571 M

HOME APPLIANCES

There are two Home Appliances brands in the Kantar BrandZ China Top 100: Midea at No. 32 and GREE at No. 50. Both improved their rankings this year after posting strong year-on-year growth.

Domestically, Chinese home appliance brands have benefitted from a government-backed trade-in programme that subsidises the purchase of new appliances to boost household consumption (while also counting the effects of a recent real estate slump on home appliance sales).

As of May 31 2025, this 'old for new' initiative across five major categories had generated \$139 billion (¥1.1 trillion) in retail sales, with roughly 175 million subsidies going directly to consumers.

That said, it was not a foregone conclusion that Chinese home appliance brands would benefit so handsomely from this scheme: foreign brands also qualified for many incentives. Domestic brands still had to earn consumers' business by providing superior value – and they did, thanks to strong brand equity.

Today, brands like Midea and GREE are seen as equals – or even superiors – to Western names like Bosch and Panasonic. That's because they offer comparable innovation and stylishness at more attractive prices. They are simply great value. This perception also extends to appliance makers valued in other China Top 100 categories, such as Haier, Xiaomi, and TCL – plus unranked brands like Hisense, ECOVACS, and Roborock.

This change is no accident. It reflects years of R&D investment and consumer research. Chinese brands now lead the world in applying AI to real-world household problems – with solutions ranging from full 'connected home' systems to smart features like Midea's refrigerator water dispensers that detect the container size to prevent spills. Solar-integrated appliances (as notably offered by Midea and Haier) are another big trend, as are time-saving innovations like GREE's self-cleaning air conditioners.

Chinese brands' marketing strategies have levelled up as well. Chinese home appliance makers now aim to convey more than just raw product superiority. In 2025, they are also layering in more emotional themes like comfort, security, and care. At the same time, many brands have started leveraging their corporate executives as 'brand IP' – ably communicating a brand's expertise while also adding a more personal touch to a company's brand image.

As a result, Chinese brands can now represent themselves as not merely 'advanced', but 'premium'. That distinction is an especially important one overseas, where technical specs like speed, energy efficiency, and noise levels are just one component of what makes a home appliance 'worth the price'. Design cues, cultural relevance, and lifestyle fit matter a lot too – something Chinese brands now recognise.

Looking ahead, top home appliance brands aim to grow even further in these global markets. They also hope to expand into emerging, adjacent 'home tech' spaces – for example, at-home robots, which promise new forms of convenience, wellness, and even companionship for their owners. (Already, laundry-folding robots and AI chefs have joined some higher-income Chinese households).



HOME APPLIANCES

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Midea pushes into ‘Premium’

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$7,598 M

+45% vs. 2024

As Midea continues to set revenue records, technology remains a key advantage. Midea invested ¥16.2 billion in R&D last year and now holds 150,000 global patents. These support ongoing upgrades to intelligent products – including further integration with AI tools like DeepSeek. The result is stronger market trust and greater resilience.

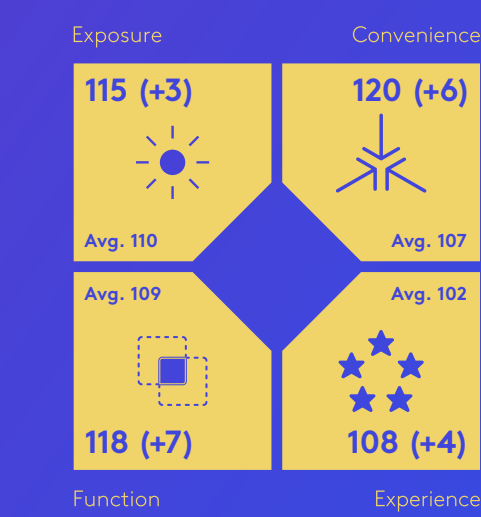
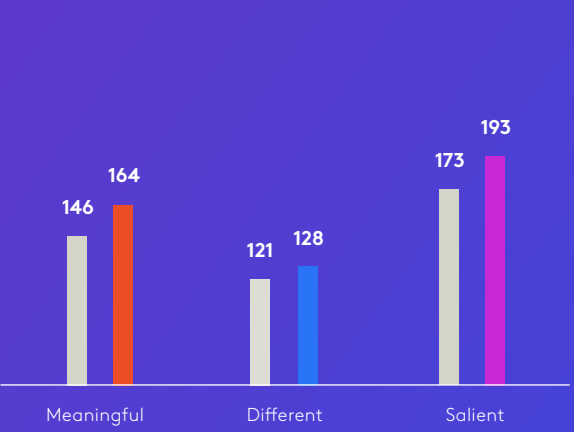
Predisposing more people through Meaningful Difference

Once known mainly for appliances, Midea now pursues its focus on ‘technology + globalisation + digitisation’ across many categories. Midea’s R&D remains tightly integrated with production – with a sharp new focus on emerging AI trends. While competitors remain mired in price wars, Midea’s advanced technology and strong brand equity has helped it progress from ‘Made in China’ to ‘Intelligently Made in China’.

Midea (vs. 2024) vs. China Top 100 average

Global brand equity

■ 2024 ■ 2025



BRAND SPOTLIGHT



GREE leverages its star brand asset

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$3,973 M

+33% vs. 2024

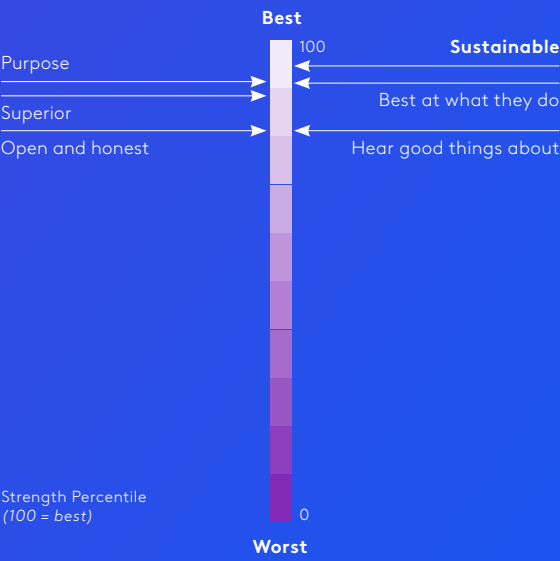
GREE has strengthened its competitiveness via a unique approach to cost cutting – one that combines technological innovation with personality-based ‘IP marketing’. Last year’s record-high net profits validate this approach.

Out-of-the-box marketing

Chairwoman Dong Mingzhu became the public face of GREE long before it was popular to turn executives into ‘brand IP’. With the rise of social media, GREE placed Chairwoman Dong at the centre of its livestreams and viral posts, generating widespread attention at low cost.

Now, GREE has gone a step further. Its new Dong Mingzhu Healthy Home initiative has transformed exclusive stores into full smart-home experience centres. The aim is to shift consumer focus from individual products to whole-home living scenarios – all inspired (and publicised) by GREE’s star brand asset. Combined with targetted sports sponsorships and a tightly managed marketing budget, this approach has helped GREE maintain strong visibility – ultimately converting attention into real sales.

Home Appliances, China Comparison to all brands



From 2020–2025, GREE has had the highest Sustainable performance among the China Top 100.

IOT ECOSYSTEM

HAIER **\$47,769** Brand Value (US\$M)

DEFINITION:
The IoT Ecosystem category includes brands that leverage IoT-related technology and co-create with partners to provide customised, iterative cross-category products, services, and experiences.

CO-CREATING
FOR GROWTH/
HAIER CONNECTS
WITH USERS

IoT Ecosystem
Total Brand Value

\$47,769 M

IOT ECOSYSTEM

Haier has made the China Top 100 for the 15th straight year. It rose one spot this year to become China’s sixth most valuable brand. Haier also returned for the seventh year to the Kantar BrandZ Global Top 100, ascending four places this year to reach the 54th spot.

Haier pioneered the ‘ecosystem brand’ concept, but it is no longer the only one. And for Haier, that’s a good thing: one of the main purposes of Kantar’s annual Ecosystem Brand Development Report is to promote the development of ecological ecosystem brands more broadly. Because after all, a cornerstone of the concept is that business success is much less ‘zero sum’ than conventional wisdom holds; there are lots of opportunities for win-win collaboration. (For one thing, these collaborations remain the lifeblood of Haier’s extensive ‘industrial internet’ business.)

Another important, related concept is ‘co-creation with end-users’ – not surprisingly, this one has been fully embraced in Haier’s consumer-facing appliance business. Take the brand’s recent launch of its three-drum washing machines. In July 2024, a social media user suggested a three-drum design for washing underwear, outerwear, and socks separately but simultaneously. Product Director Zongyuan Weng had already been exploring that concept – but instead of moving directly to R&D, he turned to AI to generate nearly 100 design options and asked users to vote on their preferred structure. By August, a final design had been chosen through this collaborative process.

When similar requests appeared again in early 2025 – this time in the comment section of one of Haier CEO Zhou Yunjie’s viral National People’s Congress posts – Haier’s R&D team accelerated development. In March 2025, the washing machine officially launched with robust consumer take-up.

Innovation is another Haier cornerstone. While the brand has long made use of advanced AI, its new AI Eye features have further boosted its leadership in this area. Unveiled at the 2025 Appliance & Electronics World Expo, the system acts as a visual nerve centre, giving home appliances the ability not just to ‘hear’ but also to ‘see’. The goal is to shift from passive responses to active service.

For example, Haier’s AI Eye-powered air conditioners produce two kinds of airflow: one cools the room to a baseline; the other adjusts for comfort, adapting with time to how people feel and act. A washing machine with the same AI Eye system can detect many common issues before they turn into big problems (e.g. clothes caught in the door, colour bleeding, or items left behind). A range hood with AI vision can tell when a pot is about to boil over and automatically tells the stove to reduce the heat to prevent this.

In the marketing realm, Zhou Yunjie, also Haier’s Chairman of the Board, has driven strong results through authentic social media engagement and enhanced user experience. Best of all, this strategy arose organically when netizens began to champion Chairman Zhou’s social media posts from the most recent National People’s Congress. By staying true to its authentic strengths, Haier has solidified its brand as an industry leader – turning fleeting engagement into lifelong users and ecosystem growth.

Globally, the brand’s cultural cachet is enhanced through considered sponsorships and activations, as well as the Haier Global Fans Festival which runs in terminal touch points and online.

In particular, 2025 marked the first year of Haier’s partnership with the Australian Open tennis tournament. This event draws 1,100,000 on-site spectators and reaches 900 million global viewers – 65% of whom are Haier’s target audience of high-net-worth household decision makers. The tournament also coincides with a seasonal peak in home appliance usage, and its spirit of high performance aligns with Haier’s brand ethos of ‘pursuing excellence’.

To make the most of this opportunity, Haier created the world’s first ‘home appliance x tennis 3D avatar’ IP named ACE, and featured it across a lot of campaign touchpoints, especially on social media platforms. It is a simple way to communicate the



brand’s embrace of smart technology. In-venue branding included Haier referee chairs and many impactful side events, such as smoothie making, jersey care demos, and exhibitions with star players and Key Opinion Leaders (KOLs).

On television, Haier launched a five-week media campaign to boost the brand TVC, added branded effects to the Australian Open broadcast studio, and secured screen placement during matches. Online, Haier focused on Facebook, Instagram,

YouTube, and TikTok. A series of short-form videos covered highlights, product demos, and behind-the-scenes footage. The brand ran large outdoor promotional displays and pop-up events in major markets around the world.

The result? Haier’s core social media followers increased to 22.8 million. Its brand awareness in Australia increased significantly. And its search volumes exceeded direct competitors, all while its overseas stores saw improved performance.

IOT ECOSYSTEM

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Haier pursues a forward-looking internationalisation strategy

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$47,769 M
+47% vs. 2024

Haier has built its strong position by focusing on resilient performance, advanced technology, and global collaboration – all centred around its unique ‘ecosystem’ approach and RenDanHeYi philosophy.

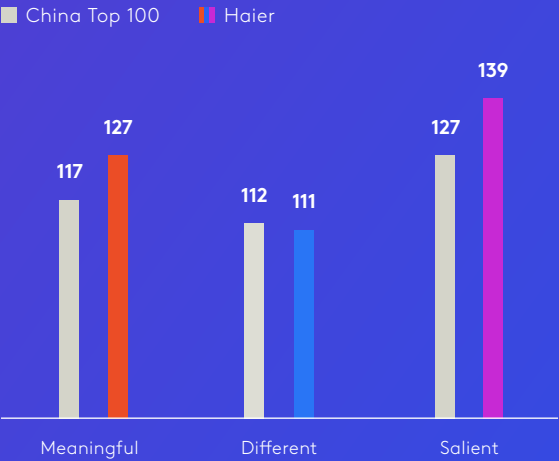
	Brand strengths	Strength percentile
PURPOSE	+14	93
SOCIALLY RESPONSIBLE	+2	92
BETTER ONLINE & ON MOBILE	+3	91

Strength Percentile (100 = best)

Meaningful value through co-creation

Much of Haier’s brand strength among consumers comes from the high-end segment. It uses new technologies and a full product lineup to reshape expectations about premium appliances – while unlocking new levels of Meaningful co-collaboration with its user base. In 2024, international markets made up more than half of Haier’s total revenue for the first time. This milestone is a testament to Haier’s long-time efforts to tailor its offerings to specific markets’ needs.

Global brand equity



MEDIA AND ENTERTAINMENT

TENCENT*	\$197,991	Brand Value (US\$M)
DOUYIN	\$76,200	
NETEASE	\$8,783	
BAIDU	\$8,350	
KUAISHOU	\$8,072	
XIAOHONGSHU	\$7,604	
TOUTIAO	\$7,277	
BILIBILI	\$3,005	
YOUKU	\$2,635	
MANGO TV	\$2,203	
KUGOU	\$1,634	

DEFINITION:
The Media and Entertainment category includes traditional media (TV, newspapers, etc.) as well as social media, search engines, video sharing services, gaming, video and music streaming services, and leisure facilities.

KEEP WATCHING/
BRANDS INNOVATE
FOR ENGAGEMENT

Media and Entertainment
Total Brand Value

\$323,754 M

*Tencent is valued in two categories: Media and Entertainment, and Business Technology and Services Platforms

MEDIA AND ENTERTAINMENT

There are 11 Media and Entertainment brands in the China Top 100, down from 13 the year before. Ten of these players have grown since last year – not least because as AI helped brands roll out new content and advertising tools while reining in costs.

Tencent remains the category's most valuable brand. (It also appears in the Business Technology and Services Platform category). Its brand value rose 53% this year thanks to its expanding AI capabilities. The Tencent Hunyuan model and Tencent Yuanbao chatbot were key to this – among other effects, they improved search and ad targeting across core platforms like WeChat. Tencent also upgraded its advertising suites across its platforms, with new tools for instant image generation and automated video editing.

AI is reshaping Tencent's entertainment business too. The HunyuanVideo engine has streamlined special effects and editing for Tencent TV originals, while automated subtitling and audio/video generation tools have made it easier for the brand to expand in regions like Southeast Asia.

Other top Media and Entertainment brands have gone on similar AI journeys. Internally, most are using AI to find new efficiencies and lower costs; externally, it's for aiding users and advertisers to create more relevant content. As these tools improve, the gap between professional ads and user-generated content is shrinking – to the particular benefit of the latter.

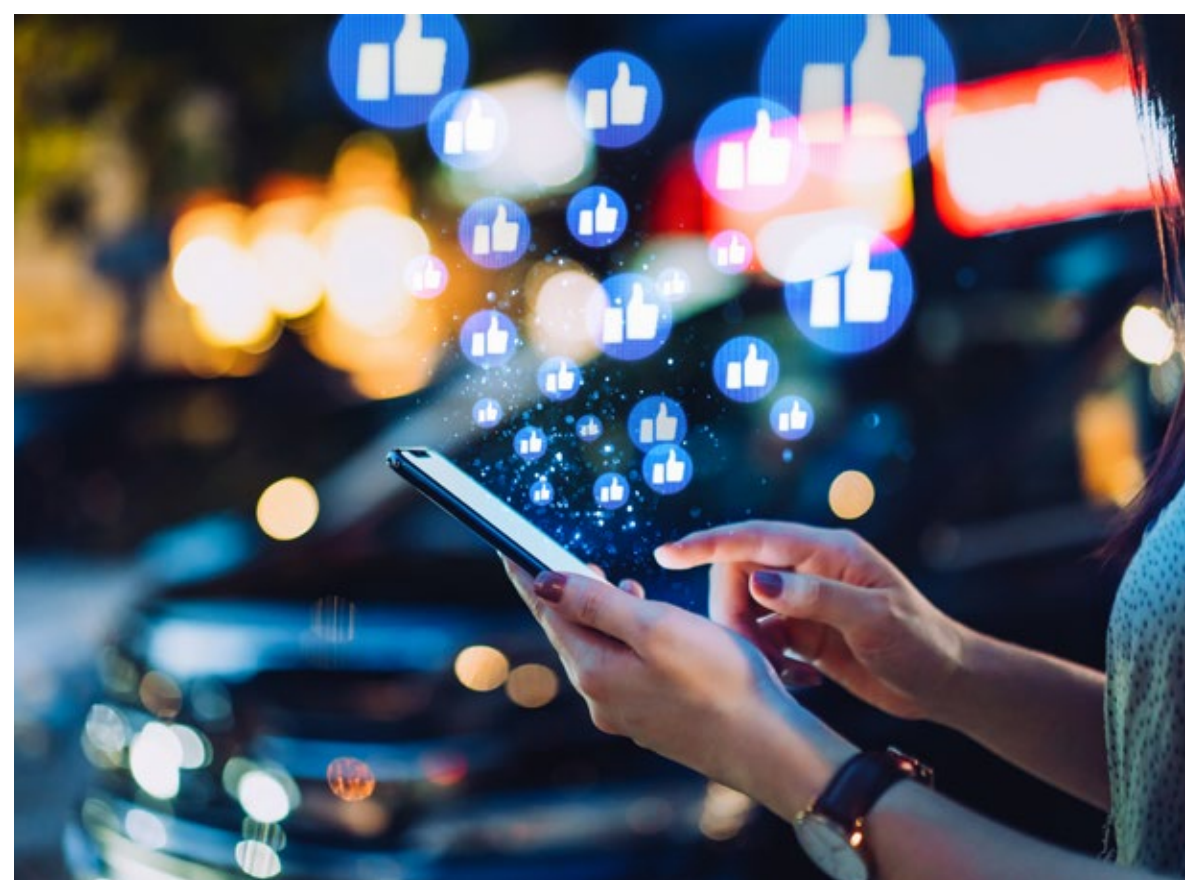
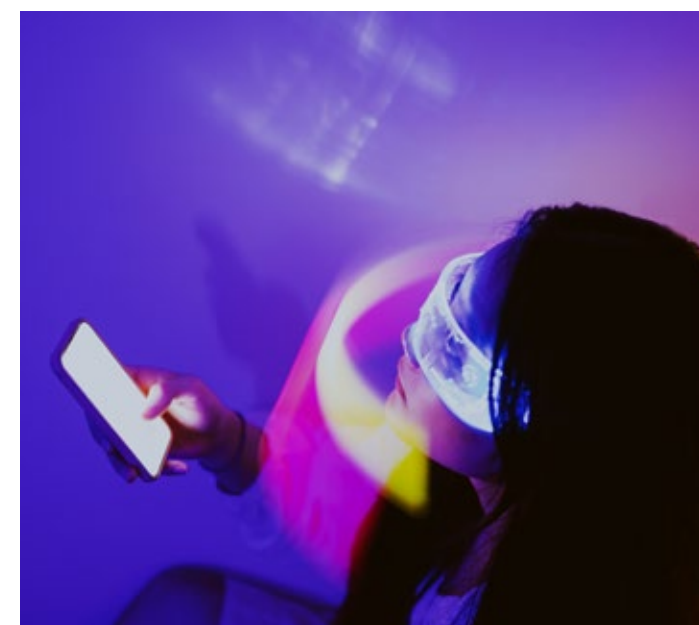
In that vein, bilibili is the category's second fastest-growing brand this year. Its rise testifies to the power of fan-led content creation, as well as how AI algorithms have succeeded in curating niche communities. Big-budget productions still matter for Tencent Video, Youku, Mango TV, and NetEase's gaming studios. But at the same time, platforms like bilibili, Douyin, and Xiaohongshu are growing by matching users with engaging smaller creators (while *also* helping advertisers launch high-reach, AI-customised campaigns).

Global expansion is another key growth area for Chinese media and entertainment brands. Douyin/TikTok remains the best-known Chinese social platform internationally. While its future in the US remains uncertain, the brand's TikTok Shop concept still has huge growth potential elsewhere having only recently launched in major markets like Japan, France, Germany, Brazil, and Mexico.

At home, newer social platforms are gaining traction as ecommerce players. True, 'traditional' livestream shopping formats are still dominated by the big players Tencent, Alibaba, and JD. But newer platforms aim to compete alongside these giants for the next phase of content commerce.

For instance, the Xiaohongshu Creator Centre anticipates this shift by offering enhanced analytics, brand-influencer collaboration tools, and custom storefronts. The brand is also tackling reputational risks with features like watermarks for original content and AI moderation tools to detect banned terms (thus helping reduce content takedowns and avoid shadow banning).

Bigger tech players like Tmall, Baidu, and JD are taking a different tack, using their AI prowess (and massive research budgets) to experiment with virtual avatar livestream hosts that can broadcast 24/7 while responding in real-time to user feedback. In some cases, they've achieved sales conversion rates comparable to 'real' KOLs. Meanwhile, Douyin is straddling both lanes, rolling out new AI tools for small creators while also experimenting with virtual hosts powered by its Doubao AI engine.



MEDIA AND ENTERTAINMENT

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Tencent uses ‘stickiness’ to retain its leadership position

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$197,991 M

+53% vs. 2024

Over the past year, Tencent shifted from scale growth to quality growth. It has grown its brand value by leveraging the centrality of its WeChat ecosystem, by expanding globally and advancing AI innovations (which range from medical imaging tools to its consumer-facing chatbot Yuanbao).

A brand that consumers prefer – at home and abroad

International markets have become a standout area of progress. WeChat Pay is now available in 74 countries, driving growth in foreign card transactions. In Hong Kong and Macao, WeChat mini-programmes saw a 70% year-on-year rise in gross merchandise value. And in Singapore, Tencent debuted palm-swipe payment technology in partnership with Visa, setting a new benchmark for Chinese tech abroad.

Information news and search, China

	Brand strengths	Strength percentile
CONVENIENT	+11	84
ENVIRONMENTALLY RESPONSIBLE	+3	97
TREAT EMPLOYEES WELL	+3	96

Strength Percentile (100 = best)

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Douyin remains a leader in content commerce

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$76,200 M

+34% vs. 2024

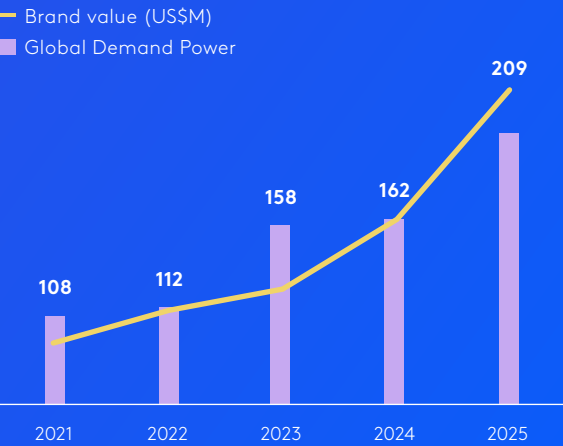
Douyin has built a powerful engine for commercial growth. Its core strength lies in turning content influence into real sales. By matching user interests with shopping scenarios, it has become a major player in content commerce – while also building out its local services and supply chain logistics offerings.

A favourite among brands and consumers

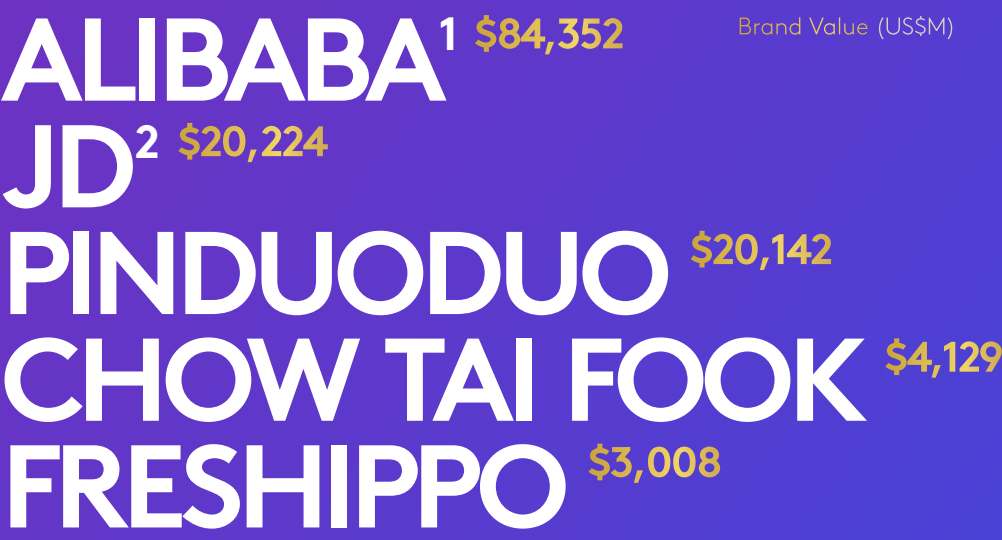
Douyin’s model differs markedly from traditional shelf-based ecommerce. Instead of waiting for users to search, it pushes products through influencers and interest-driven content. That blend of entertainment and commerce has become a key point of brand differentiation.

The platform now has 800 million daily users and boasts an exceptionally rich source of AI training data. The up side? Advanced algorithms that use real-time behavior data to match people with products – even those who had no plans to shop (in fact, 85% of eventual buyers are drawn in by content, not prior intent). This makes Douyin a favourite channel for brands looking to grow.

Douyin’s five-year growth journey



RETAIL



¹ Alibaba brand value includes Alibaba Cloud, Ant Financial, AliExpress, 1688.com, AliHealth, Taobao, and Tmall
² JD brand value includes JD Financial

DEFINITION:
The Retail category includes physical and digital distribution channels in grocery and department stores and specialists in drug, electrical, DIY, and home furnishings.

SELLING SMARTER/ AI BOOSTS RETAIL

Retail
Total Brand Value

\$131,857 M

RETAIL

There are five Retail brands in the China Top 100, including one newcomer: FRESHIPPO. Of the returning brands, two rose by double digits and two declined slightly.

Chinese retailers are under pressure. The domestic economy is slowing, and consumers say they have less to spend. Pinduoduo's aggressive pricing strategy led to downward price pressure in many product categories. Shopping festivals are no longer guaranteed blockbusters. And while the rise of content commerce has helped some retail heavyweights, it has also created new rivals like Douyin, Xiaohongshu, and bilibili. Meanwhile, trade tensions overseas have made it harder to expand into some new markets.

And yet China's two most valuable Retail brands – Alibaba and JD – have grown handsomely this past year. They might not sell as much lipstick on Singles Day as they did a few years ago, but they're finding other paths to profit and brand value.

How? The answer is simple: AI.

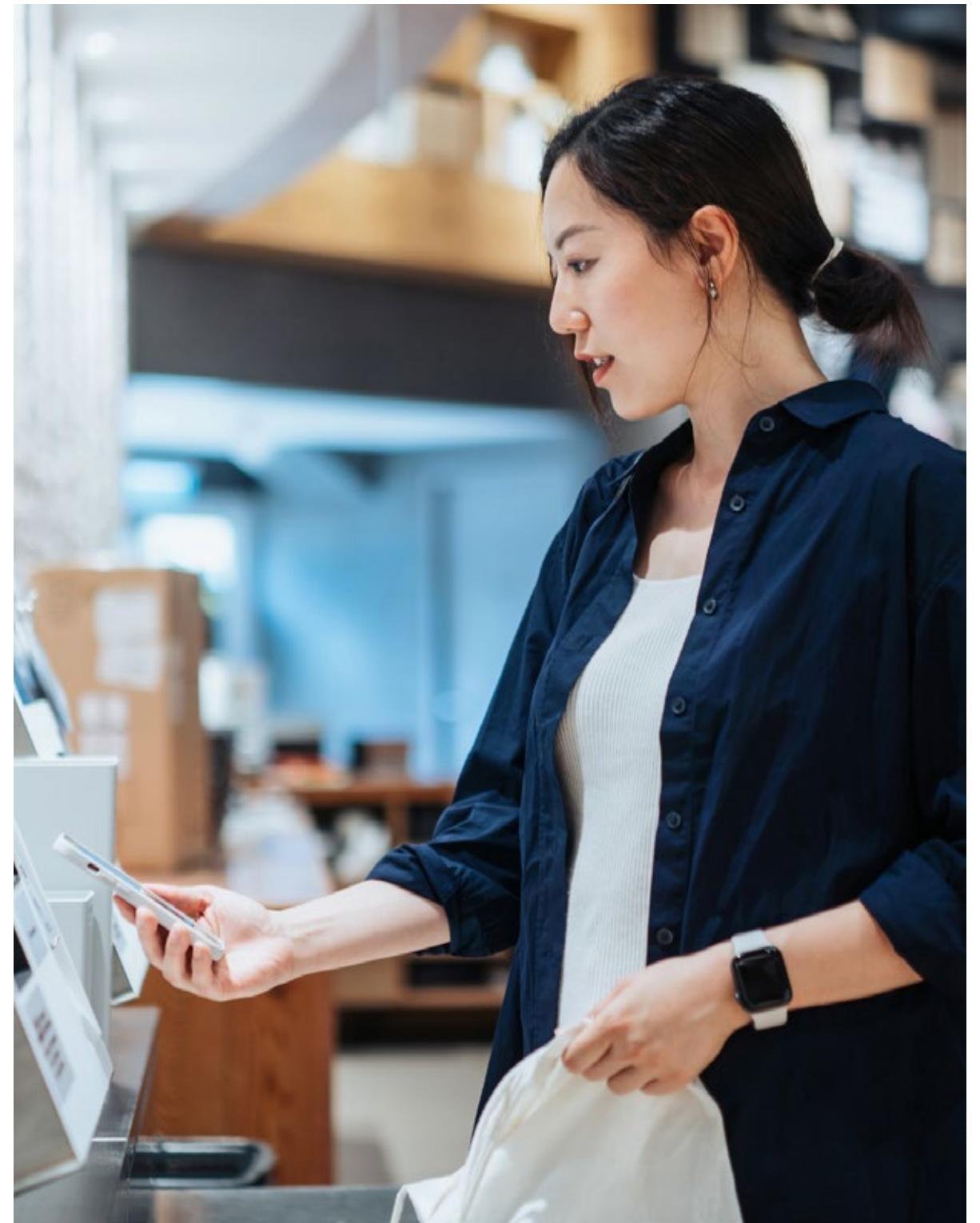
AI has helped brands to further optimise their supply chains, lowering their costs while also improving fulfilment times (and thus customer experience). AI has improved product recommendations, boosting basket sizes and purchase frequency. AI has helped sellers adapt their product pages more easily for foreign markets and set better prices abroad. And it has helped brands and influencers create more compelling content online.

Most of all, AI has brought a new air of excitement and innovation to the category at a time when many had begun to doubt China's ecommerce giants.

Already, new kinds of virtual influencers are trending on livestreams, offering a fun and cost-effective alternative to traditional sales tactics. AI agents have automated about 30% of customer service interactions for JD and Alibaba. And both brands have rolled out branded B2B and B2C AI tools: from JD's AI 'wealth manager' and shopping assistants to the enhanced AliGenie voice assistant powered by Alibaba's powerful Qwen LLM.

Meanwhile, Pinduoduo has begun a multifaceted strategic pivot. After making a bold move into the US and Europe with its Temu brand, it now faces fresh tariffs in some of its biggest overseas domains. In response, the company is focusing on friendlier emerging markets. It now operates in more than 70 countries.

At home, Pinduoduo restructured its merchant ecosystem with a focus on cost efficiencies and digital upgrades. It has improved delivery in remote regions and introduced free shipping across the platform. These moves have already led to strong order growth in western China while reinforcing the brand's popularity in lower-tier cities. At the same time, it has targeted higher-value categories like 3C as a ticket to becoming a high-quality, high-value shopping destination.



RETAIL

BRAND SPOTLIGHT



Alibaba uses AI to unlock new growth

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$84,352 M

+23% vs. 2024

Alibaba has achieved strong recovery after several challenging years. To accomplish this, the brand has focused on user experience, AI integration, and overseas expansion.

Premium positioning and global expansion

Within the retail segment, Alibaba’s user numbers and user engagement have reached record highs. Alibaba has also made it easier for merchants to sell abroad, using new tools to improve order reliability and fulfilment. Its AI model Tongyi Qianwen supports over 69,000 international sellers, and more than 100 million product listings have been optimised with AI. Back at home, Alibaba’s Tmall store is one of only two ‘Justified Premium’ Chinese ecommerce players in Kantar’s strategic pricing model.

Alibaba’s B2B ecosystem also continues to widen. The brand’s growing partnerships with global tech firms like Apple hint at broader AI ambitions.

Online commerce, China



BRAND SPOTLIGHT



JD secures trust through superior service

2025 BRAND VALUE

\$20,224 M

+16% vs. 2024

Over the past year, JD has improved user services and applied AI across its retail operations. This has led to major gains in efficiency while also enhancing user satisfaction. Last year, the brand’s net profits rose by 71%.

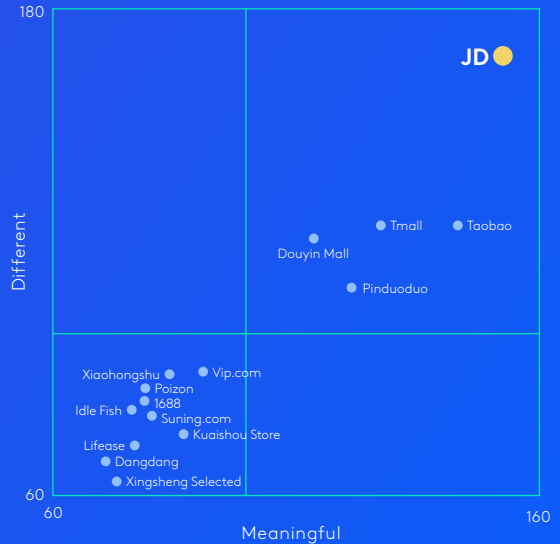
JD differentiates through trust

JD has strong Meaningful Difference perceptions and a well-earned reputation for trustworthiness. JD sees earning consumers’ trust as a continual process: to that end, it recently upgraded its PLUS membership, launched a new Lifestyle Service Package, and widened the reach of its free shipping offer. A recent ‘trade-in for new’ option further boosted shoppers’ confidence in the brand. And through it all, JD has continued to guarantee product quality while providing strong after-sales customer service.

	Brand strengths	Strength percentile
PURPOSE	+31	98
SUPERIOR	+12	78
COMPANY YOU TRUST	+3	82

Strength Percentile (100 = best)

Online commerce, China





**BRAND
PERSPECTIVES**

- 83 - HAIER
 - 85 - VIVO
 - 87 - TCL
-





Zhou Yunjie
Chairman of the Board and CEO
Haier Group



View the full interview on [Kantar’s official YouTube channel](#)

Haier

Zhou Yunjie is Chairman of the Board of Directors and CEO of Haier Group. He studied science and engineering in college and later obtained a Doctor of Management degree.

Haier Group is a leading global provider of better life and digital transformation solutions. In 2024, it achieved a global revenue of \$55.9 billion. It has built 10 R&D centres, 35 industrial parks, 163 manufacturing centres, and has a global workforce of 120,000 employees.

As you think back over your career, how did you get to where you are today?

I graduated from university in 1988 and have been working for Haier ever since. I started as a frontline employee and have gone through many positions including sales, manufacturing, quality control, procurement, and R&D.

I feel grateful to have come of age during a great era. Without the resumption of China’s National College Entrance Examination, it would have been extremely difficult for people like us to have the opportunity to study at university. Without the Reform and Opening-up policy, there would be no achievements of Haier today.

I also feel grateful to the generation of entrepreneurs that came before me, especially Mr. Zhang Ruimin and Ms. Yang Mianmian. They established Haier on the basis of a factory that was on the verge of collapse. With extraordinary courage and wisdom, they made Haier what it is today. In particular, Mr. Zhang Ruimin created a corporate culture of entrepreneurship, innovation, and the pursuit of excellence: ‘a place where horses are raced instead of being judged by appearance’. In other words: a place where you are able to develop your abilities to the fullest extent, and rise to a stage that corresponds with them.

In 2021, Mr. Zhang Ruimin handed Haier over to me. This was not a case of corporate succession, but of ecosystem inheritance. I say that because Haier is more than an enterprise or a brand: it is an ever-thriving entrepreneurial ecosystem, as well as an entrepreneurial spirit passed down from generation to generation.

What advice would you give to young people who are joining Haier today?

I would offer them these three questions: *Can you be as sensitive as a sensor? Can you think as comprehensively as an integrated circuit? Can you integrate things as intelligently as AI?*

Being ‘as sensitive as a sensor’ means always maintaining an open-minded attitude. Anchor to your goals, and then perceive and capture data just like a sensor does: that’s the first step toward developing your cognition and skills.

‘Thinking like an integrated circuit’ means learning to recognise and pursue true innovation. This kind of thinking is more than just stacking functions on top of one another – it’s about reconstructing the relationships between things. Learn to solve problems from a systematic perspective, by building multidimensional interconnected ecosystems.

‘Integrating like AI’ means building the ability to solve complex problems multidimensionally. One should not only possess intelligence quotient (IQ) and emotional quotient (EQ), but also adversity quotient (AQ) and spiritual quotient (SQ). You can achieve real self-growth by solving problems that draw on all of these attributes.

Based on what you’ve learned over the past two decades, what are some of the most important elements in building a world-class brand?

A clear brand direction is key. From 1984 to today, Haier’s strategy has remained consistent. We have always aimed to create a world-leading brand. From becoming No. 1 in China’s home appliance industry to becoming No. 1 globally, we’ve taken each step with persistence.

This has not been easy. We went through 25 years of non-profitability in overseas markets, but we kept going. In 2018, Haier proposed the concept of the ‘IoT ecosystem brand’. Today, we’re the only brand of that kind to be listed in the Kantar BrandZ Top 100 Most Valuable Global Brands – as we have been for seven consecutive years.



Zhou Yunjie
Chairman of the Board and CEO
Haier Group

A modern governance system is also essential. In 2005, Haier began to explore the *RenDanHeYi* management model. After nearly 20 years of exploration, it has become a globally recognised and applicable model – not only enabling us to effectively meet users’ needs but also significantly enhancing employees’ working experiences. To date, 15 *RenDanHeYi* research centres have been spontaneously established around the world. And some 82,000 companies are now learning from and applying this model.

How have consumers’ needs changed compared with 20 years ago?

First, consumers’ focus has shifted from product functions to overall experience. Users have moved beyond just caring about technical specifications; they now look for scenario-based experiences. Take refrigerators, for example: what users want today is not merely a storage device for food, but a kind of health steward that enables convenient eating, supports freshness, and promotes a healthy diet. No one product function can completely fulfil all of these aspirations, but a lifestyle scenario can.

Second, interactivity: consumers who once passively accepted products now actively participate in their co-creation. Users nowadays are like product managers; we think of them as ‘prosumers’. Give them the chance, and they will gladly step into that role of co-designer. A good example of this is the ‘lazy-person washing machine’ we recently launched.

This washing machine has three drums, which can separately wash socks, underwear, and outerwear; and all three drums can run simultaneously. By ‘co-created’, I mean that at every step of the development process, we returned to users to ask for feedback on prototypes or design schemes, and to better understand people’s pain points and needs. Since the washing machine’s launch, demand has exceeded supply, and we already have pre-orders for more than 80,000 units.

Third, we’re seeing a shift from meeting functional needs to offering emotional value and emotional resonance. At this stage, users don’t just want good products – they want emotional connection. For example, we recently relaunched the animated series *Haier Brothers* [a classic children’s science popularisation adventure story that first aired in the 1990s]. Almost immediately, many netizens suggested that Haier launch related products, too. They also provided us with valuable suggestions on aspects such as the image, music, and storyline for the sequel of *Haier Brothers*. That’s a clear reflection of emotional interactivity and warmth. People want to connect with a brand that resonates with them personally.

What role do you think AI will play in a world-class enterprise like Haier? What might Haier look like in 10 years?

We ‘either evolve together with AI, or be marginalised by AI’. In the future, across all fields, it will likely be the smartest people working alongside intelligent machines.

As for Haier, we will focus on three pillars, including Smart Living Ecosystem, Comprehensive Health Industry Ecosystem, and Digital Economy Industry Ecosystem: creating intelligent terminals that better understand users, building a more flexible manufacturing network, and establishing a warmer service ecosystem. Our goal is for every family to have an ecosystem partner that can autonomously evolve, every factory and city to have a brain capable of independent thinking and decision making, and every individual to have a personal health steward. That’s the vision we’re working toward.

Globally, AI will undoubtedly reshape the world. I believe this is a major opportunity for Chinese enterprises. As long as we seize it, we’ll see more Chinese brands and more ‘Created in China’ innovations rising to the global stage.





Kent Cheng
Senior Vice President and President of China Market at vivo



What do you think have been the biggest shifts over the last 15 years in both consumer needs and the ways brands engage consumers?

This year marks our company’s 30th anniversary, during which we have witnessed the transformation of eras and consumer trends while growing alongside over 500 million users worldwide. Smartphones have evolved from mere communication tools connecting people to bridges that link individuals with the digital world.

In 2017, China’s smartphone market entered a period of stable growth. To pursue more sustainable and high-quality growth, we began exploring the scenarios and experiences that consumers truly care about in the long term. Beyond industry benchmarks such as durability, signal strength, and battery life, we discovered that users prioritise four key dimensions: design, imaging, system, and performance. This insight prompted us to allocate resources strategically in these areas. In 2023, we launched our proprietary technology brand, BlueTech, and collaborated with industry leaders like ZEISS and MediaTek to collectively advance solid technological innovations that meet user expectations.

Beyond functional experiences, we also returned and amplified products’ innate ability to forge emotional connections. Last year, our collaboration with director Shuang Xin on the short film *Call Me When You Need Me* – entirely shot on the vivo X100 Ultra – was rooted in profound observations of Chinese daily life. It seamlessly integrated our products and brand into nuanced storytelling. The film earned the Bronze Lion in the Film Craft category at the 2025 Cannes Lions International Festival of Creativity, making vivo the only Chinese smartphone brand to receive this honour in the last five years.

How do you ensure your brand stays relevant in the current era of rapid technological and cultural change?

All our product and technology R&D starts with our users. A user-centric approach is the foundation of everything we do and the core value of our enterprise.

We aim to not only get closer to our users, but also to truly understand them. That’s why vivo has launched a series of initiatives to connect with users, such as the User Advisory Program and the Global Awakening Lions Program. Moreover, we listen to the real ‘voice’ of our users through user research, insights, after-sales VOC (Voice of Customer), and product NPS (Net Promoter Score), ensuring we avoid ‘self-indulgence’.

We guide our practices with the Four User-Oriented Questions: identify the target audience, uncover the core scenarios that matter most to them, break down user needs within those scenarios into key tasks, and evaluate whether the delivery of those key tasks meets the required standards. Through these four steps, we aim to create a user experience that is different and significantly better.

We genuinely respect and trust our users. Technology may be cold, but we aim to provide it to our users in a warm, humanised form and bring them wonderful experiences.





Kent Cheng
Senior Vice President and President of China Market at vivo

Take imaging as an example. vivo has been deeply committed to the field of imaging for over a decade – throughout this journey, our user-oriented approach and professional imaging philosophy, which centres on the human experience, have remained unchanged. vivo’s 200 MP ZEISS APO Super Telephoto lens was born from our profound understanding of users’ core needs. It allows users to capture a distant sunset simply by raising their phones and enables those in the stands to clearly record the exciting moments of their idols’ performances on stage, preserving every beautiful memory.

Only by truly practicing user orientation can we leverage these breakthrough innovations and truly achieve the goal of ‘coming from the users, going back to the users’.

Respecting humanity, serving people, and becoming a humanistic technology company have always been vivo’s unwavering commitments. vivo upholds the brand direction of ‘Joy of Humanity’, prioritising people above all else. This is our proven approach to adapting to rapid environmental changes.

And finally, we’re all aware of the pace of development and adoption of AI – what are the implications for vivo?

In the ever-evolving tide of technological advancement, the mobile phone industry stands at the forefront of both technological evolution and the creation of humanistic value. As the brightest star in today’s technological revolution, AI has also brought new opportunities to the mobile phone industry.

First, AI has enhanced the systematic capabilities of mobile phones in underlying technologies such as imaging, operating systems, and performance. As early as 2018, vivo began its strategic layout in AI, establishing the vivo AI Global Research Institute. In 2023, vivo released its self-developed BlueLM. We are dedicated to applying AI as an underlying technology in mobile phones, breaking through technical limits, unleashing efficiency, and making ultimate experiences and a better life within easy reach.

Secondly, we continue to deeply explore the on-device applications of AI, allowing users to experience the in-depth empowerment of AI on vivo products. For example, the AI Visual feature on the vivo X series can change the sky style in multiple ways with one tap, remove passers-by, and add customised Live Photo with one tap, so that users can take perfect pictures without any regrets. The X Fold5 further empowers mobile work scenarios with its AI capabilities. Features such as the AI captions immediately benefits the office user.

Finally, vivo believes that ‘technology illuminates a beautiful future’. The transformation of technology lies in bringing meaningful changes to people and enabling everyone to benefit from technological progress. Enhanced capabilities can only be achieved by carefully designing every function with AI, making them intelligent and easy to use. For example, vivo Sight uses an AI large model to convert visual information into voice prompts, informing visually impaired users that ‘the sky is very blue’ and ‘Gate 23 has arrived’. This is the warmest moment of vivo’s BlueLM and also the most wonderful moment of technology.

It has been and will continue to be vivo’s long-standing and unchanging mission to warm every household with the light of humanistic technology. The starlight of AI will surely enable vivo to better use the power of technology to make even the smallest needs visible to the times.





Yuki Wei
Vice President, TCL Technology Group
Chairman, TCL Charity Foundation



TCL

You’ve described globalisation as ‘the art of resonance, not homogenisation’. During the process of brand globalisation, how does TCL truly break through geographical barriers and transcend cultural differences to explore what resonates with users worldwide?

Based on TCL’s 26 years of global experience, I believe there are three main aspects:

First, we promote technology-driven humanised communication with a focus on universal topics, using human-centric initiatives to bridge cultural differences and spark emotional resonance. Through our own IP platforms, such as TCLYoung, TCLforHer, TCLGreen, and TCLArt, TCL narrates brand stories around universal topics – youth inspiration, women’s empowerment, environmental sustainability, and inclusiveness through art. With that, we transcend cultural barriers, build trust with diverse stakeholders, and resonate with global users.

Second, the global communication of the sporting spirit matters a lot. As products go global, brands also need to keep pace. It is essential to build strong emotional connections with users across

different countries and cultures, and sports serve as an excellent bond for this purpose. TCL has been actively engaged with major global sports events and associations for over 30 years – from the Chinese Basketball Association to Copa América; from the International Basketball Federation to the NFL. In esports, which has become incredibly popular among young people, TCL sponsors IPs like the League of Legends Pro League to continuously bridge the gap with the next generation of consumers. TCL has now become an official Worldwide Olympic Partner. From sponsoring sports events to joining hands with the Olympics, TCL’s journey in sports marketing has always been a twin pursuit of brand globalisation and emotional resonance.

Third, we adhere to a localisation strategy in our global communications, strengthening the consistency of the brand globally while accelerating the establishment of local partnerships and brand localisation. This includes leveraging leading local market IPs to enhance brand recognition within target markets, collaborating with influential local KOLs on mainstream social platforms and using local languages and pop-culture elements to interact with consumers.





Yuki Wei
Vice President, TCL Technology Group
Chairman, TCL Charity Foundation

In 2025, TCL officially became a Worldwide TOP Partner of the International Olympic Committee. What do you think are the key factors behind TCL’s ability to secure this recognition?

This appointment represents the highest-level commercial partnership granted by the International Olympic Committee, reserved for companies with world-leading technology, quality, and brand reputation.

Primarily, it is because TCL has clearly proven capabilities that meet the rigorous standards of the exclusive TOP Program, which allows only one partner from each industry. Since entering Vietnam in 1999, TCL has already been on a 26-year journey of globalisation.

Leveraging our world-leading technological and industrial strength, TCL has achieved remarkable accomplishments in the global market. In 2024, TCL’s TV shipments reached 29 million units, ranking second globally, while our Mini LED TV shipments ranked first worldwide. Additionally, TCL CSOT (China Star Optoelectronics Technology) gaming displays, as well as LTPS laptop and LTPS tablet products, account for the largest global market share. TCL ZHONGHUAN also leads the global market in photovoltaic silicon wafers.

Equally crucial is the alignment of TCL’s brand proposition with the Olympic spirit. Our slogan ‘Inspire Greatness’ resonates with the Olympic motto ‘Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together’ in championing human potential. And our vision of ‘Building a Better World with Technology’, embodied in our global human-centric values, is closely aligned with the IOC’s mission of ‘Shaping a better future through sport’. The IOC President Kirsty Coventry has remarked on this collaboration: ‘TCL’s spirit perfectly matches the essence of the Olympic Movement’.

TCL’s long-standing legacy of trust developed through sports marketing assets is also an important reason. As one of China’s globalisation pioneers, we’ve strategically invested in top sports and entertainment IPs for over 30 years. Through

a ‘glocalisation’ marketing strategy, we have accelerated our presence across global markets in various fields such as football, basketball, rugby, cricket, and esports, creating a diverse and youthful global sports IP portfolio.

As a key leader driving the company’s growth, how do you perceive the value and significance of brand building for the company’s development over the long term?

As products go global, brands must also build a worldwide presence – systematic global brand building supports our expansion across the world. Through sports marketing and technology-driven humanised communication, TCL transcends cultural barriers, builds global trust and credibility, and continuously connects and engages users worldwide, which provides strength and resilience to navigate the challenging global market environment.

TCL’s brand building empowers both product and business marketing. For example, through global endorsements like the Olympic TOP partnership, TCL transforms cutting-edge technologies into tangible value propositions that resonate with users, enhancing product competitiveness. Meanwhile, through human-centric brand marketing, TCL fosters emotional connections with users, which organically attracts audiences and lowers the threshold for decision-making among users. Moreover, TCL strives to establish sustainable competitive advantages and differentiation. By maintaining clear brand positioning, TCL secures a unique position in consumers’ minds. By being recognised as a world-leading technology brand, we accelerate market acceptance of TCL’s new technologies and products, thereby improving the commercialisation efficiency of technological innovations.



As a benchmark for Chinese brands going global, TCL has pioneered a new path of globalisation, transitioning from ‘landing’ to ‘taking root’ in international markets. What preparations has TCL made to better seize future growth opportunities?

TCL’s development philosophy is ‘Strategy Guidance, Innovation Drive, Advanced Manufacturing, and Global Operation’. As a Worldwide Olympic Partner, we consistently prioritise innovation-driven growth and put great importance on the development and exploration of cutting-edge technologies. From 2019 to 2024, TCL’s R&D investment exceeded \$8.35 billion. We increased investment in key technologies such as edge intelligence, AI, and digital twins, continuously enhancing our technical support and enhancing our capabilities for enterprise digitalisation. Currently, we have actively established a strong presence in the field of industrial AI through collaborations with multiple universities and enterprises, such as co-founding a joint laboratory with the University of Hong Kong and forming a comprehensive AI strategic partnership with Alibaba Cloud. In June 2025, TCL CSOT launched the display industry’s first vertical AI model focused on reasoning: X-Intelligence 3.0.

From exporting products to co-building industrial capabilities, going global is not just about building factories overseas, but more importantly, leveraging our capabilities to grow together with local markets. With localised products and technological prowess, we have solidified our presence in Europe and North America, with overseas revenue growing by more than 19% annually on average for the past five years. We have always been committed to building a brand that consumers and customers can trust. Trust does not mean eliminating differences. It means finding common ground on the premise of mutual respect. Brand building relies on genuine emotional connections and a commitment to long-term values.



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The Kantar logo, featuring the word "KANTAR" in a bold, white, sans-serif font. The letter "K" is stylized with a vertical bar to its left, creating a unique graphic element. The background of the entire advertisement is a composite image: a starry night sky transitions into a vibrant sunset or sunrise with pink and orange clouds, and a silhouette of a person stands on a dark, jagged rock peak in the foreground, looking out over a misty mountain range.

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KANTAR BRANDZ BRAND VALUATION METHODOLOGY

INTRODUCTION

A Kantar BrandZ ranking of brand valuations lists the brands making the largest absolute US\$ contribution to the total value of their respective parent companies, considering both current and future performance.

This is the true value of brand building and we want to isolate and reward the brands making the largest contributions to the success of their parent companies.

A company may have huge overall business value but the absolute US\$ contribution made by the relevant brand(s) that the company owns may not be a comparatively large figure – at least not large enough to qualify for the Kantar BrandZ ranking in question.

The brands that appear in this report are the most valuable in the country. They were selected for inclusion in the *Kantar BrandZ Most Valuable Chinese Brands 2025* report based on the unique and objective Kantar BrandZ brand valuation methodology that combines extensive and ongoing consumer insights with rigorous financial analysis.

Our valuation methodology can be distinguished from its competitors by the way we use consumer viewpoints to assess brand equity. We strongly believe that how consumers feel about a brand determines its success or failure. We conduct worldwide, ongoing, in-depth, quantitative consumer research and build up a global picture of brands on a category-by-category and market-by-market basis. Globally, our research covers over 4.5 million consumer interviews in 538 categories, and 22,000 different brands in 54 markets.

Before reviewing the details of this methodology, consider these three fundamental questions: why is brand important; why is brand valuation important; and what makes Kantar BrandZ the definitive brand valuation tool?

Importance of brand

Brands embody a core promise of values and benefits consistently delivered. Brands provide clarity and guidance for choices made by companies, consumers, investors, and other stakeholders. Brands provide the signposts we need to navigate the consumer and B2B landscapes.

At the heart of a brand’s value is its ability to appeal to both relevant and potential customers. Kantar BrandZ uniquely measures this appeal and validates it against actual sales performance. Brands that succeed in creating the greatest attraction power are:

Meaningful

In any category, they hold more appeal and generate greater ‘love’, meeting the individual’s expectations and needs.

Different

They are unique in a positive way and ‘set the trends’, staying ahead of the curve for the benefit of the consumer.

Salient

They come spontaneously to mind as the brand of choice for key needs.

Importance of brand valuation

Brand valuation is a metric that quantifies the worth of these powerful but intangible corporate assets. It enables brand owners and the investment community to evaluate and compare brands so they can make faster and better-informed decisions.

Brand valuation also enables marketing professionals to quantify their achievements in driving business growth with brands, and to celebrate the achievements in the boardroom.

Distinction of Kantar BrandZ valuation

Kantar BrandZ is the only brand valuation tool that peels away all the financial and other components of brand value and gets to the core – the extent to which brand alone contributes to corporate value. This core, what we call Brand Contribution, differentiates Kantar BrandZ from its competitors.

Interbrand, for instance, derives the consumer point of view from desk-based research, expert opinions, and similar sources. Meanwhile, Brand Finance’s methodology depends on comparable licensing agreements within brand sectors, which may not apply to brands in sectors where licensing is uncommon or sectors overlap.

Kantar BrandZ’s methodology provides a more nuanced and actionable valuation, making it particularly valuable for companies looking to understand and leverage their brand’s impact on consumer behaviour and market performance.

Globally accredited MDS framework

Kantar’s Meaningful Different and Salient framework (MDS) is the only brand equity measurement approach endorsed by the Marketing Accountability Standards Board (MASB).

MASB’s process, the Marketing Metric Audit Protocol (MMAP), is a formal, industry-recognised process for assessing connections from marketing activities and metrics to financial performance.

This means our MDS framework is independently validated to deliver commercial outcomes and pinpoints long-term measures of brand value growth.



KANTAR BRANDZ BRAND VALUATION METHODOLOGY

THE VALUATION PROCESS

Kantar BrandZ valuations isolate the value generated by the strength of the brand alone in the minds of consumers i.e. with all other elements removed.

To achieve this, we calculate and combine two important elements:

- 1. **Financial Value** – the proportion of the total \$ value of the parent company that can be attributed to the brand in question, considering both current and future performance.
- 2. **Brand Contribution** – quantifies the proportion of this Financial Value that is directly driven by a brand’s equity i.e. the ability of the brand to deliver value to the company by predisposing consumers to choose the brand over others or pay more for it, based purely on perceptions.

Note: This does not include the proportion of consumers who choose the brand for reasons other than this predisposition e.g. those attracted by price promotions, a particularly prominent display, etc. Such purchases are not due to the brand’s equity and so are removed as part of the process.

ELIGIBILITY CRITERIA

Brands ranked in the *Kantar BrandZ Most Valuable Chinese Brands 2025* must meet the following eligibility criteria:

- 1. The brand was originally created in Mainland China.
- 2. The brand is owned by a publicly traded enterprise. For privately owned brands, the company’s financials are audited by a major global accounting practice and published in the public domain.
- 3. Bank brands derive at least 20% of their earnings from retail banking.
- 4. Chinese unicorn brands have their most recent valuation publicly available.

Part 1 Calculating financial value

STEP 1

We begin with the brand’s **parent company**, which generates earnings from:

- 1. **Tangible assets** (assets with a physical form, which include fixed assets such as buildings, machinery, land, current assets e.g. cash and inventory).
- 2. **Intangible assets** (such as patents, trademarks, brands).

Example: ‘Volkswagen AG’ is a parent company that generates earnings from tangible assets like its manufacturing plants and equipment, as well as its intangible assets, so the brand names under which the cars are sold – Volkswagen, Audi, SEAT, etc.

To determine the proportion of earnings directly derived from the company’s intangible assets we begin with **corporate earnings** – sourced from S&P Capital IQ, which represent the latest annual earnings reported by the parent company. Then, by using other financial data from the same sources, we calculate and apply a metric called the **intangible ratio**.

By multiplying corporate earnings by the intangible ratio, we are left with **intangible earnings**, which represent earnings derived from intangible assets.

STEP 2

Next, we need to determine the proportion of these **intangible earnings** that are directly attributable to the brand we want to value. To do this we take the intangible earnings identified in Step 1 and apply the **attribution rate**, which literally attributes a proportion of the parent company’s intangible earnings to the brand we want to value.

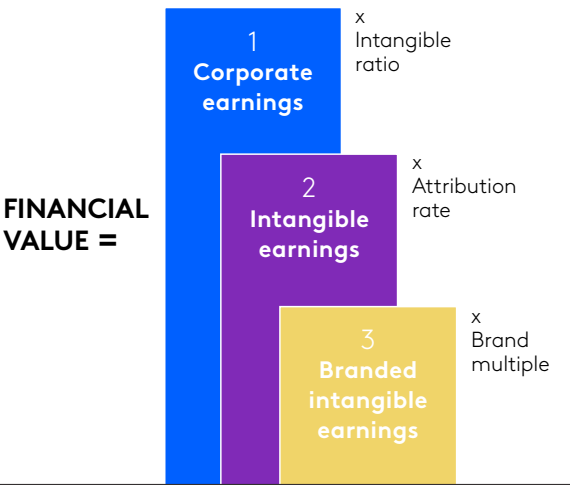
The attribution rate is determined by analysis of brand-level financial information from the parent company’s published financial reports and other credible sources, such as data from Kantar.

Once the attribution rate is applied to intangible earnings, we are left with **branded intangible earnings** i.e. the proportion of the parent company’s intangible earnings that can be attributed to the specific brand in question e.g. this step would attribute a proportion of Volkswagen AG’s intangible earnings to Volkswagen, Audi, SEAT, etc.

STEP 3

The final step is to consider the projected earnings of the brand in question, which measures the brand’s ability to generate earnings in the future and requires the addition of a final component – the **brand multiple**, which is also calculated from financial data sourced from S&P Capital IQ. It’s similar to the calculation used by financial analysts to determine the market value of stocks (Example: 6x earnings or 12x earnings).

When we multiply the branded intangible earnings from Step 2 by the brand multiple, we reach the brand’s true **Financial Value** – i.e. the proportion of the parent company’s \$ value that can be attributed to the brand in question, accounting for current and projected performance.



KANTAR BRANDZ BRAND VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Part 2 Determining brand contribution

To arrive at the true value of the brand (i.e. the asset in the minds of consumers), we need to quantify its strength relative to competitors i.e. to isolate the Financial Value that is directly driven by its **brand equity**. This allows us to understand the proportion of the Financial Value that is explained by the brand alone, and hence the total \$ value of the brand itself. A brand's equity can impact consumer behaviour and contribute value to a corporation in three ways:

- 1. **Current demand** – based on the strength of its equity alone, a brand can influence consumers to choose it over others in the present – generating volume share.
- 2. **Price premium** – based on the strength of its equity alone, a brand can influence consumers to be willing to pay more for it over others – generating value share and profit.
- 3. **Future demand and price** – based on the strength of its equity alone, a brand can influence consumers to buy the brand more in future or to buy it for the first time at the desired price – increasing volume and value share in the future.

Using Kantar BrandZ's unique survey-based MDS framework, we are able to quantify a brand's abilities in each of these three areas relative to competitors, with a survey-based measure:

- (i) Current demand = **Demand Power**
- (ii) Price premium = **Pricing Power**
- (iii) Future demand and price = **Future Power**

The first two of these measures contribute to the proportion of the company's total value accounted for by the brand's equity alone i.e. the **Brand Contribution**.

Part 3 Calculating brand value

Brand value is the \$ amount that the brand contributes to overall business value of the parent company. This is calculated as follows:

BRAND
VALUE

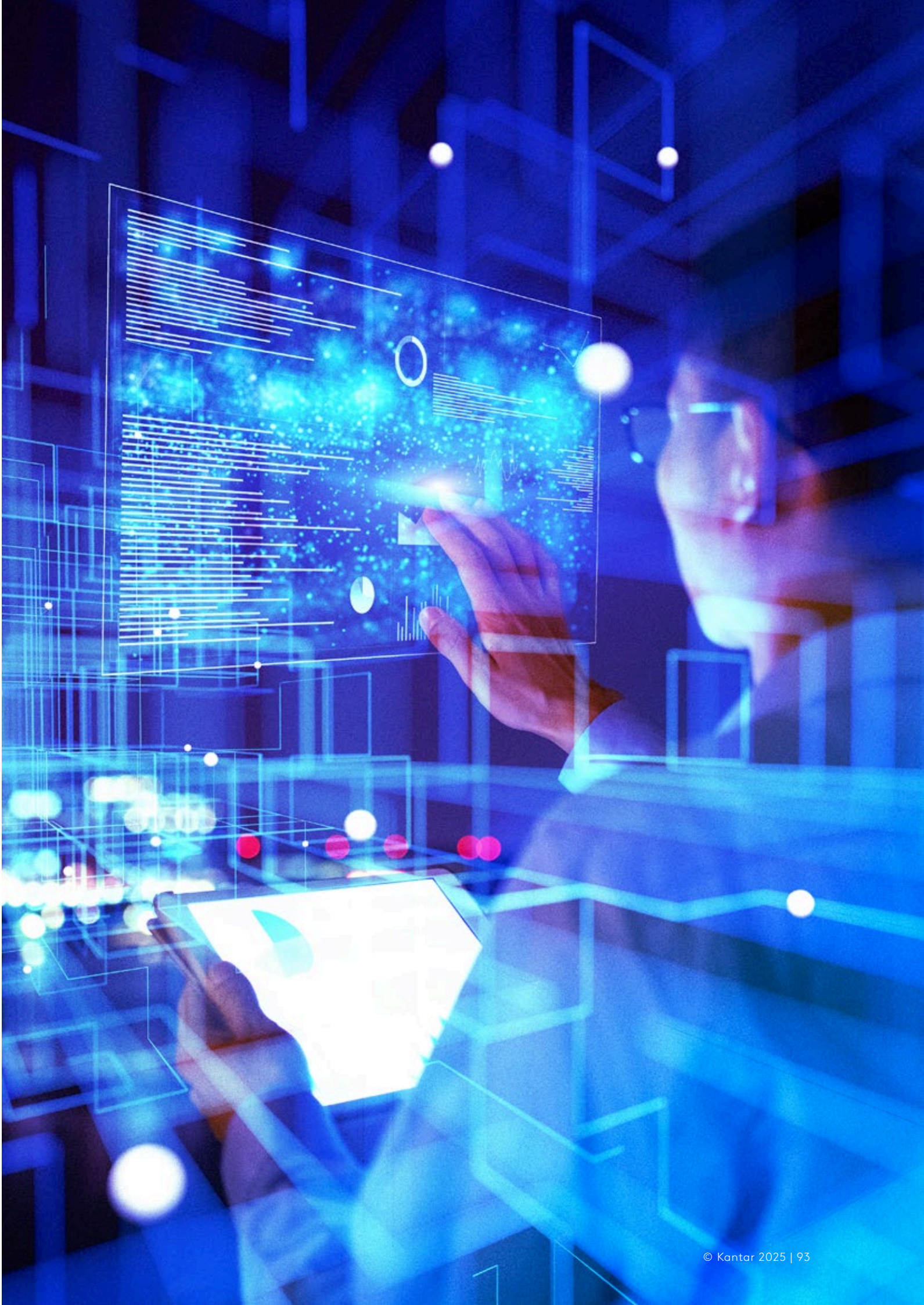
=

FINANCIAL
VALUE

×

BRAND
CONTRIBUTION

This is the final brand value figure that appears in the valuation, positioning the brand within the ranking as one of the country's strongest and most valuable.



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A person wearing a red jacket and dark pants stands on a large, dark, mossy rock in the foreground, looking up at a massive, multi-tiered waterfall cascading down a steep, moss-covered cliff. The water is white and frothy as it falls, creating a powerful visual metaphor for the 'live voices' mentioned in the text. The background is a lush, green forest.

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Photography by:

Getty Images



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Shagun is a Senior Analyst with the brand valuation practice overseeing the brand valuation process for the China 2025 ranking. This involves selecting brands, preparing files, calculating key components and brand values, and analysing data to identify insights behind brand value changes.



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Jessica is Marketing Lead at Kantar, responsible for end-to-end project execution for Kantar BrandZ in China, including stakeholder management, report production, and launch management.



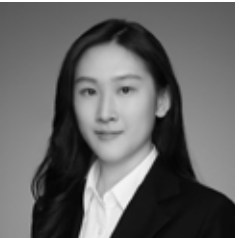
Wenjia Jiang

Wenjia is Senior Product Development Analyst, providing essential research and analytical support for the Kantar BrandZ China report.



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Priyanka is Valuation Manager for Kantar BrandZ. She looks after brand valuation projects in Kantar BrandZ for various markets.



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THE KANTAR BRANDZ CHINA TEAM



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Sirius Wang

Sirius has devoted the past 17 years to building products, driving commercial application of big data and AI into consumer insights. He oversees the product development and solution portfolio, leading Kantar Marketplace – the world’s largest market research automation platform across Greater China.



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Vesper leads Kantar’s content marketing in China. She contributed to the proofreading of this report as well as the PR, marketing, and communications on the Kantar BrandZ China project 2025.



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KANTAR BRANDZ

2025 MOST VALUABLE
CHINESE BRANDS
最具价值中国品牌

Author: **David Walter**
Producer: **Raam Tarat**
Designer: **Hiten Thaker**

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